

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 19

Psalms

Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 19

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Psalms

Psalms 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 How well God must like you-- you don't hang out at Sin Saloon, you don't slink along Dead-End Road, you don't go to Smart-Mouth College.
- 1 Blessed is the man who does not walk in the counsel of the wicked or stand in the way of sinners or sit in the seat of mockers.
- 2 Instead you thrill to GOD's Word, you chew on Scripture day and night.
- 2 But his delight is in the law of the LORD, and on his law he meditates day and night.
- 3 You're a tree replanted in Eden, bearing fresh fruit every month, Never dropping a leaf, always in blossom.
- 3 He is like a tree planted by streams of water, which yields its fruit in season and whose leaf does not wither. Whatever he does prospers.
- 4 You're not at all like the wicked, who are mere windblown dust--
- 4 Not so the wicked! They are like chaff that the wind blows away.
- 5 Without defense in court, unfit company for innocent people.
- 5 Therefore the wicked will not stand in the judgment, nor sinners in the assembly of the righteous.
- 6 GOD charts the road you take. The road they take is Skid Row.
- 6 For the LORD watches over the way of the righteous, but the way of the wicked will perish.

Psalms 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Why the big noise, nations? Why the mean plots, peoples?
- 1 Why do the nations conspire and the peoples plot in vain?

2 Earth-leaders push for position, Demagogues and delegates meet for summit talks, The God-deniers, the Messiah-defiers:

2 The kings of the earth take their stand and the rulers gather together against the LORD and against his Anointed One.

3 "Let's get free of God! Cast loose from Messiah!"

3 Let us break their chains, they say, "and throw off their fetters."

4 Heaven-throned God breaks out laughing. At first he's amused at their presumption;

4 The One enthroned in heaven laughs; the Lord scoffs at them.

5 Then he gets good and angry. Furiously, he shuts them up:

5 Then he rebukes them in his anger and terrifies them in his wrath, saying,

6 "Don't you know there's a King in Zion? A coronation banquet Is spread for him on the holy summit."

6 I have installed my King on Zion, my holy hill.

7 Let me tell you what GOD said next. He said, "You're my son, And today is your birthday.

7 I will proclaim the decree of the LORD: He said to me, "You are my Son; today I have become your Father.

8 What do you want? Name it: Nations as a present? continents as a prize?

8 Ask of me, and I will make the nations your inheritance, the ends of the earth your possession.

9 You can command them all to dance for you, Or throw them out with tomorrow's trash."

9 You will rule them with an iron scepter; you will dash them to pieces like pottery."

10 So, rebel-kings, use your heads; Upstart-judges, learn your lesson:

10 Therefore, you kings, be wise; be warned, you rulers of the earth.

11 Worship GOD in adoring embrace, Celebrate in trembling awe.

11 Serve the LORD with fear and rejoice with trembling.

12 Kiss Messiah! Your very lives are in danger, you know; His anger is about to explode, But if you make a run for God--you won't regret it! A David psalm, when he escaped for his life from Absalom, his son.

12 Kiss the Son, lest he be angry and you be destroyed in your way, for his wrath can flare up in a moment. Blessed are all who take refuge in him.

Psalms 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD! Look! Enemies past counting! Enemies sprouting like mushrooms,
- 1 A psalm of David. When he fled from his son Absalom. O LORD, how many are my foes! How many rise up against me!
- 2 Mobs of them all around me, roaring their mockery: "Hah! No help for him from God!"
- 2 Many are saying of me, "God will not deliver him." Selah
- 3 But you, GOD, shield me on all sides; You ground my feet, you lift my head high;
- 3 But you are a shield around me, O LORD; you bestow glory on me and lift up my head.
- 4 With all my might I shout up to GOD, His answers thunder from the holy mountain.
- 4 To the LORD I cry aloud, and he answers me from his holy hill. Selah
- 5 I stretch myself out. I sleep. Then I'm up again--rested, tall and steady,
- 5 I lie down and sleep; I wake again, because the LORD sustains me.
- 6 Fearless before the enemy mobs Coming at me from all sides.
- 6 I will not fear the tens of thousands drawn up against me on every side.
- 7 Up, GOD! My God, help me! Slap their faces, First this cheek, then the other, Your fist hard in their teeth!
- 7 Arise, O LORD! Deliver me, O my God! Strike all my enemies on the jaw; break the teeth of the wicked.
- 8 Real help comes from GOD. Your blessing clothes your people!
- 8 From the LORD comes deliverance. May your blessing be on your people. Selah

Psalms 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. When I call, give me answers. God, take my side! Once, in a tight place, you gave me room; Now I'm in trouble again: grace me! hear me!

- 1 For the director of music. With stringed instruments. A psalm of David.
Answer me when I call to you, O my righteous God. Give me relief from
my distress; be merciful to me and hear my prayer.
- 2 You rabble--how long do I put up with your scorn? How long will you
lust after lies? How long will you live crazed by illusion?
- 2 How long, O men, will you turn my glory into shame? How long will
you love delusions and seek false gods? Selah
- 3 Look at this: look Who got picked by GOD! He listens the split second I
call to him.
- 3 Know that the LORD has set apart the godly for himself; the LORD will
hear when I call to him.
- 4 Complain if you must, but don't lash out. Keep your mouth shut, and let
your heart do the talking.
- 4 In your anger do not sin; when you are on your beds, search your hearts
and be silent. Selah
- 5 Build your case before God and wait for his verdict.
- 5 Offer right sacrifices and trust in the LORD.
- 6 Why is everyone hungry for more? "More, more," they say. "More,
more." I have God's more-than-enough,
- 6 Many are asking, "Who can show us any good?" Let the light of your
face shine upon us, O LORD.
- 7 More joy in one ordinary day Than they get in all their shopping sprees.
- 7 You have filled my heart with greater joy than when their grain and new
wine abound.
- 8 At day's end I'm ready for sound sleep, For you, GOD, have put my life
back together.
- 8 I will lie down and sleep in peace, for you alone, O LORD, make me
dwell in safety.

Psalms 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Listen, GOD! Please, pay attention! Can you make sense
of these ramblings,

- 1 For the director of music. For flutes. A psalm of David. Give ear to my words, O LORD, consider my sighing.
- 2 my groans and cries? King-God, I need your help.
- 2 Listen to my cry for help, my King and my God, for to you I pray.
- 3 Every morning you'll hear me at it again. Every morning I lay out the pieces of my life on your altar and watch for fire to descend.
- 3 In the morning, O LORD, you hear my voice; in the morning I lay my requests before you and wait in expectation.
- 4 You don't socialize with Wicked, or invite Evil over as your houseguest.
- 4 You are not a God who takes pleasure in evil; with you the wicked cannot dwell.
- 5 Hot-Air-Boaster collapses in front of you; you shake your head over Mischief-Maker.
- 5 The arrogant cannot stand in your presence; you hate all who do wrong.
- 6 GOD destroys Lie-Speaker; Blood-Thirsty and Truth-Bender disgust you.
- 6 You destroy those who tell lies; bloodthirsty and deceitful men the LORD abhors.
- 7 And here I am, your invited guest-- it's incredible! I enter your house; here I am, prostrate in your inner sanctum,
- 7 But I, by your great mercy, will come into your house; in reverence will I bow down toward your holy temple.
- 8 Waiting for directions to get me safely through enemy lines.
- 8 Lead me, O LORD, in your righteousness because of my enemies-- make straight your way before me.
- 9 Every word they speak is a land mine; their lungs breathe out poison gas. Their throats are gaping graves, their tongues slick as mudslides.
- 9 Not a word from their mouth can be trusted; their heart is filled with destruction. Their throat is an open grave; with their tongue they speak deceit.
- 10 Pile on the guilt, God! Let their so-called wisdom wreck them. Kick them out! They've had their chance.
- 10 Declare them guilty, O God! Let their intrigues be their downfall. Banish them for their many sins, for they have rebelled against you.
- 11 But you'll welcome us with open arms when we run for cover to you. Let the party last all night! Stand guard over our celebration.

- 11 But let all who take refuge in you be glad; let them ever sing for joy.
Spread your protection over them, that those who love your name may
rejoice in you.
- 12 You are famous, GOD, for welcoming God-seekers, for decking us out
in delight.
- 12 For surely, O LORD, you bless the righteous; you surround them with
your favor as with a shield.

Psalms 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Please, GOD, no more yelling, no more trips to the
woodshed.
- 1 For the director of music. With stringed instruments. According to
sheminith. A psalm of David. O LORD, do not rebuke me in your anger
or discipline me in your wrath.
- 2 Treat me nice for a change; I'm so starved for affection. Can't you see I'm
black and blue, beat up badly in bones
- 2 Be merciful to me, LORD, for I am faint; O LORD, heal me, for my
bones are in agony.
- 3 and soul? GOD, how long will it take for you to let up?
- 3 My soul is in anguish. How long, O LORD, how long?
- 4 Break in, GOD, and break up this fight; if you love me at all, get me out
of here.
- 4 Turn, O LORD, and deliver me; save me because of your unfailing love.
- 5 I'm no good to you dead, am I? I can't sing in your choir if I'm buried in
some tomb!
- 5 No one remembers you when he is dead. Who praises you from the
grave?
- 6 I'm tired of all this--so tired. My bed has been floating forty days and
nights On the flood of my tears. My mattress is soaked, soggy with tears.
- 6 I am worn out from groaning; all night long I flood my bed with weeping
and drench my couch with tears.
- 7 The sockets of my eyes are black holes; nearly blind, I squint and grope.
- 7 My eyes grow weak with sorrow; they fail because of all my foes.

- 8 Get out of here, you Devil's crew: at last GOD has heard my sobs.
8 Away from me, all you who do evil, for the LORD has heard my weeping.
9 My requests have all been granted, my prayers are answered.
9 The LORD has heard my cry for mercy; the LORD accepts my prayer.
10 Cowards, my enemies disappear. Disgraced, they turn tail and run.
10 All my enemies will be ashamed and dismayed; they will turn back in sudden disgrace.

Psalms 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. GOD! GOD! I am running to you for dear life; the chase is wild.
1 A shiggaion of David, which he sang to the LORD concerning Cush, a Benjamite. O LORD my God, I take refuge in you; save and deliver me from all who pursue me,
2 If they catch me, I'm finished: ripped to shreds by foes fierce as lions, dragged into the forest and left unlooked for, unremembered.
2 or they will tear me like a lion and rip me to pieces with no one to rescue me.
3 GOD, if I've done what they say--
3 O LORD my God, if I have done this and there is guilt on my hands--
4 betrayed my friends, ripped off my enemies-- If my hands are really that dirty,
4 if I have done evil to him who is at peace with me or without cause have robbed my foe--
5 let them get me, walk all over me, leave me flat on my face in the dirt.
5 then let my enemy pursue and overtake me; let him trample my life to the ground and make me sleep in the dust. Selah
6 Stand up, GOD; pit your holy fury against my furious enemies. Wake up, God.
6 Arise, O LORD, in your anger; rise up against the rage of my enemies. Awake, my God; decree justice.
7 My accusers have packed the courtroom; it's judgment time.

- 7 Let the assembled peoples gather around you. Rule over them from on high;
- 8 Take your place on the bench, reach for your gavel, throw out the false charges against me. I'm ready, confident in your verdict: "Innocent."
- 8 let the LORD judge the peoples. Judge me, O LORD, according to my righteousness, according to my integrity, O Most High.
- 9 Close the book on Evil, GOD, but publish your mandate for us. You get us ready for life: you probe for our soft spots, you knock off our rough edges.
- 9 O righteous God, who searches minds and hearts, bring to an end the violence of the wicked and make the righteous secure.
- 10 And I'm feeling so fit, so safe: made right, kept right.
- 10 My shield is God Most High, who saves the upright in heart.
- 11 God in solemn honor does things right, but his nerves are sandpapered raw. Nobody gets by with anything.
- 11 God is a righteous judge, a God who expresses his wrath every day.
- 12 God is already in action-- Sword honed on his whetstone, bow strung, arrow on the string,
- 12 If he does not relent, he will sharpen his sword; he will bend and string his bow.
- 13 Lethal weapons in hand, each arrow a flaming missile.
- 13 He has prepared his deadly weapons; he makes ready his flaming arrows.
- 14 Look at that guy! He had sex with sin, he's pregnant with evil. Oh, look! He's having the baby--a Lie-Baby!
- 14 He who is pregnant with evil and conceives trouble gives birth to disillusionment.
- 15 See that man shoveling day after day, digging, then concealing, his man-trap down that lonely stretch of road? Go back and look again--you'll see him in it headfirst, legs waving in the breeze.
- 15 He who digs a hole and scoops it out falls into the pit he has made.
- 16 That's what happens: mischief backfires; violence boomerangs.
- 16 The trouble he causes recoils on himself; his violence comes down on his own head.
- 17 I'm thanking God, who makes things right. I'm singing the fame of heaven-high GOD.

17 I will give thanks to the LORD because of his righteousness and will sing praise to the name of the LORD Most High.

Psalms 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. GOD, brilliant Lord, yours is a household name.
- 1 For the director of music. According to gittith. A psalm of David. O LORD, our Lord, how majestic is your name in all the earth! You have set your glory above the heavens.
- 2 Nursing infants gurgle choruses about you; toddlers shout the songs That drown out enemy talk, and silence atheist babble.
- 2 From the lips of children and infants you have ordained praise because of your enemies, to silence the foe and the avenger.
- 3 I look up at your macro-skies, dark and enormous, your handmade sky-jewelry, Moon and stars mounted in their settings.
- 3 When I consider your heavens, the work of your fingers, the moon and the stars, which you have set in place,
- 4 Then I look at my micro-self and wonder, Why do you bother with us? Why take a second look our way?
- 4 what is man that you are mindful of him, the son of man that you care for him?
- 5 Yet we've so narrowly missed being gods, bright with Eden's dawn light.
- 5 You made him a little lower than the heavenly beings and crowned him with glory and honor.
- 6 You put us in charge of your handcrafted world, repeated to us your Genesis-charge,
- 6 You made him ruler over the works of your hands; you put everything under his feet:
- 7 Made us lords of sheep and cattle, even animals out in the wild,
- 7 all flocks and herds, and the beasts of the field,
- 8 Birds flying and fish swimming, whales singing in the ocean deeps.
- 8 the birds of the air, and the fish of the sea, all that swim the paths of the seas.
- 9 GOD, brilliant Lord, your name echoes around the world.

9 O LORD, our Lord, how majestic is your name in all the earth!

Psalms 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. I'm thanking you, GOD, from a full heart, I'm writing the book on your wonders.
- 1 For the director of music. To the tune of "The Death of the Son." A psalm of David. I will praise you, O LORD, with all my heart; I will tell of all your wonders.
- 2 I'm whistling, laughing, and jumping for joy; I'm singing your song, High God.
- 2 I will be glad and rejoice in you; I will sing praise to your name, O Most High.
- 3 The day my enemies turned tail and ran, they stumbled on you and fell on their faces.
- 3 My enemies turn back; they stumble and perish before you.
- 4 You took over and set everything right; when I needed you, you were there, taking charge.
- 4 For you have upheld my right and my cause; you have sat on your throne, judging righteously.
- 5 You blow the whistle on godless nations; you throw dirty players out of the game, wipe their names right off the roster.
- 5 You have rebuked the nations and destroyed the wicked; you have blotted out their name for ever and ever.
- 6 Enemies disappear from the sidelines, their reputation trashed, their names erased from the halls of fame.
- 6 Endless ruin has overtaken the enemy, you have uprooted their cities; even the memory of them has perished.
- 7 GOD holds the high center, he sees and sets the world's mess right.
- 7 The LORD reigns forever; he has established his throne for judgment.
- 8 He decides what is right for us earthlings, gives people their just deserts.
- 8 He will judge the world in righteousness; he will govern the peoples with justice.
- 9 GOD's a safe-house for the battered, a sanctuary during bad times.

9 The LORD is a refuge for the oppressed, a stronghold in times of trouble.
10 The moment you arrive, you relax; you're never sorry you knocked.
10 Those who know your name will trust in you, for you, LORD, have never forsaken those who seek you.
11 Sing your songs to Zion-dwelling GOD, tell his stories to everyone you meet:
11 Sing praises to the LORD, enthroned in Zion; proclaim among the nations what he has done.
12 How he tracks down killers yet keeps his eye on us, registers every whimper and moan.
12 For he who avenges blood remembers; he does not ignore the cry of the afflicted.
13 Be kind to me, GOD; I've been kicked around long enough. Once you've pulled me back from the gates of death,
13 O LORD, see how my enemies persecute me! Have mercy and lift me up from the gates of death,
14 I'll write the book on Hallelujahs; on the corner of Main and First I'll hold a street meeting; I'll be the song leader; we'll fill the air with salvation songs.
14 that I may declare your praises in the gates of the Daughter of Zion and there rejoice in your salvation.
15 They're trapped, those godless countries, in the very snares they set, Their feet all tangled in the net they spread.
15 The nations have fallen into the pit they have dug; their feet are caught in the net they have hidden.
16 They have no excuse; the way God works is well-known. The cunning machinery made by the wicked has maimed their own hands.
16 The LORD is known by his justice; the wicked are ensnared by the work of their hands. Higgsion. Selah
17 The wicked bought a one-way ticket to hell.
17 The wicked return to the grave, all the nations that forget God.
18 No longer will the poor be nameless-- no more humiliation for the humble.
18 But the needy will not always be forgotten, nor the hope of the afflicted ever perish.

- 19 Up, GOD! Aren't you fed up with their empty strutting? Expose these grand pretensions!
- 19 Arise, O LORD, let not man triumph; let the nations be judged in your presence.
- 20 Shake them up, GOD! Show them how silly they look.
- 20 Strike them with terror, O LORD; let the nations know they are but men. Selah

Psalms 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD, are you avoiding me? Where are you when I need you?
- 1 Why, O LORD, do you stand far off? Why do you hide yourself in times of trouble?
- 2 Full of hot air, the wicked are hot on the trail of the poor. Trip them up, tangle them up in their fine-tuned plots.
- 2 In his arrogance the wicked man hunts down the weak, who are caught in the schemes he devises.
- 3 The wicked are windbags, the swindlers have foul breath.
- 3 He boasts of the cravings of his heart; he blesses the greedy and reviles the LORD.
- 4 The wicked snub GOD, their noses stuck high in the air. Their graffiti are scrawled on the walls: "Catch us if you can!" "God is dead."
- 4 In his pride the wicked does not seek him; in all his thoughts there is no room for God.
- 5 They care nothing for what you think; if you get in their way, they blow you off.
- 5 His ways are always prosperous; he is haughty and your laws are far from him; he sneers at all his enemies.
- 6 They live (they think) a charmed life: "We can't go wrong. This is our lucky year!"
- 6 He says to himself, "Nothing will shake me; I'll always be happy and never have trouble."
- 7 They carry a mouthful of hexes, their tongues spit venom like adders.

- 7 His mouth is full of curses and lies and threats; trouble and evil are under his tongue.
- 8 They hide behind ordinary people, then pounce on their victims.
- 8 He lies in wait near the villages; from ambush he murders the innocent, watching in secret for his victims.
- 9 They mark the luckless, then wait like a hunter in a blind; When the poor wretch wanders too close, they stab him in the back.
- 9 He lies in wait like a lion in cover; he lies in wait to catch the helpless; he catches the helpless and drags them off in his net.
- 10 The hapless fool is kicked to the ground, the unlucky victim is brutally axed.
- 10 His victims are crushed, they collapse; they fall under his strength.
- 11 He thinks God has dumped him, he's sure that God is indifferent to his plight.
- 11 He says to himself, "God has forgotten; he covers his face and never sees."
- 12 Time to get up, GOD--get moving. The luckless think they're Godforsaken.
- 12 Arise, LORD! Lift up your hand, O God. Do not forget the helpless.
- 13 They wonder why the wicked scorn God and get away with it, Why the wicked are so cocksure they'll never come up for audit.
- 13 Why does the wicked man revile God? Why does he say to himself, "He won't call me to account"?
- 14 But you know all about it-- the contempt, the abuse. I dare to believe that the luckless will get lucky someday in you. You won't let them down: orphans won't be orphans forever.
- 14 But you, O God, do see trouble and grief; you consider it to take it in hand. The victim commits himself to you; you are the helper of the fatherless.
- 15 Break the wicked right arms, break all the evil left arms. Search and destroy every sign of crime.
- 15 Break the arm of the wicked and evil man; call him to account for his wickedness that would not be found out.
- 16 GOD's grace and order wins; godlessness loses.
- 16 The LORD is King for ever and ever; the nations will perish from his land.

- 17 The victim's faint pulse picks up; the hearts of the hopeless pump red blood as you put your ear to their lips.
- 17 You hear, O LORD, the desire of the afflicted; you encourage them, and you listen to their cry,
- 18 Orphans get parents, the homeless get homes. The reign of terror is over, the rule of the gang lords is ended.
- 18 defending the fatherless and the oppressed, in order that man, who is of the earth, may terrify no more.

Psalms 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. I've already run for dear life straight to the arms of GOD. So why would I run away now when you say, "Run to the mountains;
- 1 For the director of music. Of David. In the LORD I take refuge. How then can you say to me: "Flee like a bird to your mountain.
- 2 the evil bows are bent, the wicked arrows Aimed to shoot under cover of darkness at every heart open to God.
- 2 For look, the wicked bend their bows; they set their arrows against the strings to shoot from the shadows at the upright in heart.
- 3 The bottom's dropped out of the country; good people don't have a chance"?
- 3 When the foundations are being destroyed, what can the righteous do?"
- 4 But GOD hasn't moved to the mountains; his holy address hasn't changed. He's in charge, as always, his eyes taking everything in, his eyelids Unblinking, examining Adam's unruly brood inside and out, not missing a thing.
- 4 The LORD is in his holy temple; the LORD is on his heavenly throne. He observes the sons of men; his eyes examine them.
- 5 He tests the good and the bad alike; if anyone cheats, God's outraged.
- 5 The LORD examines the righteous, but the wicked and those who love violence his soul hates.
- 6 Fail the test and you're out, out in a hail of firestones, Drinking from a canteen filled with hot desert wind.

- 6 On the wicked he will rain fiery coals and burning sulfur; a scorching wind will be their lot.
- 7 GOD's business is putting things right; he loves getting the lines straight, Setting us straight. Once we're standing tall, we can look him straight in the eye.
- 7 For the LORD is righteous, he loves justice; upright men will see his face.

Psalms 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Quick, GOD, I need your helping hand! The last decent person just went down, All the friends I depended on gone.
- 1 For the director of music. According to sheminith. A psalm of David. Help, LORD, for the godly are no more; the faithful have vanished from among men.
- 2 Everyone talks in lie language; Lies slide off their oily lips. They doubletalk with forked tongues.
- 2 Everyone lies to his neighbor; their flattering lips speak with deception.
- 3 Slice their lips off their faces! Pull The braggart tongues from their mouths!
- 3 May the LORD cut off all flattering lips and every boastful tongue
- 4 I'm tired of hearing, "We can talk anyone into anything! Our lips manage the world."
- 4 that says, "We will triumph with our tongues; we own our lips--who is our master?"
- 5 Into the hovels of the poor, Into the dark streets where the homeless groan, God speaks: "I've had enough; I'm on my way To heal the ache in the heart of the wretched."
- 5 Because of the oppression of the weak and the groaning of the needy, I will now arise, says the LORD. "I will protect them from those who malign them."
- 6 God's words are pure words, Pure silver words refined seven times In the fires of his word-kiln, Pure on earth as well as in heaven.

- 6 And the words of the LORD are flawless, like silver refined in a furnace of clay, purified seven times.
- 7 GOD, keep us safe from their lies, From the wicked who stalk us with lies,
- 7 O LORD, you will keep us safe and protect us from such people forever.
- 8 From the wicked who collect honors For their wonderful lies.
- 8 The wicked freely strut about when what is vile is honored among men.

Psalms 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Long enough, GOD-- you've ignored me long enough. I've looked at the back of your head long enough.
- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. How long, O LORD? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me?
- 2 Long enough I've carried this ton of trouble, lived with a stomach full of pain. Long enough my arrogant enemies have looked down their noses at me.
- 2 How long must I wrestle with my thoughts and every day have sorrow in my heart? How long will my enemy triumph over me?
- 3 Take a good look at me, GOD, my God; I want to look life in the eye,
- 3 Look on me and answer, O LORD my God. Give light to my eyes, or I will sleep in death;
- 4 So no enemy can get the best of me or laugh when I fall on my face.
- 4 my enemy will say, "I have overcome him," and my foes will rejoice when I fall.
- 5 I've thrown myself headlong into your arms-- I'm celebrating your rescue.
- 5 But I trust in your unfailing love; my heart rejoices in your salvation.
- 6 I'm singing at the top of my lungs, I'm so full of answered prayers.
- 6 I will sing to the LORD, for he has been good to me.

Psalms 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Bilious and bloated, they gas, "God is gone." Their words are poison gas, fouling the air; they poison Rivers and skies; thistles are their cash crop.
- 1 For the director of music. Of David. The fool says in his heart, "There is no God." They are corrupt, their deeds are vile; there is no one who does good.
- 2 GOD sticks his head out of heaven. He looks around. He's looking for someone not stupid-- one man, even, God-expectant, just one God-ready woman.
- 2 The LORD looks down from heaven on the sons of men to see if there are any who understand, any who seek God.
- 3 He comes up empty. A string of zeros. Useless, unshepherded Sheep, taking turns pretending to be Shepherd. The ninety and nine follow their fellow.
- 3 All have turned aside, they have together become corrupt; there is no one who does good, not even one.
- 4 Don't they know anything, all these impostors? Don't they know they can't get away with this-- Treating people like a fast-food meal over which they're too busy to pray?
- 4 Will evildoers never learn-- those who devour my people as men eat bread and who do not call on the LORD?
- 5 Night is coming for them, and nightmares, for God takes the side of victims.
- 5 There they are, overwhelmed with dread, for God is present in the company of the righteous.
- 6 Do you think you can mess with the dreams of the poor? You can't, for God makes their dreams come true.
- 6 You evildoers frustrate the plans of the poor, but the LORD is their refuge.
- 7 Is there anyone around to save Israel? Yes. God is around; GOD turns life around. Turned-around Jacob skips rope, turned-around Israel sings laughter.
- 7 Oh, that salvation for Israel would come out of Zion! When the LORD restores the fortunes of his people, let Jacob rejoice and Israel be glad!

Psalms 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. GOD, who gets invited to dinner at your place? How do we get on your guest list?
- 1 A psalm of David. LORD, who may dwell in your sanctuary? Who may live on your holy hill?
- 2 "Walk straight, act right, tell the truth.
- 2 He whose walk is blameless and who does what is righteous, who speaks the truth from his heart
- 3 "Don't hurt your friend, don't blame your neighbor;
- 3 and has no slander on his tongue, who does his neighbor no wrong and casts no slur on his fellowman,
- 4 despise the despicable. "Keep your word even when it costs you,
- 4 who despises a vile man but honors those who fear the LORD, who keeps his oath even when it hurts,
- 5 make an honest living, never take a bribe. "You'll never get blacklisted if you live like this."
- 5 who lends his money without usury and does not accept a bribe against the innocent. He who does these things will never be shaken.

Psalms 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David song. Keep me safe, O God, I've run for dear life to you.
- 1 A miktam of David. Keep me safe, O God, for in you I take refuge.
- 2 I say to GOD, "Be my Lord!" Without you, nothing makes sense.
- 2 I said to the LORD, "You are my Lord; apart from you I have no good thing."
- 3 And these God-chosen lives all around-- what splendid friends they make!
- 3 As for the saints who are in the land, they are the glorious ones in whom is all my delight.

- 4 Don't just go shopping for a god. Gods are not for sale. I swear I'll never treat god-names like brand-names.
- 4 The sorrows of those will increase who run after other gods. I will not pour out their libations of blood or take up their names on my lips.
- 5 My choice is you, GOD, first and only. And now I find I'm your choice!
- 5 LORD, you have assigned me my portion and my cup; you have made my lot secure.
- 6 You set me up with a house and yard. And then you made me your heir!
- 6 The boundary lines have fallen for me in pleasant places; surely I have a delightful inheritance.
- 7 The wise counsel GOD gives when I'm awake is confirmed by my sleeping heart.
- 7 I will praise the LORD, who counsels me; even at night my heart instructs me.
- 8 Day and night I'll stick with GOD; I've got a good thing going and I'm not letting go.
- 8 I have set the LORD always before me. Because he is at my right hand, I will not be shaken.
- 9 I'm happy from the inside out, and from the outside in, I'm firmly formed.
- 9 Therefore my heart is glad and my tongue rejoices; my body also will rest secure,
- 10 You canceled my ticket to hell-- that's not my destination!
- 10 because you will not abandon me to the grave, nor will you let your Holy One see decay.
- 11 Now you've got my feet on the life path, all radiant from the shining of your face. Ever since you took my hand, I'm on the right way.
- 11 You have made known to me the path of life; you will fill me with joy in your presence, with eternal pleasures at your right hand.

Psalms 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David prayer. Listen while I build my case, GOD, the most honest prayer you'll ever hear.

- 1 A prayer of David. Hear, O LORD, my righteous plea; listen to my cry.
Give ear to my prayer-- it does not rise from deceitful lips.
- 2 Show the world I'm innocent-- in your heart you know I am.
- 2 May my vindication come from you; may your eyes see what is right.
- 3 Go ahead, examine me from inside out, surprise me in the middle of the night-- You'll find I'm just what I say I am. My words don't run loose.
- 3 Though you probe my heart and examine me at night, though you test me, you will find nothing; I have resolved that my mouth will not sin.
- 4 I'm not trying to get my way in the world's way. I'm trying to get your way, your Word's way.
- 4 As for the deeds of men-- by the word of your lips I have kept myself from the ways of the violent.
- 5 I'm staying on your trail; I'm putting one foot In front of the other. I'm not giving up.
- 5 My steps have held to your paths; my feet have not slipped.
- 6 I call to you, God, because I'm sure of an answer. So---answer! bend your ear! listen sharp!
- 6 I call on you, O God, for you will answer me; give ear to me and hear my prayer.
- 7 Paint grace-graffiti on the fences; take in your frightened children who Are running from the neighborhood bullies straight to you.
- 7 Show the wonder of your great love, you who save by your right hand those who take refuge in you from their foes.
- 8 Keep your eye on me; hide me under your cool wing feathers
- 8 Keep me as the apple of your eye; hide me in the shadow of your wings
- 9 From the wicked who are out to get me, from mortal enemies closing in.
- 9 from the wicked who assail me, from my mortal enemies who surround me.
- 10 Their hearts are hard as nails, their mouths blast hot air.
- 10 They close up their callous hearts, and their mouths speak with arrogance.
- 11 They are after me, nipping my heels, determined to bring me down,
- 11 They have tracked me down, they now surround me, with eyes alert, to throw me to the ground.
- 12 Lions ready to rip me apart, young lions poised to pounce.
- 12 They are like a lion hungry for prey, like a great lion crouching in cover.

- 13 Up, GOD: beard them! break them! By your sword, free me from their clutches;
- 13 Rise up, O LORD, confront them, bring them down; rescue me from the wicked by your sword.
- 14 Barehanded, GOD, break these mortals, these flat-earth people who can't think beyond today. I'd like to see their bellies swollen with famine food, The weeds they've sown harvested and baked into famine bread, With second helpings for their children and crusts for their babies to chew on.
- 14 O LORD, by your hand save me from such men, from men of this world whose reward is in this life. You still the hunger of those you cherish; their sons have plenty, and they store up wealth for their children.
- 15 And me? I plan on looking you full in the face. When I get up, I'll see your full stature and live heaven on earth. A David song, which he sang to God after being saved from all his enemies and from Saul.
- 15 And I--in righteousness I will see your face; when I awake, I will be satisfied with seeing your likeness.

Psalms 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 I love you, GOD-- you make me strong.
- 1 For the director of music. Of David the servant of the LORD. He sang to the LORD the words of this song when the LORD delivered him from the hand of all his enemies and from the hand of Saul. He said: I love you, O LORD, my strength.
- 2 GOD is bedrock under my feet, the castle in which I live, my rescuing knight. My God--the high crag where I run for dear life, hiding behind the boulders, safe in the granite hideout.
- 2 The LORD is my rock, my fortress and my deliverer; my God is my rock, in whom I take refuge. He is my shield and the horn of my salvation, my stronghold.
- 3 I sing to GOD, the Praise-Lofty, and find myself safe and saved.
- 3 I call to the LORD, who is worthy of praise, and I am saved from my enemies.

- 4 The hangman's noose was tight at my throat; devil waters rushed over me.
- 4 The cords of death entangled me; the torrents of destruction overwhelmed me.
- 5 Hell's ropes cinched me tight; death traps barred every exit.
- 5 The cords of the grave coiled around me; the snares of death confronted me.
- 6 A hostile world! I call to GOD, I cry to God to help me. From his palace he hears my call; my cry brings me right into his presence-- a private audience!
- 6 In my distress I called to the LORD; I cried to my God for help. From his temple he heard my voice; my cry came before him, into his ears.
- 7 Earth wobbles and lurches; huge mountains shake like leaves, Quake like aspen leaves because of his rage.
- 7 The earth trembled and quaked, and the foundations of the mountains shook; they trembled because he was angry.
- 8 His nostrils flare, bellowing smoke; his mouth spits fire. Tongues of fire dart in and out;
- 8 Smoke rose from his nostrils; consuming fire came from his mouth, burning coals blazed out of it.
- 9 he lowers the sky. He steps down; under his feet an abyss opens up.
- 9 He parted the heavens and came down; dark clouds were under his feet.
- 10 He's riding a winged creature, swift on wind-wings.
- 10 He mounted the cherubim and flew; he soared on the wings of the wind.
- 11 Now he's wrapped himself in a trenchcoat of black-cloud darkness.
- 11 He made darkness his covering, his canopy around him-- the dark rain clouds of the sky.
- 12 But his cloud-brightness bursts through, spraying hailstones and fireballs.
- 12 Out of the brightness of his presence clouds advanced, with hailstones and bolts of lightning.
- 13 Then GOD thundered out of heaven; the High God gave a great shout, spraying hailstones and fireballs.
- 13 The LORD thundered from heaven; the voice of the Most High resounded.
- 14 God shoots his arrows--pandemonium! He hurls his lightnings--a rout!

14 He shot his arrows and scattered the enemies, great bolts of lightning and routed them.

15 The secret sources of ocean are exposed, the hidden depths of earth lie uncovered The moment you roar in protest, let loose your hurricane anger.

15 The valleys of the sea were exposed and the foundations of the earth laid bare at your rebuke, O LORD, at the blast of breath from your nostrils.

16 But me he caught--reached all the way from sky to sea; he pulled me out Of that ocean of hate,

16 He reached down from on high and took hold of me; he drew me out of deep waters.

17 that enemy chaos, the void in which I was drowning.

17 He rescued me from my powerful enemy, from my foes, who were too strong for me.

18 They hit me when I was down, but GOD stuck by me.

18 They confronted me in the day of my disaster, but the LORD was my support.

19 He stood me up on a wide-open field; I stood there saved--surprised to be loved!

19 He brought me out into a spacious place; he rescued me because he delighted in me.

20 GOD made my life complete when I placed all the pieces before him. When I got my act together, he gave me a fresh start.

20 The LORD has dealt with me according to my righteousness; according to the cleanness of my hands he has rewarded me.

21 Now I'm alert to GOD's ways; I don't take God for granted.

21 For I have kept the ways of the LORD; I have not done evil by turning from my God.

22 Every day I review the ways he works; I try not to miss a trick.

22 All his laws are before me; I have not turned away from his decrees.

23 I feel put back together, and I'm watching my step.

23 I have been blameless before him and have kept myself from sin.

24 GOD rewrote the text of my life when I opened the book of my heart to his eyes.

24 The LORD has rewarded me according to my righteousness, according
to the cleanness of my hands in his sight.

25 The good people taste your goodness, The whole people taste your
health,

25 To the faithful you show yourself faithful, to the blameless you show
yourself blameless,

26 The true people taste your truth, The bad ones can't figure you out.

26 to the pure you show yourself pure, but to the crooked you show
yourself shrewd.

27 You take the side of the down-and-out, But the stuck-up you take down
a peg.

27 You save the humble but bring low those whose eyes are haughty.

28 Suddenly, GOD, you floodlight my life; I'm blazing with glory, God's
glory!

28 You, O LORD, keep my lamp burning; my God turns my darkness into
light.

29 I smash the bands of marauders, I vault the highest fences.

29 With your help I can advance against a troop; with my God I can scale a
wall.

30 What a God! His road stretches straight and smooth. Every GOD-
direction is road-tested. Everyone who runs toward him Makes it.

30 As for God, his way is perfect; the word of the LORD is flawless. He is
a shield for all who take refuge in him.

31 Is there any god like GOD? Are we not at bedrock?

31 For who is God besides the LORD? And who is the Rock except our
God?

32 Is not this the God who armed me, then aimed me in the right direction?

32 It is God who arms me with strength and makes my way perfect.

33 Now I run like a deer; I'm king of the mountain.

33 He makes my feet like the feet of a deer; he enables me to stand on the
heights.

34 He shows me how to fight; I can bend a bronze bow!

34 He trains my hands for battle; my arms can bend a bow of bronze.

35 You protect me with salvation-armor; you hold me up with a firm hand,
caress me with your gentle ways.

35 You give me your shield of victory, and your right hand sustains me;
you stoop down to make me great.

36 You cleared the ground under me so my footing was firm.

36 You broaden the path beneath me, so that my ankles do not turn.

37 When I chased my enemies I caught them; I didn't let go till they were
dead men.

37 I pursued my enemies and overtook them; I did not turn back till they
were destroyed.

38 I nailed them; they were down for good; then I walked all over them.

38 I crushed them so that they could not rise; they fell beneath my feet.

39 You armed me well for this fight, you smashed the upstarts.

39 You armed me with strength for battle; you made my adversaries bow at
my feet.

40 You made my enemies turn tail, and I wiped out the haters.

40 You made my enemies turn their backs in flight, and I destroyed my
foes.

41 They cried "uncle" but Uncle didn't come; They yelled for GOD and got
no for an answer.

41 They cried for help, but there was no one to save them-- to the LORD,
but he did not answer.

42 I ground them to dust; they gusted in the wind. I threw them out, like
garbage in the gutter.

42 I beat them as fine as dust borne on the wind; I poured them out like
mud in the streets.

43 You rescued me from a squabbling people; you made me a leader of
nations. People I'd never heard of served me;

43 You have delivered me from the attacks of the people; you have made
me the head of nations; people I did not know are subject to me.

44 the moment they got wind of me they listened. The foreign devils gave
up;

44 As soon as they hear me, they obey me; foreigners cringe before me.

45 they came on their bellies, crawling from their hideouts.

45 They all lose heart; they come trembling from their strongholds.

46 Live, GOD! Blessings from my Rock, my free and freeing God,
towering!

46 The LORD lives! Praise be to my Rock! Exalted be God my Savior!

- 47 This God set things right for me and shut up the people who talked back.
- 47 He is the God who avenges me, who subdues nations under me,
- 48 He rescued me from enemy anger, he pulled me from the grip of upstarts, He saved me from the bullies.
- 48 who saves me from my enemies. You exalted me above my foes; from violent men you rescued me.
- 49 That's why I'm thanking you, GOD, all over the world. That's why I'm singing songs that rhyme your name.
- 49 Therefore I will praise you among the nations, O LORD; I will sing praises to your name.
- 50 God's king takes the trophy; God's chosen is beloved. I mean David and all his children-- always.
- 50 He gives his king great victories; he shows unfailing kindness to his anointed, to David and his descendants forever.

Psalms 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. God's glory is on tour in the skies, God-craft on exhibit across the horizon.
- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. The heavens declare the glory of God; the skies proclaim the work of his hands.
- 2 Madame Day holds classes every morning, Professor Night lectures each evening.
- 2 Day after day they pour forth speech; night after night they display knowledge.
- 3 Their words aren't heard, their voices aren't recorded,
- 3 There is no speech or language where their voice is not heard.
- 4 But their silence fills the earth: unspoken truth is spoken everywhere. God makes a huge dome for the sun--a superdome!
- 4 Their voice goes out into all the earth, their words to the ends of the world. In the heavens he has pitched a tent for the sun,
- 5 The morning sun's a new husband leaping from his honeymoon bed, The daybreaking sun an athlete racing to the tape.

- 5 which is like a bridegroom coming forth from his pavilion, like a champion rejoicing to run his course.
- 6 That's how God's Word vaults across the skies from sunrise to sunset, Melting ice, scorching deserts, warming hearts to faith.
- 6 It rises at one end of the heavens and makes its circuit to the other; nothing is hidden from its heat.
- 7 The revelation of GOD is whole and pulls our lives together. The signposts of GOD are clear and point out the right road.
- 7 The law of the LORD is perfect, reviving the soul. The statutes of the LORD are trustworthy, making wise the simple.
- 8 The life-maps of GOD are right, showing the way to joy. The directions of GOD are plain and easy on the eyes.
- 8 The precepts of the LORD are right, giving joy to the heart. The commands of the LORD are radiant, giving light to the eyes.
- 9 GOD's reputation is twenty-four-carat gold, with a lifetime guarantee. The decisions of GOD are accurate down to the nth degree.
- 9 The fear of the LORD is pure, enduring forever. The ordinances of the LORD are sure and altogether righteous.
- 10 God's Word is better than a diamond, better than a diamond set between emeralds. You'll like it better than strawberries in spring, better than red, ripe strawberries.
- 10 They are more precious than gold, than much pure gold; they are sweeter than honey, than honey from the comb.
- 11 There's more: God's Word warns us of danger and directs us to hidden treasure.
- 11 By them is your servant warned; in keeping them there is great reward.
- 12 Otherwise how will we find our way? Or know when we play the fool?
- 12 Who can discern his errors? Forgive my hidden faults.
- 13 Clean the slate, God, so we can start the day fresh! Keep me from stupid sins, from thinking I can take over your work; Then I can start this day sun-washed, scrubbed clean of the grime of sin.
- 13 Keep your servant also from willful sins; may they not rule over me. Then will I be blameless, innocent of great transgression.
- 14 These are the words in my mouth; these are what I chew on and pray. Accept them when I place them on the morning altar, O God, my Altar-Rock, God, Priest-of-My-Altar.

14 May the words of my mouth and the meditation of my heart be pleasing in your sight, O LORD, my Rock and my Redeemer.

Psalms 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. GOD answer you on the day you crash, The name God-of-Jacob put you out of harm's reach,
- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. May the LORD answer you when you are in distress; may the name of the God of Jacob protect you.
- 2 Send reinforcements from Holy Hill, Dispatch from Zion fresh supplies,
- 2 May he send you help from the sanctuary and grant you support from Zion.
- 3 Exclaim over your offerings, Celebrate your sacrifices,
- 3 May he remember all your sacrifices and accept your burnt offerings. Selah
- 4 Give you what your heart desires, Accomplish your plans.
- 4 May he give you the desire of your heart and make all your plans succeed.
- 5 When you win, we plan to raise the roof and lead the parade with our banners. May all your wishes come true!
- 5 We will shout for joy when you are victorious and will lift up our banners in the name of our God. May the LORD grant all your requests.
- 6 That clinches it--help's coming, an answer's on the way, everything's going to work out.
- 6 Now I know that the LORD saves his anointed; he answers him from his holy heaven with the saving power of his right hand.
- 7 See those people polishing their chariots, and those others grooming their horses? But we're making garlands for GOD our God.
- 7 Some trust in chariots and some in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God.
- 8 The chariots will rust, those horses pull up lame-- and we'll be on our feet, standing tall.
- 8 They are brought to their knees and fall, but we rise up and stand firm.
- 9 Make the king a winner, GOD; the day we call, give us your answer.

9 O LORD, save the king! Answer us when we call!

Psalms 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Your strength, GOD, is the king's strength. Helped, he's hollering Hosannas.
- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. O LORD, the king rejoices in your strength. How great is his joy in the victories you give!
- 2 You gave him exactly what he wanted; you didn't hold back.
- 2 You have granted him the desire of his heart and have not withheld the request of his lips. Selah
- 3 You filled his arms with gifts; you gave him a right royal welcome.
- 3 You welcomed him with rich blessings and placed a crown of pure gold on his head.
- 4 He wanted a good life; you gave it to him, and then made it a long life as a bonus.
- 4 He asked you for life, and you gave it to him-- length of days, for ever and ever.
- 5 You lifted him high and bright as a cumulus cloud, then dressed him in rainbow colors.
- 5 Through the victories you gave, his glory is great; you have bestowed on him splendor and majesty.
- 6 You pile blessings on him; you make him glad when you smile.
- 6 Surely you have granted him eternal blessings and made him glad with the joy of your presence.
- 7 Is it any wonder the king loves GOD? that he's sticking with the Best?
- 7 For the king trusts in the LORD; through the unfailing love of the Most High he will not be shaken.
- 8 With a fistful of enemies in one hand and a fistful of haters in the other,
- 8 Your hand will lay hold on all your enemies; your right hand will seize your foes.
- 9 You radiate with such brilliance that they cringe as before a furnace. Now the furnace swallows them whole, the fire eats them alive!

- 9 At the time of your appearing you will make them like a fiery furnace. In his wrath the LORD will swallow them up, and his fire will consume them.
- 10 You purge the earth of their progeny, you wipe the slate clean.
- 10 You will destroy their descendants from the earth, their posterity from mankind.
- 11 All their evil schemes, the plots they cook up, have fizzled--every one.
- 11 Though they plot evil against you and devise wicked schemes, they cannot succeed;
- 12 You sent them packing; they couldn't face you.
- 12 for you will make them turn their backs when you aim at them with drawn bow.
- 13 Show your strength, GOD, so no one can miss it. We are out singing the good news!
- 13 Be exalted, O LORD, in your strength; we will sing and praise your might.

Psalms 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. God, God . . . my God! Why did you dump me miles from nowhere?
- 1 For the director of music. To the tune of "The Doe of the Morning." A psalm of David. My God, my God, why have you forsaken me? Why are you so far from saving me, so far from the words of my groaning?
- 2 Doubled up with pain, I call to God all the day long. No answer. Nothing. I keep at it all night, tossing and turning.
- 2 O my God, I cry out by day, but you do not answer, by night, and am not silent.
- 3 And you! Are you indifferent, above it all, leaning back on the cushions of Israel's praise?
- 3 Yet you are enthroned as the Holy One; you are the praise of Israel.
- 4 We know you were there for our parents:
- 4 In you our fathers put their trust; they trusted and you delivered them.

5 they cried for your help and you gave it; they trusted and lived a good life.

5 They cried to you and were saved; in you they trusted and were not disappointed.

6 And here I am, a nothing--an earthworm, something to step on, to squash.

6 But I am a worm and not a man, scorned by men and despised by the people.

7 Everyone pokes fun at me; they make faces at me, they shake their heads:

7 All who see me mock me; they hurl insults, shaking their heads:

8 "Let's see how GOD handles this one; since God likes him so much, let him help him!"

8 He trusts in the LORD; let the LORD rescue him. Let him deliver him, since he delights in him.

9 And to think you were midwife at my birth, setting me at my mother's breasts!

9 Yet you brought me out of the womb; you made me trust in you even at my mother's breast.

10 When I left the womb you cradled me; since the moment of birth you've been my God.

10 From birth I was cast upon you; from my mother's womb you have been my God.

11 Then you moved far away and trouble moved in next-door. I need a neighbor.

11 Do not be far from me, for trouble is near and there is no one to help.

12 Herds of bulls come at me, the raging bulls stampede,

12 Many bulls surround me; strong bulls of Bashan encircle me.

13 Horns lowered, nostrils flaring, like a herd of buffalo on the move.

13 Roaring lions tearing their prey open their mouths wide against me.

14 I'm a bucket kicked over and spilled, every joint in my body has been pulled apart. My heart is a blob of melted wax in my gut.

14 I am poured out like water, and all my bones are out of joint. My heart has turned to wax; it has melted away within me.

15 I'm dry as a bone, my tongue black and swollen. They have laid me out for burial in the dirt.

15 My strength is dried up like a potsherd, and my tongue sticks to the roof of my mouth; you lay me in the dust of death.

16 Now packs of wild dogs come at me; thugs gang up on me. They pin me down hand and foot,
16 Dogs have surrounded me; a band of evil men has encircled me, they have pierced my hands and my feet.
17 and lock me in a cage--a bag Of bones in a cage, stared at by every passerby.
17 I can count all my bones; people stare and gloat over me.
18 They take my wallet and the shirt off my back, and then throw dice for my clothes.
18 They divide my garments among them and cast lots for my clothing.
19 You, GOD--don't put off my rescue! Hurry and help me!
19 But you, O LORD, be not far off; O my Strength, come quickly to help me.
20 Don't let them cut my throat; don't let those mongrels devour me.
20 Deliver my life from the sword, my precious life from the power of the dogs.
21 If you don't show up soon, I'm done for--gored by the bulls, meat for the lions.
21 Rescue me from the mouth of the lions; save me from the horns of the wild oxen.
22 Here's the story I'll tell my friends when they come to worship, and punctuate it with Hallelujahs:
22 I will declare your name to my brothers; in the congregation I will praise you.
23 Shout Hallelujah, you God-worshippers; give glory, you sons of Jacob; adore him, you daughters of Israel.
23 You who fear the LORD, praise him! All you descendants of Jacob, honor him! Revere him, all you descendants of Israel!
24 He has never let you down, never looked the other way when you were being kicked around. He has never wandered off to do his own thing; he has been right there, listening.
24 For he has not despised or disdained the suffering of the afflicted one; he has not hidden his face from him but has listened to his cry for help.
25 Here in this great gathering for worship I have discovered this praise-life. And I'll do what I promised right here in front of the God-worshippers.

- 25 From you comes the theme of my praise in the great assembly; before those who fear you will I fulfill my vows.
- 26 Down-and-outers sit at GOD's table and eat their fill. Everyone on the hunt for God is here, praising him. "Live it up, from head to toe. Don't ever quit!"
- 26 The poor will eat and be satisfied; they who seek the LORD will praise him-- may your hearts live forever!
- 27 From the four corners of the earth people are coming to their senses, are running back to GOD. Long-lost families are falling on their faces before him.
- 27 All the ends of the earth will remember and turn to the LORD, and all the families of the nations will bow down before him,
- 28 GOD has taken charge; from now on he has the last word.
- 28 for dominion belongs to the LORD and he rules over the nations.
- 29 All the power-mongers are before him --worshiping! All the poor and powerless, too --worshiping! Along with those who never got it together --worshiping!
- 29 All the rich of the earth will feast and worship; all who go down to the dust will kneel before him-- those who cannot keep themselves alive.
- 30 Our children and their children will get in on this As the word is passed along from parent to child.
- 30 Posterity will serve him; future generations will be told about the Lord.
- 31 Babies not yet conceived will hear the good news-- that God does what he says.
- 31 They will proclaim his righteousness to a people yet unborn-- for he has done it.

Psalms 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. GOD, my shepherd! I don't need a thing.
- 1 A psalm of David. The LORD is my shepherd, I shall not be in want.
- 2 You have bedded me down in lush meadows, you find me quiet pools to drink from.

- 2 He makes me lie down in green pastures, he leads me beside quiet waters,
3 True to your word, you let me catch my breath and send me in the right direction.
3 he restores my soul. He guides me in paths of righteousness for his name's sake.
4 Even when the way goes through Death Valley, I'm not afraid when you walk at my side. Your trusty shepherd's crook makes me feel secure.
4 Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for you are with me; your rod and your staff, they comfort me.
5 You serve me a six-course dinner right in front of my enemies. You revive my drooping head; my cup brims with blessing.
5 You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies. You anoint my head with oil; my cup overflows.
6 Your beauty and love chase after me every day of my life. I'm back home in the house of GOD for the rest of my life.
6 Surely goodness and love will follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the house of the LORD forever.

Psalms 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. GOD claims Earth and everything in it, God claims World and all who live on it.
1 Of David. A psalm. The earth is the LORD's, and everything in it, the world, and all who live in it;
2 He built it on Ocean foundations, laid it out on River girders.
2 for he founded it upon the seas and established it upon the waters.
3 Who can climb Mount GOD? Who can scale the holy north-face?
3 Who may ascend the hill of the LORD? Who may stand in his holy place?
4 Only the clean-handed, only the pure-hearted; Men who won't cheat, women who won't seduce.
4 He who has clean hands and a pure heart, who does not lift up his soul to an idol or swear by what is false.

- 5 GOD is at their side; with GOD's help they make it.
5 He will receive blessing from the LORD and vindication from God his Savior.
6 This, Jacob, is what happens to God-seekers, God-questers.
6 Such is the generation of those who seek him, who seek your face, O God of Jacob. Selah
7 Wake up, you sleepyhead city! Wake up, you sleepyhead people! King-Glory is ready to enter.
7 Lift up your heads, O you gates; be lifted up, you ancient doors, that the King of glory may come in.
8 Who is this King-Glory? GOD, armed and battle-ready.
8 Who is this King of glory? The LORD strong and mighty, the LORD mighty in battle.
9 Wake up, you sleepyhead city! Wake up, you sleepyhead people! King-Glory is ready to enter.
9 Lift up your heads, O you gates; lift them up, you ancient doors, that the King of glory may come in.
10 Who is this King-Glory? GOD of the angel armies: he is King-Glory.
10 Who is he, this King of glory? The LORD Almighty-- he is the King of glory. Selah

Psalms 25

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. My head is high, GOD, held high;
1 Of David. To you, O LORD, I lift up my soul;
2 I'm looking to you, GOD; No hangdog skulking for me.
2 in you I trust, O my God. Do not let me be put to shame, nor let my enemies triumph over me.
3 I've thrown in my lot with you; You won't embarrass me, will you? Or let my enemies get the best of me? Don't embarrass any of us Who went out on a limb for you. It's the traitors who should be humiliated.
3 No one whose hope is in you will ever be put to shame, but they will be put to shame who are treacherous without excuse.
4 Show me how you work, GOD; School me in your ways.

- 4 Show me your ways, O LORD, teach me your paths;
5 Take me by the hand; Lead me down the path of truth. You are my Savior, aren't you?
5 guide me in your truth and teach me, for you are God my Savior, and my hope is in you all day long.
6 Mark the milestones of your mercy and love, GOD; Rebuild the ancient landmarks!
6 Remember, O LORD, your great mercy and love, for they are from of old.
7 Forget that I sowed wild oats; Mark me with your sign of love. Plan only the best for me, GOD!
7 Remember not the sins of my youth and my rebellious ways; according to your love remember me, for you are good, O LORD.
8 GOD is fair and just; He corrects the misdirected, Sends them in the right direction.
8 Good and upright is the LORD; therefore he instructs sinners in his ways.
9 He gives the rejects his hand, And leads them step-by-step.
9 He guides the humble in what is right and teaches them his way.
10 From now on every road you travel Will take you to GOD. Follow the Covenant signs; Read the charted directions.
10 All the ways of the LORD are loving and faithful for those who keep the demands of his covenant.
11 Keep up your reputation, GOD; Forgive my bad life; It's been a very bad life.
11 For the sake of your name, O LORD, forgive my iniquity, though it is great.
12 My question: What are God-worshippers like? Your answer: Arrows aimed at God's bull's-eye.
12 Who, then, is the man that fears the LORD? He will instruct him in the way chosen for him.
13 They settle down in a promising place; Their kids inherit a prosperous farm.
13 He will spend his days in prosperity, and his descendants will inherit the land.
14 God-friendship is for God-worshippers; They are the ones he confides in.

- 14 The LORD confides in those who fear him; he makes his covenant known to them.
- 15 If I keep my eyes on GOD, I won't trip over my own feet.
- 15 My eyes are ever on the LORD, for only he will release my feet from the snare.
- 16 Look at me and help me! I'm all alone and in big trouble.
- 16 Turn to me and be gracious to me, for I am lonely and afflicted.
- 17 My heart and kidneys are fighting each other; Call a truce to this civil war.
- 17 The troubles of my heart have multiplied; free me from my anguish.
- 18 Take a hard look at my life of hard labor, Then lift this ton of sin.
- 18 Look upon my affliction and my distress and take away all my sins.
- 19 Do you see how many people Have it in for me? How viciously they hate me?
- 19 See how my enemies have increased and how fiercely they hate me!
- 20 Keep watch over me and keep me out of trouble; Don't let me down when I run to you.
- 20 Guard my life and rescue me; let me not be put to shame, for I take refuge in you.
- 21 Use all your skill to put me together; I wait to see your finished product.
- 21 May integrity and uprightness protect me, because my hope is in you.
- 22 GOD, give your people a break From this run of bad luck.
- 22 Redeem Israel, O God, from all their troubles!

Psalms 26

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Clear my name, GOD; I've kept an honest shop. I've thrown in my lot with you, GOD, and I'm not budging.
- 1 Of David. Vindicate me, O LORD, for I have led a blameless life; I have trusted in the LORD without wavering.
- 2 Examine me, GOD, from head to foot, order your battery of tests. Make sure I'm fit inside and out
- 2 Test me, O LORD, and try me, examine my heart and my mind;

3 So I never lose sight of your love, But keep in step with you, never
missing a beat.
3 for your love is ever before me, and I walk continually in your truth.
4 I don't hang out with tricksters, I don't pal around with thugs;
4 I do not sit with deceitful men, nor do I consort with hypocrites;
5 I hate that pack of gangsters, I don't deal with double-dealers.
5 I abhor the assembly of evildoers and refuse to sit with the wicked.
6 I scrub my hands with purest soap, then join hands with the others in the
great circle, dancing around your altar, GOD,
6 I wash my hands in innocence, and go about your altar, O LORD,
7 Singing God-songs at the top of my lungs, telling God-stories.
7 proclaiming aloud your praise and telling of all your wonderful deeds.
8 GOD, I love living with you; your house glows with your glory.
8 I love the house where you live, O LORD, the place where your glory
dwells.
9 When it's time for spring cleaning, don't sweep me out with the quacks
and crooks,
9 Do not take away my soul along with sinners, my life with bloodthirsty
men,
10 Men with bags of dirty tricks, women with purses stuffed with bribe-
money.
10 in whose hands are wicked schemes, whose right hands are full of
bribes.
11 You know I've been aboveboard with you; now be aboveboard with me.
11 But I lead a blameless life; redeem me and be merciful to me.
12 I'm on the level with you, GOD; I bless you every chance I get.
12 My feet stand on level ground; in the great assembly I will praise the
LORD.

Psalms 27

MSG

NIV

1 A David psalm. Light, space, zest-- that's GOD! So, with him on my side
I'm fearless, afraid of no one and nothing.

- 1 Of David. The LORD is my light and my salvation-- whom shall I fear?
The LORD is the stronghold of my life-- of whom shall I be afraid?
- 2 When vandal hordes ride down ready to eat me alive, Those bullies and
toughs fall flat on their faces.
- 2 When evil men advance against me to devour my flesh, when my
enemies and my foes attack me, they will stumble and fall.
- 3 When besieged, I'm calm as a baby. When all hell breaks loose, I'm
collected and cool.
- 3 Though an army besiege me, my heart will not fear; though war break
out against me, even then will I be confident.
- 4 I'm asking GOD for one thing, only one thing: To live with him in his
house my whole life long. I'll contemplate his beauty; I'll study at his
feet.
- 4 One thing I ask of the LORD, this is what I seek: that I may dwell in the
house of the LORD all the days of my life, to gaze upon the beauty of
the LORD and to seek him in his temple.
- 5 That's the only quiet, secure place in a noisy world, The perfect getaway,
far from the buzz of traffic.
- 5 For in the day of trouble he will keep me safe in his dwelling; he will
hide me in the shelter of his tabernacle and set me high upon a rock.
- 6 God holds me head and shoulders above all who try to pull me down. I'm
headed for his place to offer anthems that will raise the roof! Already I'm
singing God-songs; I'm making music to GOD.
- 6 Then my head will be exalted above the enemies who surround me; at his
tabernacle will I sacrifice with shouts of joy; I will sing and make music
to the LORD.
- 7 Listen, GOD, I'm calling at the top of my lungs: "Be good to me! Answer
me!"
- 7 Hear my voice when I call, O LORD; be merciful to me and answer me.
- 8 When my heart whispered, "Seek God," my whole being replied, "I'm
seeking him!"
- 8 My heart says of you, "Seek his face!" Your face, LORD, I will seek.
- 9 Don't hide from me now! You've always been right there for me; don't
turn your back on me now. Don't throw me out, don't abandon me;
you've always kept the door open.

- 9 Do not hide your face from me, do not turn your servant away in anger; you have been my helper. Do not reject me or forsake me, O God my Savior.
- 10 My father and mother walked out and left me, but GOD took me in.
- 10 Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me.
- 11 Point me down your highway, GOD; direct me along a well-lighted street; show my enemies whose side you're on.
- 11 Teach me your way, O LORD; lead me in a straight path because of my oppressors.
- 12 Don't throw me to the dogs, those liars who are out to get me, filling the air with their threats.
- 12 Do not turn me over to the desire of my foes, for false witnesses rise up against me, breathing out violence.
- 13 I'm sure now I'll see God's goodness in the exuberant earth.
- 13 I am still confident of this: I will see the goodness of the LORD in the land of the living.
- 14 Stay with GOD! Take heart. Don't quit. I'll say it again: Stay with GOD.
- 14 Wait for the LORD; be strong and take heart and wait for the LORD.

Psalms 28

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Don't turn a deaf ear when I call you, GOD. If all I get from you is deafening silence, I'd be better off in the Black Hole.
- 1 Of David. To you I call, O LORD my Rock; do not turn a deaf ear to me. For if you remain silent, I will be like those who have gone down to the pit.
- 2 I'm letting you know what I need, calling out for help And lifting my arms toward your inner sanctum.
- 2 Hear my cry for mercy as I call to you for help, as I lift up my hands toward your Most Holy Place.
- 3 Don't shove me into the same jail cell with those crooks, With those who are full-time employees of evil.
- 3 Do not drag me away with the wicked, with those who do evil, who speak cordially with their neighbors but harbor malice in their hearts.

- 4 They talk a good line of "peace," then moonlight for the Devil. Pay them back for what they've done, for how bad they've been. Pay them back for their long hours in the Devil's workshop; Then cap it with a huge bonus.
- 4 Repay them for their deeds and for their evil work; repay them for what their hands have done and bring back upon them what they deserve.
- 5 Because they have no idea how God works or what he is up to, God will smash them to smithereens and walk away from the ruins.
- 5 Since they show no regard for the works of the LORD and what his hands have done, he will tear them down and never build them up again.
- 6 Blessed be GOD-- he heard me praying.
- 6 Praise be to the LORD, for he has heard my cry for mercy.
- 7 He proved he's on my side; I've thrown my lot in with him. Now I'm jumping for joy, and shouting and singing my thanks to him.
- 7 The LORD is my strength and my shield; my heart trusts in him, and I am helped. My heart leaps for joy and I will give thanks to him in song.
- 8 GOD is all strength for his people, ample refuge for his chosen leader;
- 8 The LORD is the strength of his people, a fortress of salvation for his anointed one.
- 9 Save your people and bless your heritage. Care for them; carry them like a good shepherd.
- 9 Save your people and bless your inheritance; be their shepherd and carry them forever.

Psalms 29

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Bravo, GOD, bravo! Gods and all angels shout, "Encore!"
- 1 A psalm of David. Ascribe to the LORD, O mighty ones, ascribe to the LORD glory and strength.
- 2 In awe before the glory, in awe before God's visible power. Stand at attention! Dress your best to honor him!
- 2 Ascribe to the LORD the glory due his name; worship the LORD in the splendor of his holiness.

- 3 GOD thunders across the waters, Brilliant, his voice and his face,
streaming brightness--GOD, across the flood waters.
- 3 The voice of the LORD is over the waters; the God of glory thunders, the
LORD thunders over the mighty waters.
- 4 GOD's thunder tympanic, GOD's thunder symphonic.
- 4 The voice of the LORD is powerful; the voice of the LORD is majestic.
- 5 GOD's thunder smashes cedars, GOD topples the northern cedars.
- 5 The voice of the LORD breaks the cedars; the LORD breaks in pieces the
cedars of Lebanon.
- 6 The mountain ranges skip like spring colts, The high ridges jump like
wild kid goats.
- 6 He makes Lebanon skip like a calf, Sirion like a young wild ox.
- 7 GOD's thunder spits fire.
- 7 The voice of the LORD strikes with flashes of lightning.
- 8 GOD thunders, the wilderness quakes; He makes the desert of Kadesh
shake.
- 8 The voice of the LORD shakes the desert; the LORD shakes the Desert
of Kadesh.
- 9 GOD's thunder sets the oak trees dancing A wild dance, whirling; the
pelting rain strips their branches. We fall to our knees--we call out,
"Glory!"
- 9 The voice of the LORD twists the oaks and strips the forests bare. And in
his temple all cry, "Glory!"
- 10 Above the floodwaters is GOD's throne from which his power flows,
from which he rules the world.
- 10 The LORD sits enthroned over the flood; the LORD is enthroned as
King forever.
- 11 GOD makes his people strong. GOD gives his people peace.
- 11 The LORD gives strength to his people; the LORD blesses his people
with peace.

Psalms 30

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. I give you all the credit, GOD-- you got me out of that mess, you didn't let my foes gloat.
- 1 A psalm. A song. For the dedication of the temple. Of David. I will exalt you, O LORD, for you lifted me out of the depths and did not let my enemies gloat over me.
- 2 GOD, my God, I yelled for help and you put me together.
- 2 O LORD my God, I called to you for help and you healed me.
- 3 GOD, you pulled me out of the grave, gave me another chance at life when I was down-and-out.
- 3 O LORD, you brought me up from the grave; you spared me from going down into the pit.
- 4 All you saints! Sing your hearts out to GOD! Thank him to his face!
- 4 Sing to the LORD, you saints of his; praise his holy name.
- 5 He gets angry once in a while, but across a lifetime there is only love. The nights of crying your eyes out give way to days of laughter.
- 5 For his anger lasts only a moment, but his favor lasts a lifetime; weeping may remain for a night, but rejoicing comes in the morning.
- 6 When things were going great I crowed, "I've got it made.
- 6 When I felt secure, I said, "I will never be shaken."
- 7 I'm GOD's favorite. He made me king of the mountain." Then you looked the other way and I fell to pieces.
- 7 O LORD, when you favored me, you made my mountain stand firm; but when you hid your face, I was dismayed.
- 8 I called out to you, GOD; I laid my case before you:
- 8 To you, O LORD, I called; to the Lord I cried for mercy:
- 9 "Can you sell me for a profit when I'm dead? auction me off at a cemetery yard sale? When I'm 'dust to dust' my songs and stories of you won't sell.
- 9 What gain is there in my destruction, in my going down into the pit? Will the dust praise you? Will it proclaim your faithfulness?
- 10 So listen! and be kind! Help me out of this!"
- 10 Hear, O LORD, and be merciful to me; O LORD, be my help."
- 11 You did it: you changed wild lament into whirling dance; You ripped off my black mourning band and decked me with wildflowers.
- 11 You turned my wailing into dancing; you removed my sackcloth and clothed me with joy,

- 12 I'm about to burst with song; I can't keep quiet about you. GOD, my God, I can't thank you enough.
- 12 that my heart may sing to you and not be silent. O LORD my God, I will give you thanks forever.

Psalms 31

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. I run to you, GOD; I run for dear life. Don't let me down! Take me seriously this time!
- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. In you, O LORD, I have taken refuge; let me never be put to shame; deliver me in your righteousness.
- 2 Get down on my level and listen, and please--no procrastination! Your granite cave a hiding place, your high cliff aerie a place of safety.
- 2 Turn your ear to me, come quickly to my rescue; be my rock of refuge, a strong fortress to save me.
- 3 You're my cave to hide in, my cliff to climb. Be my safe leader, be my true mountain guide.
- 3 Since you are my rock and my fortress, for the sake of your name lead and guide me.
- 4 Free me from hidden traps; I want to hide in you.
- 4 Free me from the trap that is set for me, for you are my refuge.
- 5 I've put my life in your hands. You won't drop me, you'll never let me down.
- 5 Into your hands I commit my spirit; redeem me, O LORD, the God of truth.
- 6 I hate all this silly religion, but you, GOD, I trust.
- 6 I hate those who cling to worthless idols; I trust in the LORD.
- 7 I'm leaping and singing in the circle of your love; you saw my pain, you disarmed my tormentors,
- 7 I will be glad and rejoice in your love, for you saw my affliction and knew the anguish of my soul.
- 8 You didn't leave me in their clutches but gave me room to breathe.

- 8 You have not handed me over to the enemy but have set my feet in a spacious place.
- 9 Be kind to me, GOD-- I'm in deep, deep trouble again. I've cried my eyes out; I feel hollow inside.
- 9 Be merciful to me, O LORD, for I am in distress; my eyes grow weak with sorrow, my soul and my body with grief.
- 10 My life leaks away, groan by groan; my years fade out in sighs. My troubles have worn me out, turned my bones to powder.
- 10 My life is consumed by anguish and my years by groaning; my strength fails because of my affliction, and my bones grow weak.
- 11 To my enemies I'm a monster; I'm ridiculed by the neighbors. My friends are horrified; they cross the street to avoid me.
- 11 Because of all my enemies, I am the utter contempt of my neighbors; I am a dread to my friends-- those who see me on the street flee from me.
- 12 They want to blot me from memory, forget me like a corpse in a grave, discard me like a broken dish in the trash.
- 12 I am forgotten by them as though I were dead; I have become like broken pottery.
- 13 The street-talk gossip has me "criminally insane"! Behind locked doors they plot how to ruin me for good.
- 13 For I hear the slander of many; there is terror on every side; they conspire against me and plot to take my life.
- 14 Desperate, I throw myself on you: you are my God!
- 14 But I trust in you, O LORD; I say, "You are my God."
- 15 Hour by hour I place my days in your hand, safe from the hands out to get me.
- 15 My times are in your hands; deliver me from my enemies and from those who pursue me.
- 16 Warm me, your servant, with a smile; save me because you love me.
- 16 Let your face shine on your servant; save me in your unfailing love.
- 17 Don't embarrass me by not showing up; I've given you plenty of notice. Embarrass the wicked, stand them up, leave them stupidly shaking their heads as they drift down to hell.
- 17 Let me not be put to shame, O LORD, for I have cried out to you; but let the wicked be put to shame and lie silent in the grave.

- 18 Gag those loudmouthed liars who heckle me, your follower, with jeers and catcalls.
- 18 Let their lying lips be silenced, for with pride and contempt they speak arrogantly against the righteous.
- 19 What a stack of blessing you have piled up for those who worship you, Ready and waiting for all who run to you to escape an unkind world.
- 19 How great is your goodness, which you have stored up for those who fear you, which you bestow in the sight of men on those who take refuge in you.
- 20 You hide them safely away from the opposition. As you slam the door on those oily, mocking faces, you silence the poisonous gossip.
- 20 In the shelter of your presence you hide them from the intrigues of men; in your dwelling you keep them safe from accusing tongues.
- 21 Blessed GOD! His love is the wonder of the world. Trapped by a siege,
- 21 Praise be to the LORD, for he showed his wonderful love to me when I was in a besieged city.
- 22 I panicked. "Out of sight, out of mind," I said. But you heard me say it, you heard and listened.
- 22 In my alarm I said, "I am cut off from your sight!" Yet you heard my cry for mercy when I called to you for help.
- 23 Love GOD, all you saints; GOD takes care of all who stay close to him, But he pays back in full those arrogant enough to go it alone.
- 23 Love the LORD, all his saints! The LORD preserves the faithful, but the proud he pays back in full.
- 24 Be brave. Be strong. Don't give up. Expect GOD to get here soon.
- 24 Be strong and take heart, all you who hope in the LORD.

Psalms 32

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Count yourself lucky, how happy you must be-- you get a fresh start, your slate's wiped clean.
- 1 Of David. A maskil. Blessed is he whose transgressions are forgiven, whose sins are covered.

- 2 Count yourself lucky-- GOD holds nothing against you and you're holding nothing back from him.
- 2 Blessed is the man whose sin the LORD does not count against him and in whose spirit is no deceit.
- 3 When I kept it all inside, my bones turned to powder, my words became daylong groans.
- 3 When I kept silent, my bones wasted away through my groaning all day long.
- 4 The pressure never let up; all the juices of my life dried up.
- 4 For day and night your hand was heavy upon me; my strength was sapped as in the heat of summer. Selah
- 5 Then I let it all out; I said, "I'll make a clean breast of my failures to GOD." Suddenly the pressure was gone-- my guilt dissolved, my sin disappeared.
- 5 Then I acknowledged my sin to you and did not cover up my iniquity. I said, "I will confess my transgressions to the LORD"-- and you forgave the guilt of my sin. Selah
- 6 These things add up. Every one of us needs to pray; when all hell breaks loose and the dam bursts we'll be on high ground, untouched.
- 6 Therefore let everyone who is godly pray to you while you may be found; surely when the mighty waters rise, they will not reach him.
- 7 GOD's my island hideaway, keeps danger far from the shore, throws garlands of hosannas around my neck.
- 7 You are my hiding place; you will protect me from trouble and surround me with songs of deliverance. Selah
- 8 Let me give you some good advice; I'm looking you in the eye and giving it to you straight:
- 8 I will instruct you and teach you in the way you should go; I will counsel you and watch over you.
- 9 "Don't be ornery like a horse or mule that needs bit and bridle to stay on track."
- 9 Do not be like the horse or the mule, which have no understanding but must be controlled by bit and bridle or they will not come to you.
- 10 God-defiers are always in trouble; GOD-affirmers find themselves loved every time they turn around.

- 10 Many are the woes of the wicked, but the LORD's unfailing love surrounds the man who trusts in him.
- 11 Celebrate GOD. Sing together--everyone! All you honest hearts, raise the roof!
- 11 Rejoice in the LORD and be glad, you righteous; sing, all you who are upright in heart!

Psalms 33

MSG

NIV

- 1 Good people, cheer GOD! Right-living people sound best when praising.
- 1 Sing joyfully to the LORD, you righteous; it is fitting for the upright to praise him.
- 2 Use guitars to reinforce your Hallelujahs! Play his praise on a grand piano!
- 2 Praise the LORD with the harp; make music to him on the ten-stringed lyre.
- 3 Invent your own new song to him; give him a trumpet fanfare.
- 3 Sing to him a new song; play skillfully, and shout for joy.
- 4 For GOD's Word is solid to the core; everything he makes is sound inside and out.
- 4 For the word of the LORD is right and true; he is faithful in all he does.
- 5 He loves it when everything fits, when his world is in plumb-line true. Earth is drenched in GOD's affectionate satisfaction.
- 5 The LORD loves righteousness and justice; the earth is full of his unfailing love.
- 6 The skies were made by GOD's command; he breathed the word and the stars popped out.
- 6 By the word of the LORD were the heavens made, their starry host by the breath of his mouth.
- 7 He scooped Sea into his jug, put Ocean in his keg.
- 7 He gathers the waters of the sea into jars; he puts the deep into storehouses.
- 8 Earth-creatures, bow before GOD; world-dwellers--down on your knees!

8 Let all the earth fear the LORD; let all the people of the world revere him.

9 Here's why: he spoke and there it was, in place the moment he said so.

9 For he spoke, and it came to be; he commanded, and it stood firm.

10 GOD takes the wind out of Babel pretense, he shoots down the world's power-schemes.

10 The LORD foils the plans of the nations; he thwarts the purposes of the peoples.

11 GOD's plan for the world stands up, all his designs are made to last.

11 But the plans of the LORD stand firm forever, the purposes of his heart through all generations.

12 Blessed is the country with GOD for God; blessed are the people he's put in his will.

12 Blessed is the nation whose God is the LORD, the people he chose for his inheritance.

13 From high in the skies GOD looks around, he sees all Adam's brood.

13 From heaven the LORD looks down and sees all mankind;

14 From where he sits he overlooks all us earth-dwellers.

14 from his dwelling place he watches all who live on earth--

15 He has shaped each person in turn; now he watches everything we do.

15 he who forms the hearts of all, who considers everything they do.

16 No king succeeds with a big army alone, no warrior wins by brute strength.

16 No king is saved by the size of his army; no warrior escapes by his great strength.

17 Horsepower is not the answer; no one gets by on muscle alone.

17 A horse is a vain hope for deliverance; despite all its great strength it cannot save.

18 Watch this: God's eye is on those who respect him, the ones who are looking for his love.

18 But the eyes of the LORD are on those who fear him, on those whose hope is in his unfailing love,

19 He's ready to come to their rescue in bad times; in lean times he keeps body and soul together.

19 to deliver them from death and keep them alive in famine.

20 We're depending on GOD; he's everything we need.

- 20 We wait in hope for the LORD; he is our help and our shield.
- 21 What's more, our hearts brim with joy since we've taken for our own his holy name.
- 21 In him our hearts rejoice, for we trust in his holy name.
- 22 Love us, GOD, with all you've got-- that's what we're depending on. A David psalm, when he outwitted Abimelech and got away.
- 22 May your unfailing love rest upon us, O LORD, even as we put our hope in you.

Psalms 34

MSG

NIV

- 1 I bless GOD every chance I get; my lungs expand with his praise.
- 1 Of David. When he pretended to be insane before Abimelech, who drove him away, and he left. I will extol the LORD at all times; his praise will always be on my lips.
- 2 I live and breathe GOD; if things aren't going well, hear this and be happy:
- 2 My soul will boast in the LORD; let the afflicted hear and rejoice.
- 3 Join me in spreading the news; together let's get the word out.
- 3 Glorify the LORD with me; let us exalt his name together.
- 4 GOD met me more than halfway, he freed me from my anxious fears.
- 4 I sought the LORD, and he answered me; he delivered me from all my fears.
- 5 Look at him; give him your warmest smile. Never hide your feelings from him.
- 5 Those who look to him are radiant; their faces are never covered with shame.
- 6 When I was desperate, I called out, and GOD got me out of a tight spot.
- 6 This poor man called, and the LORD heard him; he saved him out of all his troubles.
- 7 GOD's angel sets up a circle of protection around us while we pray.
- 7 The angel of the LORD encamps around those who fear him, and he delivers them.

- 8 Open your mouth and taste, open your eyes and see-- how good GOD is.
Blessed are you who run to him.
- 8 Taste and see that the LORD is good; blessed is the man who takes
refuge in him.
- 9 Worship GOD if you want the best; worship opens doors to all his
goodness.
- 9 Fear the LORD, you his saints, for those who fear him lack nothing.
- 10 Young lions on the prowl get hungry, but GOD-seekers are full of God.
- 10 The lions may grow weak and hungry, but those who seek the LORD
lack no good thing.
- 11 Come, children, listen closely; I'll give you a lesson in GOD worship.
- 11 Come, my children, listen to me; I will teach you the fear of the LORD.
- 12 Who out there has a lust for life? Can't wait each day to come upon
beauty?
- 12 Whoever of you loves life and desires to see many good days,
- 13 Guard your tongue from profanity, and no more lying through your
teeth.
- 13 keep your tongue from evil and your lips from speaking lies.
- 14 Turn your back on sin; do something good. Embrace peace--don't let it
get away!
- 14 Turn from evil and do good; seek peace and pursue it.
- 15 GOD keeps an eye on his friends, his ears pick up every moan and
groan.
- 15 The eyes of the LORD are on the righteous and his ears are attentive to
their cry;
- 16 GOD won't put up with rebels; he'll cull them from the pack.
- 16 the face of the LORD is against those who do evil, to cut off the
memory of them from the earth.
- 17 Is anyone crying for help? GOD is listening, ready to rescue you.
- 17 The righteous cry out, and the LORD hears them; he delivers them from
all their troubles.
- 18 If your heart is broken, you'll find GOD right there; if you're kicked in
the gut, he'll help you catch your breath.
- 18 The LORD is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are
crushed in spirit.
- 19 Disciples so often get into trouble; still, GOD is there every time.

- 19 A righteous man may have many troubles, but the LORD delivers him from them all;
- 20 He's your bodyguard, shielding every bone; not even a finger gets broken.
- 20 he protects all his bones, not one of them will be broken.
- 21 The wicked commit slow suicide; they waste their lives hating the good.
- 21 Evil will slay the wicked; the foes of the righteous will be condemned.
- 22 GOD pays for each slave's freedom; no one who runs to him loses out.
- 22 The LORD redeems his servants; no one will be condemned who takes refuge in him.

Psalms 35

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Harass these hecklers, GOD, punch these bullies in the nose.
- 1 Of David. Contend, O LORD, with those who contend with me; fight against those who fight against me.
- 2 Grab a weapon, anything at hand; stand up for me!
- 2 Take up shield and buckler; arise and come to my aid.
- 3 Get ready to throw the spear, aim the javelin, at the people who are out to get me. Reassure me; let me hear you say, "I'll save you."
- 3 Brandish spear and javelin against those who pursue me. Say to my soul, "I am your salvation."
- 4 When those thugs try to knife me in the back, make them look foolish. Frustrate all those who are plotting my downfall.
- 4 May those who seek my life be disgraced and put to shame; may those who plot my ruin be turned back in dismay.
- 5 Make them like cinders in a high wind, with GOD's angel working the bellows.
- 5 May they be like chaff before the wind, with the angel of the LORD driving them away;
- 6 Make their road lightless and mud-slick, with GOD's angel on their tails.
- 6 may their path be dark and slippery, with the angel of the LORD pursuing them.

- 7 Out of sheer cussedness they set a trap to catch me; for no good reason they dug a ditch to stop me.
- 7 Since they hid their net for me without cause and without cause dug a pit for me,
- 8 Surprise them with your ambush-- catch them in the very trap they set, the disaster they planned for me.
- 8 may ruin overtake them by surprise-- may the net they hid entangle them, may they fall into the pit, to their ruin.
- 9 But let me run loose and free, celebrating GOD's great work,
- 9 Then my soul will rejoice in the LORD and delight in his salvation.
- 10 Every bone in my body laughing, singing, "GOD, there's no one like you. You put the down-and-out on their feet and protect the unprotected from bullies!"
- 10 My whole being will exclaim, "Who is like you, O LORD? You rescue the poor from those too strong for them, the poor and needy from those who rob them."
- 11 Hostile accusers appear out of nowhere, they stand up and badger me.
- 11 Ruthless witnesses come forward; they question me on things I know nothing about.
- 12 They pay me back misery for mercy, leaving my soul empty.
- 12 They repay me evil for good and leave my soul forlorn.
- 13 When they were sick, I dressed in black; instead of eating, I prayed.
- 13 Yet when they were ill, I put on sackcloth and humbled myself with fasting. When my prayers returned to me unanswered,
- 14 My prayers were like lead in my gut, like I'd lost my best friend, my brother. I paced, distraught as a motherless child, hunched and heavyhearted.
- 14 I went about mourning as though for my friend or brother. I bowed my head in grief as though weeping for my mother.
- 15 But when I was down they threw a party! All the nameless riffraff of the town came chanting insults about me.
- 15 But when I stumbled, they gathered in glee; attackers gathered against me when I was unaware. They slandered me without ceasing.
- 16 Like barbarians desecrating a shrine, they destroyed my reputation.
- 16 Like the ungodly they maliciously mocked; they gnashed their teeth at me.

17 GOD, how long are you going to stand there doing nothing? Save me from their brutalities; everything I've got is being thrown to the lions.

17 O Lord, how long will you look on? Rescue my life from their ravages, my precious life from these lions.

18 I will give you full credit when everyone gathers for worship; When the people turn out in force I will say my Hallelujahs.

18 I will give you thanks in the great assembly; among throngs of people I will praise you.

19 Don't let these liars, my enemies, have a party at my expense, Those who hate me for no reason, winking and rolling their eyes.

19 Let not those gloat over me who are my enemies without cause; let not those who hate me without reason maliciously wink the eye.

20 No good is going to come from that crowd; They spend all their time cooking up gossip against those who mind their own business.

20 They do not speak peaceably, but devise false accusations against those who live quietly in the land.

21 They open their mouths in ugly grins, Mocking, "Ha-ha, ha-ha, thought you'd get away with it? We've caught you hands down!"

21 They gape at me and say, "Aha! Aha! With our own eyes we have seen it."

22 Don't you see what they're doing, GOD? You're not going to let them Get by with it, are you? Not going to walk off without doing something, are you?

22 O LORD, you have seen this; be not silent. Do not be far from me, O Lord.

23 Please get up--wake up! Tend to my case. My God, my Lord--my life is on the line.

23 Awake, and rise to my defense! Contend for me, my God and Lord.

24 Do what you think is right, GOD, my God, but don't make me pay for their good time.

24 Vindicate me in your righteousness, O LORD my God; do not let them gloat over me.

25 Don't let them say to themselves, "Ha-ha, we got what we wanted." Don't let them say, "We've chewed him up and spit him out."

25 Do not let them think, "Aha, just what we wanted!" or say, "We have swallowed him up."

- 26 Let those who are being hilarious at my expense Be made to look ridiculous. Make them wear donkey's ears; Pin them with the donkey's tail, who made themselves so high and mighty!
- 26 May all who gloat over my distress be put to shame and confusion; may all who exalt themselves over me be clothed with shame and disgrace.
- 27 But those who want the best for me, Let them have the last word--a glad shout!-- and say, over and over and over, "GOD is great--everything works together for good for his servant."
- 27 May those who delight in my vindication shout for joy and gladness; may they always say, "The LORD be exalted, who delights in the well-being of his servant."
- 28 I'll tell the world how great and good you are, I'll shout Hallelujah all day, every day.
- 28 My tongue will speak of your righteousness and of your praises all day long.

Psalms 36

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. The God-rebel tunes in to sedition-- all ears, eager to sin. He has no regard for God, he stands insolent before him.
- 1 For the director of music. Of David the servant of the LORD. An oracle is within my heart concerning the sinfulness of the wicked: There is no fear of God before his eyes.
- 2 He has smooth-talked himself into believing That his evil will never be noticed.
- 2 For in his own eyes he flatters himself too much to detect or hate his sin.
- 3 Words gutter from his mouth, dishwater dirty. Can't remember when he did anything decent.
- 3 The words of his mouth are wicked and deceitful; he has ceased to be wise and to do good.
- 4 Every time he goes to bed, he fathers another evil plot. When he's loose on the streets, nobody's safe. He plays with fire and doesn't care who gets burned.

- 4 Even on his bed he plots evil; he commits himself to a sinful course and does not reject what is wrong.
- 5 God's love is meteoric, his loyalty astronomic,
- 5 Your love, O LORD, reaches to the heavens, your faithfulness to the skies.
- 6 His purpose titanic, his verdicts oceanic. Yet in his largeness nothing gets lost; Not a man, not a mouse, slips through the cracks.
- 6 Your righteousness is like the mighty mountains, your justice like the great deep. O LORD, you preserve both man and beast.
- 7 How exquisite your love, O God! How eager we are to run under your wings,
- 7 How priceless is your unfailing love! Both high and low among men find refuge in the shadow of your wings.
- 8 To eat our fill at the banquet you spread as you fill our tankards with Eden spring water.
- 8 They feast on the abundance of your house; you give them drink from your river of delights.
- 9 You're a fountain of cascading light, and you open our eyes to light.
- 9 For with you is the fountain of life; in your light we see light.
- 10 Keep on loving your friends; do your work in welcoming hearts.
- 10 Continue your love to those who know you, your righteousness to the upright in heart.
- 11 Don't let the bullies kick me around, the moral midgets slap me down.
- 11 May the foot of the proud not come against me, nor the hand of the wicked drive me away.
- 12 Send the upstarts sprawling flat on their faces in the mud.
- 12 See how the evildoers lie fallen-- thrown down, not able to rise!

Psalms 37

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Don't bother your head with braggarts or wish you could succeed like the wicked.
- 1 Of David. Do not fret because of evil men or be envious of those who do wrong;

- 2 In no time they'll shrivel like grass clippings and wilt like cut flowers in the sun.
- 2 for like the grass they will soon wither, like green plants they will soon die away.
- 3 Get insurance with GOD and do a good deed, settle down and stick to your last.
- 3 Trust in the LORD and do good; dwell in the land and enjoy safe pasture.
- 4 Keep company with GOD, get in on the best.
- 4 Delight yourself in the LORD and he will give you the desires of your heart.
- 5 Open up before GOD, keep nothing back; he'll do whatever needs to be done:
- 5 Commit your way to the LORD; trust in him and he will do this:
- 6 He'll validate your life in the clear light of day and stamp you with approval at high noon.
- 6 He will make your righteousness shine like the dawn, the justice of your cause like the noonday sun.
- 7 Quiet down before GOD, be prayerful before him. Don't bother with those who climb the ladder, who elbow their way to the top.
- 7 Be still before the LORD and wait patiently for him; do not fret when men succeed in their ways, when they carry out their wicked schemes.
- 8 Bridle your anger, trash your wrath, cool your pipes--it only makes things worse.
- 8 Refrain from anger and turn from wrath; do not fret--it leads only to evil.
- 9 Before long the crooks will be bankrupt; GOD-investors will soon own the store.
- 9 For evil men will be cut off, but those who hope in the LORD will inherit the land.
- 10 Before you know it, the wicked will have had it; you'll stare at his once famous place and--nothing!
- 10 A little while, and the wicked will be no more; though you look for them, they will not be found.
- 11 Down-to-earth people will move in and take over, relishing a huge bonanza.
- 11 But the meek will inherit the land and enjoy great peace.
- 12 Bad guys have it in for the good guys, obsessed with doing them in.

12 The wicked plot against the righteous and gnash their teeth at them;
13 But GOD isn't losing any sleep; to him they're a joke with no punch line.
13 but the Lord laughs at the wicked, for he knows their day is coming.
14 Bullies brandish their swords, pull back on their bows with a flourish.
They're out to beat up on the harmless, or mug that nice man out walking his dog.
14 The wicked draw the sword and bend the bow to bring down the poor and needy, to slay those whose ways are upright.
15 A banana peel lands them flat on their faces-- slapstick figures in a moral circus.
15 But their swords will pierce their own hearts, and their bows will be broken.
16 Less is more and more is less. One righteous will outclass fifty wicked,
16 Better the little that the righteous have than the wealth of many wicked;
17 For the wicked are moral weaklings but the righteous are GOD-strong.
17 for the power of the wicked will be broken, but the LORD upholds the righteous.
18 GOD keeps track of the decent folk; what they do won't soon be forgotten.
18 The days of the blameless are known to the LORD, and their inheritance will endure forever.
19 In hard times, they'll hold their heads high; when the shelves are bare, they'll be full.
19 In times of disaster they will not wither; in days of famine they will enjoy plenty.
20 God-despisers have had it; GOD's enemies are finished-- Stripped bare like vineyards at harvest time, vanished like smoke in thin air.
20 But the wicked will perish: The LORD's enemies will be like the beauty of the fields, they will vanish--vanish like smoke.
21 Wicked borrows and never returns; Righteous gives and gives.
21 The wicked borrow and do not repay, but the righteous give generously;
22 Generous gets it all in the end; Stingy is cut off at the pass.
22 those the LORD blesses will inherit the land, but those he curses will be cut off.
23 Stalwart walks in step with GOD; his path blazed by GOD, he's happy.

23 If the LORD delights in a man's way, he makes his steps firm;
24 If he stumbles, he's not down for long; GOD has a grip on his hand.
24 though he stumble, he will not fall, for the LORD upholds him with his hand.
25 I once was young, now I'm a graybeard-- not once have I seen an abandoned believer, or his kids out roaming the streets.
25 I was young and now I am old, yet I have never seen the righteous forsaken or their children begging bread.
26 Every day he's out giving and lending, his children making him proud.
26 They are always generous and lend freely; their children will be blessed.
27 Turn your back on evil, work for the good and don't quit.
27 Turn from evil and do good; then you will dwell in the land forever.
28 GOD loves this kind of thing, never turns away from his friends. Live this way and you've got it made, but bad eggs will be tossed out.
28 For the LORD loves the just and will not forsake his faithful ones. They will be protected forever, but the offspring of the wicked will be cut off;
29 The good get planted on good land and put down healthy roots.
29 the righteous will inherit the land and dwell in it forever.
30 Righteous chews on wisdom like a dog on a bone, rolls virtue around on his tongue.
30 The mouth of the righteous man utters wisdom, and his tongue speaks what is just.
31 His heart pumps God's Word like blood through his veins; his feet are as sure as a cat's.
31 The law of his God is in his heart; his feet do not slip.
32 Wicked sets a watch for Righteous, he's out for the kill.
32 The wicked lie in wait for the righteous, seeking their very lives;
33 GOD, alert, is also on watch-- Wicked won't hurt a hair of his head.
33 but the LORD will not leave them in their power or let them be condemned when brought to trial.
34 Wait passionately for GOD, don't leave the path. He'll give you your place in the sun while you watch the wicked lose it.
34 Wait for the LORD and keep his way. He will exalt you to inherit the land; when the wicked are cut off, you will see it.
35 I saw Wicked bloated like a toad, croaking pretentious nonsense.

35 I have seen a wicked and ruthless man flourishing like a green tree in its native soil,
36 The next time I looked there was nothing-- a punctured bladder, vapid and limp.
36 but he soon passed away and was no more; though I looked for him, he could not be found.
37 Keep your eye on the healthy soul, scrutinize the straight life; There's a future in strenuous wholeness.
37 Consider the blameless, observe the upright; there is a future for the man of peace.
38 But the willful will soon be discarded; insolent souls are on a dead-end street.
38 But all sinners will be destroyed; the future of the wicked will be cut off.
39 The spacious, free life is from GOD, it's also protected and safe.
39 The salvation of the righteous comes from the LORD; he is their stronghold in time of trouble.
40 GOD-strengthened, we're delivered from evil-- when we run to him, he saves us.
40 The LORD helps them and delivers them; he delivers them from the wicked and saves them, because they take refuge in him.

Psalms 38

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Take a deep breath, GOD; calm down-- don't be so hasty with your punishing rod.
- 1 A psalm of David. A petition. O LORD, do not rebuke me in your anger or discipline me in your wrath.
- 2 Your sharp-pointed arrows of rebuke draw blood; my backside smarts from your caning.
- 2 For your arrows have pierced me, and your hand has come down upon me.
- 3 I've lost twenty pounds in two months because of your accusation. My bones are brittle as dry sticks because of my sin.
- 3 Because of your wrath there is no health in my body; my bones have no soundness because of my sin.
- 4 I'm swamped by my bad behavior, collapsed under gunnysacks of guilt.
- 4 My guilt has overwhelmed me like a burden too heavy to bear.
- 5 The cuts in my flesh stink and grow maggots because I've lived so badly.
- 5 My wounds fester and are loathsome because of my sinful folly.
- 6 And now I'm flat on my face feeling sorry for myself morning to night.
- 6 I am bowed down and brought very low; all day long I go about mourning.
- 7 All my insides are on fire, my body is a wreck.
- 7 My back is filled with searing pain; there is no health in my body.
- 8 I'm on my last legs; I've had it-- my life is a vomit of groans.
- 8 I am feeble and utterly crushed; I groan in anguish of heart.
- 9 Lord, my longings are sitting in plain sight, my groans an old story to you.
- 9 All my longings lie open before you, O Lord; my sighing is not hidden from you.
- 10 My heart's about to break; I'm a burned-out case. Cataracts blind me to God and good;
- 10 My heart pounds, my strength fails me; even the light has gone from my eyes.

11 old friends avoid me like the plague. My cousins never visit, my neighbors stab me in the back.

11 My friends and companions avoid me because of my wounds; my neighbors stay far away.

12 My competitors blacken my name, devoutly they pray for my ruin.

12 Those who seek my life set their traps, those who would harm me talk of my ruin; all day long they plot deception.

13 But I'm deaf and mute to it all, ears shut, mouth shut.

13 I am like a deaf man, who cannot hear, like a mute, who cannot open his mouth;

14 I don't hear a word they say, don't speak a word in response.

14 I have become like a man who does not hear, whose mouth can offer no reply.

15 What I do, GOD, is wait for you, wait for my Lord, my God--you will answer!

15 I wait for you, O LORD; you will answer, O Lord my God.

16 I wait and pray so they won't laugh me off, won't smugly strut off when I stumble.

16 For I said, "Do not let them gloat or exalt themselves over me when my foot slips."

17 I'm on the edge of losing it-- the pain in my gut keeps burning.

17 For I am about to fall, and my pain is ever with me.

18 I'm ready to tell my story of failure, I'm no longer smug in my sin.

18 I confess my iniquity; I am troubled by my sin.

19 My enemies are alive and in action, a lynch mob after my neck.

19 Many are those who are my vigorous enemies; those who hate me without reason are numerous.

20 I give out good and get back evil from God-haters who can't stand a God-lover.

20 Those who repay my good with evil slander me when I pursue what is good.

21 Don't dump me, GOD; my God, don't stand me up.

21 O LORD, do not forsake me; be not far from me, O my God.

22 Hurry and help me; I want some wide-open space in my life!

22 Come quickly to help me, O Lord my Savior.

Psalms 39

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. I'm determined to watch steps and tongue so they won't land me in trouble. I decided to hold my tongue as long as Wicked is in the room.
- 1 For the director of music. For Jeduthun. A psalm of David. I said, "I will watch my ways and keep my tongue from sin; I will put a muzzle on my mouth as long as the wicked are in my presence."
- 2 "Mum's the word," I said, and kept quiet. But the longer I kept silence
The worse it got--
- 2 But when I was silent and still, not even saying anything good, my anguish increased.
- 3 my insides got hotter and hotter. My thoughts boiled over; I spilled my guts.
- 3 My heart grew hot within me, and as I meditated, the fire burned; then I spoke with my tongue:
- 4 "Tell me, what's going on, GOD? How long do I have to live? Give me the bad news!
- 4 Show me, O LORD, my life's end and the number of my days; let me know how fleeting is my life.
- 5 You've kept me on pretty short rations; my life is string too short to be saved.
- 5 You have made my days a mere handbreadth; the span of my years is as nothing before you. Each man's life is but a breath. Selah
- 6 Oh! we're all puffs of air. Oh! we're all shadows in a campfire. Oh! we're just spit in the wind. We make our pile, and then we leave it.
- 6 Man is a mere phantom as he goes to and fro: He bustles about, but only in vain; he heaps up wealth, not knowing who will get it.
- 7 "What am I doing in the meantime, Lord? Hoping, that's what I'm doing--
hoping
- 7 But now, Lord, what do I look for? My hope is in you.
- 8 You'll save me from a rebel life, save me from the contempt of dunces.
- 8 Save me from all my transgressions; do not make me the scorn of fools.
- 9 I'll say no more, I'll shut my mouth, since you, Lord, are behind all this.

- 9 I was silent; I would not open my mouth, for you are the one who has done this.
- 10 But I can't take it much longer. When you put us through the fire
- 10 Remove your scourge from me; I am overcome by the blow of your hand.
- 11 to purge us from our sin, our dearest idols go up in smoke. Are we also nothing but smoke?
- 11 You rebuke and discipline men for their sin; you consume their wealth like a moth-- each man is but a breath. Selah
- 12 "Ah, GOD, listen to my prayer, my cry--open your ears. Don't be callous; just look at these tears of mine. I'm a stranger here. I don't know my way-- a migrant like my whole family.
- 12 Hear my prayer, O LORD, listen to my cry for help; be not deaf to my weeping. For I dwell with you as an alien, a stranger, as all my fathers were.
- 13 Give me a break, cut me some slack before it's too late and I'm out of here."
- 13 Look away from me, that I may rejoice again before I depart and am no more."

Psalms 40

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. I waited and waited and waited for GOD. At last he looked; finally he listened.
- 1 For the director of music. Of David. A psalm. I waited patiently for the LORD; he turned to me and heard my cry.
- 2 He lifted me out of the ditch, pulled me from deep mud. He stood me up on a solid rock to make sure I wouldn't slip.
- 2 He lifted me out of the slimy pit, out of the mud and mire; he set my feet on a rock and gave me a firm place to stand.
- 3 He taught me how to sing the latest God-song, a praise-song to our God. More and more people are seeing this: they enter the mystery, abandoning themselves to GOD.

- 3 He put a new song in my mouth, a hymn of praise to our God. Many will see and fear and put their trust in the LORD.
- 4 Blessed are you who give yourselves over to GOD, turn your backs on the world's "sure thing," ignore what the world worships;
- 4 Blessed is the man who makes the LORD his trust, who does not look to the proud, to those who turn aside to false gods.
- 5 The world's a huge stockpile of GOD-wonders and God-thoughts. Nothing and no one comes close to you! I start talking about you, telling what I know, and quickly run out of words. Neither numbers nor words account for you.
- 5 Many, O LORD my God, are the wonders you have done. The things you planned for us no one can recount to you; were I to speak and tell of them, they would be too many to declare.
- 6 Doing something for you, bringing something to you-- that's not what you're after. Being religious, acting pious-- that's not what you're asking for. You've opened my ears so I can listen.
- 6 Sacrifice and offering you did not desire, but my ears you have pierced; burnt offerings and sin offerings you did not require.
- 7 So I answered, "I'm coming. I read in your letter what you wrote about me,
- 7 Then I said, "Here I am, I have come-- it is written about me in the scroll.
- 8 And I'm coming to the party you're throwing for me." That's when God's Word entered my life, became part of my very being.
- 8 I desire to do your will, O my God; your law is within my heart."
- 9 I've preached you to the whole congregation, I've kept back nothing, GOD--you know that.
- 9 I proclaim righteousness in the great assembly; I do not seal my lips, as you know, O LORD.
- 10 I didn't keep the news of your ways a secret, didn't keep it to myself. I told it all, how dependable you are, how thorough. I didn't hold back pieces of love and truth For myself alone. I told it all, let the congregation know the whole story.
- 10 I do not hide your righteousness in my heart; I speak of your faithfulness and salvation. I do not conceal your love and your truth from the great assembly.

- 11 Now GOD, don't hold out on me, don't hold back your passion. Your love and truth are all that keeps me together.
- 11 Do not withhold your mercy from me, O LORD; may your love and your truth always protect me.
- 12 When troubles ganged up on me, a mob of sins past counting, I was so swamped by guilt I couldn't see my way clear. More guilt in my heart than hair on my head, so heavy the guilt that my heart gave out.
- 12 For troubles without number surround me; my sins have overtaken me, and I cannot see. They are more than the hairs of my head, and my heart fails within me.
- 13 Soften up, GOD, and intervene; hurry and get me some help,
- 13 Be pleased, O LORD, to save me; O LORD, come quickly to help me.
- 14 So those who are trying to kidnap my soul will be embarrassed and lose face, So anyone who gets a kick out of making me miserable will be heckled and disgraced,
- 14 May all who seek to take my life be put to shame and confusion; may all who desire my ruin be turned back in disgrace.
- 15 So those who pray for my ruin will be booed and jeered without mercy.
- 15 May those who say to me, "Aha! Aha!" be appalled at their own shame.
- 16 But all who are hunting for you-- oh, let them sing and be happy. Let those who know what you're all about tell the world you're great and not quitting.
- 16 But may all who seek you rejoice and be glad in you; may those who love your salvation always say, "The LORD be exalted!"
- 17 And me? I'm a mess. I'm nothing and have nothing: make something of me. You can do it; you've got what it takes-- but God, don't put it off.
- 17 Yet I am poor and needy; may the Lord think of me. You are my help and my deliverer; O my God, do not delay.

Psalms 41

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Dignify those who are down on their luck; you'll feel good--that's what GOD does.

- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. Blessed is he who has regard for the weak; the LORD delivers him in times of trouble.
- 2 GOD looks after us all, makes us robust with life-- Lucky to be in the land, we're free from enemy worries.
- 2 The LORD will protect him and preserve his life; he will bless him in the land and not surrender him to the desire of his foes.
- 3 Whenever we're sick and in bed, GOD becomes our nurse, nurses us back to health.
- 3 The LORD will sustain him on his sickbed and restore him from his bed of illness.
- 4 I said, "GOD, be gracious! Put me together again-- my sins have torn me to pieces."
- 4 I said, "O LORD, have mercy on me; heal me, for I have sinned against you."
- 5 My enemies are wishing the worst for me; they make bets on what day I will die.
- 5 My enemies say of me in malice, "When will he die and his name perish?"
- 6 If someone comes to see me, he mouths empty platitudes, All the while gathering gossip about me to entertain the street-corner crowd.
- 6 Whenever one comes to see me, he speaks falsely, while his heart gathers slander; then he goes out and spreads it abroad.
- 7 These "friends" who hate me whisper slanders all over town. They form committees to plan misery for me.
- 7 All my enemies whisper together against me; they imagine the worst for me, saying,
- 8 The rumor goes out, "He's got some dirty, deadly disease. The doctors have given up on him."
- 8 A vile disease has beset him; he will never get up from the place where he lies.
- 9 Even my best friend, the one I always told everything --he ate meals at my house all the time!-- has bitten my hand.
- 9 Even my close friend, whom I trusted, he who shared my bread, has lifted up his heel against me.
- 10 GOD, give grace, get me up on my feet. I'll show them a thing or two.

- 10 But you, O LORD, have mercy on me; raise me up, that I may repay them.
- 11 Meanwhile, I'm sure you're on my side-- no victory shouts yet from the enemy camp!
- 11 I know that you are pleased with me, for my enemy does not triumph over me.
- 12 You know me inside and out, you hold me together, you never fail to stand me tall in your presence so I can look you in the eye.
- 12 In my integrity you uphold me and set me in your presence forever.
- 13 Blessed is GOD, Israel's God, always, always, always. Yes. Yes. Yes.
- 13 Praise be to the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting to everlasting. Amen and Amen.

Psalms 42

MSG

NIV

- 1 A psalm of the sons of Korah. A white-tailed deer drinks from the creek; I want to drink God, deep draughts of God.
- 1 For the director of music. A maskil of the Sons of Korah. As the deer pants for streams of water, so my soul pants for you, O God.
- 2 I'm thirsty for God-alive. I wonder, "Will I ever make it-- arrive and drink in God's presence?"
- 2 My soul thirsts for God, for the living God. When can I go and meet with God?
- 3 I'm on a diet of tears-- tears for breakfast, tears for supper. All day long people knock at my door, Pestering, "Where is this God of yours?"
- 3 My tears have been my food day and night, while men say to me all day long, "Where is your God?"
- 4 These are the things I go over and over, emptying out the pockets of my life. I was always at the head of the worshiping crowd, right out in front, Leading them all, eager to arrive and worship, Shouting praises, singing thanksgiving-- celebrating, all of us, God's feast!
- 4 These things I remember as I pour out my soul: how I used to go with the multitude, leading the procession to the house of God, with shouts of joy and thanksgiving among the festive throng.

- 5 Why are you down in the dumps, dear soul? Why are you crying the blues? Fix my eyes on God-- soon I'll be praising again. He puts a smile on my face. He's my God.
- 5 Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why so disturbed within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise him, my Savior and
- 6 When my soul is in the dumps, I rehearse everything I know of you, From Jordan depths to Hermon heights, including Mount Mizar.
- 6 my God. My soul is downcast within me; therefore I will remember you from the land of the Jordan, the heights of Hermon--from Mount Mizar.
- 7 Chaos calls to chaos, to the tune of whitewater rapids. Your breaking surf, your thundering breakers crash and crush me.
- 7 Deep calls to deep in the roar of your waterfalls; all your waves and breakers have swept over me.
- 8 Then GOD promises to love me all day, sing songs all through the night! My life is God's prayer.
- 8 By day the LORD directs his love, at night his song is with me-- a prayer to the God of my life.
- 9 Sometimes I ask God, my rock-solid God, "Why did you let me down? Why am I walking around in tears, harassed by enemies?"
- 9 I say to God my Rock, "Why have you forgotten me? Why must I go about mourning, oppressed by the enemy?"
- 10 They're out for the kill, these tormentors with their obscenities, Taunting day after day, "Where is this God of yours?"
- 10 My bones suffer mortal agony as my foes taunt me, saying to me all day long, "Where is your God?"
- 11 Why are you down in the dumps, dear soul? Why are you crying the blues? Fix my eyes on God-- soon I'll be praising again. He puts a smile on my face. He's my God.
- 11 Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why so disturbed within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise him, my Savior and my God.

Psalms 43

MSG

NIV

- 1 Clear my name, God; stick up for me against these loveless, immoral people. Get me out of here, away from these lying degenerates.
- 1 Vindicate me, O God, and plead my cause against an ungodly nation; rescue me from deceitful and wicked men.
- 2 I counted on you, God. Why did you walk out on me? Why am I pacing the floor, wringing my hands over these outrageous people?
- 2 You are God my stronghold. Why have you rejected me? Why must I go about mourning, oppressed by the enemy?
- 3 Give me your lantern and compass, give me a map, So I can find my way to the sacred mountain, to the place of your presence,
- 3 Send forth your light and your truth, let them guide me; let them bring me to your holy mountain, to the place where you dwell.
- 4 To enter the place of worship, meet my exuberant God, Sing my thanks with a harp, magnificent God, my God.
- 4 Then will I go to the altar of God, to God, my joy and my delight. I will praise you with the harp, O God, my God.
- 5 Why are you down in the dumps, dear soul? Why are you crying the blues? Fix my eyes on God-- soon I'll be praising again. He puts a smile on my face. He's my God.
- 5 Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why so disturbed within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise him, my Savior and my God.

Psalms 44

MSG

NIV

- 1 A psalm of the sons of Korah. We've been hearing about this, God, all our lives. Our fathers told us the stories their fathers told them,
- 1 For the director of music. Of the Sons of Korah. A maskil. We have heard with our ears, O God; our fathers have told us what you did in their days, in days long ago.
- 2 How single-handedly you weeded out the godless from the fields and planted us, How you sent those people packing but gave us a fresh start.
- 2 With your hand you drove out the nations and planted our fathers; you crushed the peoples and made our fathers flourish.

- 3 We didn't fight for this land; we didn't work for it--it was a gift! You gave it, smiling as you gave it, delighting as you gave it.
- 3 It was not by their sword that they won the land, nor did their arm bring them victory; it was your right hand, your arm, and the light of your face, for you loved them.
- 4 You're my King, O God-- command victories for Jacob!
- 4 You are my King and my God, who decrees victories for Jacob.
- 5 With your help we'll wipe out our enemies, in your name we'll stomp them to dust.
- 5 Through you we push back our enemies; through your name we trample our foes.
- 6 I don't trust in weapons; my sword won't save me--
- 6 I do not trust in my bow, my sword does not bring me victory;
- 7 But it's you, you who saved us from the enemy; you made those who hate us lose face.
- 7 but you give us victory over our enemies, you put our adversaries to shame.
- 8 All day we parade God's praise-- we thank you by name over and over.
- 8 In God we make our boast all day long, and we will praise your name forever. Selah
- 9 But now you've walked off and left us, you've disgraced us and won't fight for us.
- 9 But now you have rejected and humbled us; you no longer go out with our armies.
- 10 You made us turn tail and run; those who hate us have cleaned us out.
- 10 You made us retreat before the enemy, and our adversaries have plundered us.
- 11 You delivered us as sheep to the butcher, you scattered us to the four winds.
- 11 You gave us up to be devoured like sheep and have scattered us among the nations.
- 12 You sold your people at a discount-- you made nothing on the sale.
- 12 You sold your people for a pittance, gaining nothing from their sale.
- 13 You made people on the street, urchins, poke fun and call us names.
- 13 You have made us a reproach to our neighbors, the scorn and derision of those around us.

14 You made us a joke among the godless, a cheap joke among the rabble.
14 You have made us a byword among the nations; the peoples shake their heads at us.
15 Every day I'm up against it, my nose rubbed in my shame--
15 My disgrace is before me all day long, and my face is covered with shame
16 Gossip and ridicule fill the air, people out to get me crowd the street.
16 at the taunts of those who reproach and revile me, because of the enemy, who is bent on revenge.
17 All this came down on us, and we've done nothing to deserve it. We never betrayed your Covenant:
17 All this happened to us, though we had not forgotten you or been false to your covenant.
18 our hearts were never false, our feet never left your path.
18 Our hearts had not turned back; our feet had not strayed from your path.
19 Do we deserve torture in a den of jackals? or lockup in a black hole?
19 But you crushed us and made us a haunt for jackals and covered us over with deep darkness.
20 If we had forgotten to pray to our God or made fools of ourselves with store-bought gods,
20 If we had forgotten the name of our God or spread out our hands to a foreign god,
21 Wouldn't God have figured this out? We can't hide things from him.
21 would not God have discovered it, since he knows the secrets of the heart?
22 No, you decided to make us martyrs, lambs assigned for sacrifice each day.
22 Yet for your sake we face death all day long; we are considered as sheep to be slaughtered.
23 Get up, GOD! Are you going to sleep all day? Wake up! Don't you care what happens to us?
23 Awake, O Lord! Why do you sleep? Rouse yourself! Do not reject us forever.
24 Why do you bury your face in the pillow? Why pretend things are just fine with us?
24 Why do you hide your face and forget our misery and oppression?

25 And here we are--flat on our faces in the dirt, held down with a boot on our necks.

25 We are brought down to the dust; our bodies cling to the ground.

26 Get up and come to our rescue. If you love us so much, Help us!

26 Rise up and help us; redeem us because of your unfailing love.

Psalms 45

MSG

NIV

1 A wedding song of the sons of Korah. My heart bursts its banks, spilling beauty and goodness. I pour it out in a poem to the king, shaping the river into words:

1 For the director of music. To the tune of "Lilies." Of the Sons of Korah. A maskil. A wedding song. My heart is stirred by a noble theme as I recite my verses for the king; my tongue is the pen of a skillful writer.

2 "You're the handsomest of men; every word from your lips is sheer grace, and God has blessed you, blessed you so much.

2 You are the most excellent of men and your lips have been anointed with grace, since God has blessed you forever.

3 Strap your sword to your side, warrior! Accept praise! Accept due honor! Ride majestically! Ride triumphantly!

3 Gird your sword upon your side, O mighty one; clothe yourself with splendor and majesty.

4 Ride on the side of truth! Ride for the righteous meek! "Your instructions are glow-in-the-dark;

4 In your majesty ride forth victoriously in behalf of truth, humility and righteousness; let your right hand display awesome deeds.

5 you shoot sharp arrows Into enemy hearts; the king's foes lie down in the dust, beaten.

5 Let your sharp arrows pierce the hearts of the king's enemies; let the nations fall beneath your feet.

6 "Your throne is God's throne, ever and always; The scepter of your royal rule measures right living.

6 Your throne, O God, will last for ever and ever; a scepter of justice will be the scepter of your kingdom.

- 7 You love the right and hate the wrong. And that is why God, your very own God, poured fragrant oil on your head, Marking you out as king from among your dear companions.
- 7 You love righteousness and hate wickedness; therefore God, your God, has set you above your companions by anointing you with the oil of joy.
- 8 "Your ozone-drenched garments are fragrant with mountain breeze. Chamber music--from the throne room-- makes you want to dance.
- 8 All your robes are fragrant with myrrh and aloes and cassia; from palaces adorned with ivory the music of the strings makes you glad.
- 9 Kings' daughters are maids in your court, the Bride glittering with golden jewelry.
- 9 Daughters of kings are among your honored women; at your right hand is the royal bride in gold of Ophir.
- 10 "Now listen, daughter, don't miss a word: forget your country, put your home behind you.
- 10 Listen, O daughter, consider and give ear: Forget your people and your father's house.
- 11 Be here--the king is wild for you. Since he's your lord, adore him.
- 11 The king is enthralled by your beauty; honor him, for he is your lord.
- 12 Wedding gifts pour in from Tyre; rich guests shower you with presents."
- 12 The Daughter of Tyre will come with a gift, men of wealth will seek your favor.
- 13 (Her wedding dress is dazzling, lined with gold by the weavers;
- 13 All glorious is the princess within her chamber; her gown is interwoven with gold.
- 14 All her dresses and robes are woven with gold. She is led to the king, followed by her virgin companions.
- 14 In embroidered garments she is led to the king; her virgin companions follow her and are brought to you.
- 15 A procession of joy and laughter! a grand entrance to the king's palace!)
- 15 They are led in with joy and gladness; they enter the palace of the king.
- 16 "Set your mind now on sons-- don't dote on father and grandfather. You'll set your sons up as princes all over the earth.
- 16 Your sons will take the place of your fathers; you will make them princes throughout the land.

17 I'll make you famous for generations; you'll be the talk of the town for a long, long time."

17 I will perpetuate your memory through all generations; therefore the nations will praise you for ever and ever.

Psalms 46

MSG

NIV

1 A song of the sons of Korah. God is a safe place to hide, ready to help when we need him.

1 For the director of music. Of the Sons of Korah. According to alamothe. A song. God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in trouble.

2 We stand fearless at the cliff-edge of doom, courageous in seastorm and earthquake,

2 Therefore we will not fear, though the earth give way and the mountains fall into the heart of the sea,

3 Before the rush and roar of oceans, the tremors that shift mountains. Jacob-wrestling God fights for us, GOD of angel armies protects us.

3 though its waters roar and foam and the mountains quake with their surging. Selah

4 River fountains splash joy, cooling God's city, this sacred haunt of the Most High.

4 There is a river whose streams make glad the city of God, the holy place where the Most High dwells.

5 God lives here, the streets are safe, God at your service from crack of dawn.

5 God is within her, she will not fall; God will help her at break of day.

6 Godless nations rant and rave, kings and kingdoms threaten, but Earth does anything he says.

6 Nations are in uproar, kingdoms fall; he lifts his voice, the earth melts.

7 Jacob-wrestling God fights for us, GOD of angel armies protects us.

7 The LORD Almighty is with us; the God of Jacob is our fortress. Selah

8 Attention, all! See the marvels of GOD! He plants flowers and trees all over the earth,

- 8 Come and see the works of the LORD, the desolations he has brought on the earth.
- 9 Bans war from pole to pole, breaks all the weapons across his knee.
- 9 He makes wars cease to the ends of the earth; he breaks the bow and shatters the spear, he burns the shields with fire.
- 10 "Step out of the traffic! Take a long, loving look at me, your High God, above politics, above everything."
- 10 Be still, and know that I am God; I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth.
- 11 Jacob-wrestling God fights for us, GOD of angel armies protects us.
- 11 The LORD Almighty is with us; the God of Jacob is our fortress. Selah

Psalms 47

MSG

NIV

- 1 A psalm of the sons of Korah. Applause, everyone. Bravo, bravissimo! Shout God-songs at the top of your lungs!
- 1 For the director of music. Of the Sons of Korah. A psalm. Clap your hands, all you nations; shout to God with cries of joy.
- 2 GOD Most High is stunning, astride land and ocean.
- 2 How awesome is the LORD Most High, the great King over all the earth!
- 3 He crushes hostile people, puts nations at our feet.
- 3 He subdued nations under us, peoples under our feet.
- 4 He set us at the head of the line, prize-winning Jacob, his favorite.
- 4 He chose our inheritance for us, the pride of Jacob, whom he loved. Selah
- 5 Loud cheers as God climbs the mountain, a ram's horn blast at the summit.
- 5 God has ascended amid shouts of joy, the LORD amid the sounding of trumpets.
- 6 Sing songs to God, sing out! Sing to our King, sing praise!
- 6 Sing praises to God, sing praises; sing praises to our King, sing praises.
- 7 He's Lord over earth, so sing your best songs to God.
- 7 For God is the King of all the earth; sing to him a psalm of praise.
- 8 God is Lord of godless nations-- sovereign, he's King of the mountain.

- 8 God reigns over the nations; God is seated on his holy throne.
9 Princes from all over are gathered, people of Abraham's God. The powers of earth are God's-- he soars over all.
9 The nobles of the nations assemble as the people of the God of Abraham, for the kings of the earth belong to God; he is greatly exalted.

Psalms 48

MSG

NIV

- 1 A psalm of the sons of Korah. GOD majestic, praise abounds in our God-city! His sacred mountain,
1 A song. A psalm of the Sons of Korah. Great is the LORD, and most worthy of praise, in the city of our God, his holy mountain.
2 breathtaking in its heights--earth's joy. Zion Mountain looms in the North, city of the world-King.
2 It is beautiful in its loftiness, the joy of the whole earth. Like the utmost heights of Zaphon is Mount Zion, the city of the Great King.
3 God in his citadel peaks impregnable.
3 God is in her citadels; he has shown himself to be her fortress.
4 The kings got together, they united and came.
4 When the kings joined forces, when they advanced together,
5 They took one look and shook their heads, they scattered and ran away.
5 they saw her and were astounded; they fled in terror.
6 They doubled up in pain like a woman having a baby.
6 Trembling seized them there, pain like that of a woman in labor.
7 You smashed the ships of Tarshish with a storm out of the East.
7 You destroyed them like ships of Tarshish shattered by an east wind.
8 We heard about it, then we saw it with our eyes-- In GOD's city of angel armies, in the city our God Set on firm foundations, firm forever.
8 As we have heard, so have we seen in the city of the LORD Almighty, in the city of our God: God makes her secure forever. Selah
9 We pondered your love-in-action, God, waiting in your temple:
9 Within your temple, O God, we meditate on your unfailing love.
10 Your name, God, evokes a train of Hallelujahs wherever It is spoken, near and far; your arms are heaped with goodness-in-action.

- 10 Like your name, O God, your praise reaches to the ends of the earth;
your right hand is filled with righteousness.
- 11 Be glad, Zion Mountain; Dance, Judah's daughters! He does what he
said he'd do!
- 11 Mount Zion rejoices, the villages of Judah are glad because of your
judgments.
- 12 Circle Zion, take her measure, count her fortress peaks,
- 12 Walk about Zion, go around her, count her towers,
- 13 Gaze long at her sloping bulwark, climb her citadel heights-- Then you
can tell the next generation detail by detail the story of God,
- 13 consider well her ramparts, view her citadels, that you may tell of them
to the next generation.
- 14 Our God forever, who guides us till the end of time.
- 14 For this God is our God for ever and ever; he will be our guide even to
the end.

Psalms 49

MSG

NIV

- 1 A psalm of the sons of Korah. Listen, everyone, listen-- earth-dwellers,
don't miss this.
- 1 For the director of music. Of the Sons of Korah. A psalm. Hear this, all
you peoples; listen, all who live in this world,
- 2 All you haves and have-nots, All together now: listen.
- 2 both low and high, rich and poor alike:
- 3 I set plainspoken wisdom before you, my heart-seasoned understandings
of life.
- 3 My mouth will speak words of wisdom; the utterance from my heart will
give understanding.
- 4 I fine-tuned my ear to the sayings of the wise, I solve life's riddle with the
help of a harp.
- 4 I will turn my ear to a proverb; with the harp I will expound my riddle:
- 5 So why should I fear in bad times, hemmed in by enemy malice,
- 5 Why should I fear when evil days come, when wicked deceivers
surround me--

6 Shoved around by bullies, demeaned by the arrogant rich?
6 those who trust in their wealth and boast of their great riches?
7 Really! There's no such thing as self-rescue, pulling yourself up by your
bootstraps.
7 No man can redeem the life of another or give to God a ransom for him--
8 The cost of rescue is beyond our means, and even then it doesn't
guarantee
8 the ransom for a life is costly, no payment is ever enough--
9 Life forever, or insurance against the Black Hole.
9 that he should live on forever and not see decay.
10 Anyone can see that the brightest and best die, wiped out right along
with fools and dunces.
10 For all can see that wise men die; the foolish and the senseless alike
perish and leave their wealth to others.
11 They leave all their prowess behind, move into their new home, The
Coffin, The cemetery their permanent address. And to think they named
counties after themselves!
11 Their tombs will remain their houses forever, their dwellings for endless
generations, though they had named lands after themselves.
12 We aren't immortal. We don't last long. Like our dogs, we age and
weaken. And die.
12 But man, despite his riches, does not endure; he is like the beasts that
perish.
13 This is what happens to those who live for the moment, who only look
out for themselves:
13 This is the fate of those who trust in themselves, and of their followers,
who approve their sayings. Selah
14 Death herds them like sheep straight to hell; they disappear down the
gullet of the grave; They waste away to nothing-- nothing left but a
marker in a cemetery.
14 Like sheep they are destined for the grave, and death will feed on them.
The upright will rule over them in the morning; their forms will decay in
the grave, far from their princely mansions.
15 But me? God snatches me from the clutch of death, he reaches down
and grabs me.

- 15 But God will redeem my life from the grave; he will surely take me to himself. Selah
- 16 So don't be impressed with those who get rich and pile up fame and fortune.
- 16 Do not be overawed when a man grows rich, when the splendor of his house increases;
- 17 They can't take it with them; fame and fortune all get left behind.
- 17 for he will take nothing with him when he dies, his splendor will not descend with him.
- 18 Just when they think they've arrived and folks praise them because they've made good,
- 18 Though while he lived he counted himself blessed-- and men praise you when you prosper--
- 19 They enter the family burial plot where they'll never see sunshine again.
- 19 he will join the generation of his fathers, who will never see the light of life.
- 20 We aren't immortal. We don't last long. Like our dogs, we age and weaken. And die.
- 20 A man who has riches without understanding is like the beasts that perish.

Psalms 50

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. The God of gods--it's GOD!--speaks out, shouts, "Earth!" welcomes the sun in the east, farewells the disappearing sun in the west.
- 1 A psalm of Asaph. The Mighty One, God, the LORD, speaks and summons the earth from the rising of the sun to the place where it sets.
- 2 From the dazzle of Zion, God blazes into view.
- 2 From Zion, perfect in beauty, God shines forth.
- 3 Our God makes his entrance, he's not shy in his coming. Starbursts of fireworks precede him.
- 3 Our God comes and will not be silent; a fire devours before him, and around him a tempest rages.

4 He summons heaven and earth as a jury, he's taking his people to court:
4 He summons the heavens above, and the earth, that he may judge his people:
5 "Round up my saints who swore on the Bible their loyalty to me."
5 Gather to me my consecrated ones, who made a covenant with me by sacrifice.
6 The whole cosmos attests to the fairness of this court, that here God is judge.
6 And the heavens proclaim his righteousness, for God himself is judge.
Selah
7 "Are you listening, dear people? I'm getting ready to speak; Israel, I'm about ready to bring you to trial. This is God, your God, speaking to you.
7 Hear, O my people, and I will speak, O Israel, and I will testify against you: I am God, your God.
8 I don't find fault with your acts of worship, the frequent burnt sacrifices you offer.
8 I do not rebuke you for your sacrifices or your burnt offerings, which are ever before me.
9 But why should I want your blue-ribbon bull, or more and more goats from your herds?
9 I have no need of a bull from your stall or of goats from your pens,
10 Every creature in the forest is mine, the wild animals on all the mountains.
10 for every animal of the forest is mine, and the cattle on a thousand hills.
11 I know every mountain bird by name; the scampering field mice are my friends.
11 I know every bird in the mountains, and the creatures of the field are mine.
12 If I get hungry, do you think I'd tell you? All creation and its bounty are mine.
12 If I were hungry I would not tell you, for the world is mine, and all that is in it.
13 Do you think I feast on venison? or drink draughts of goats' blood?
13 Do I eat the flesh of bulls or drink the blood of goats?
14 Spread for me a banquet of praise, serve High God a feast of kept promises,

14 Sacrifice thank offerings to God, fulfill your vows to the Most High,
15 And call for help when you're in trouble-- I'll help you, and you'll honor me."
15 and call upon me in the day of trouble; I will deliver you, and you will honor me."
16 Next, God calls up the wicked: "What are you up to, quoting my laws, talking like we are good friends?
16 But to the wicked, God says: "What right have you to recite my laws or take my covenant on your lips?
17 You never answer the door when I call; you treat my words like garbage.
17 You hate my instruction and cast my words behind you.
18 If you find a thief, you make him your buddy; adulterers are your friends of choice.
18 When you see a thief, you join with him; you throw in your lot with adulterers.
19 Your mouth drools filth; lying is a serious art form with you.
19 You use your mouth for evil and harness your tongue to deceit.
20 You stab your own brother in the back, rip off your little sister.
20 You speak continually against your brother and slander your own mother's son.
21 I kept a quiet patience while you did these things; you thought I went along with your game. I'm calling you on the carpet, now, laying your wickedness out in plain sight.
21 These things you have done and I kept silent; you thought I was altogether like you. But I will rebuke you and accuse you to your face.
22 "Time's up for playing fast and loose with me. I'm ready to pass sentence, and there's no help in sight!
22 Consider this, you who forget God, or I will tear you to pieces, with none to rescue:
23 It's the praising life that honors me. As soon as you set your foot on the Way, I'll show you my salvation." A David psalm, after he was confronted by Nathan about the affair with Bathsheba.
23 He who sacrifices thank offerings honors me, and he prepares the way so that I may show him the salvation of God."

Psalms 51

MSG

NIV

- 1 Generous in love--God, give grace! Huge in mercy--wipe out my bad record.
- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. When the prophet Nathan came to him after David had committed adultery with Bathsheba. Have mercy on me, O God, according to your unfailing love; according to your great compassion blot out my transgressions.
- 2 Scrub away my guilt, soak out my sins in your laundry.
- 2 Wash away all my iniquity and cleanse me from my sin.
- 3 I know how bad I've been; my sins are staring me down.
- 3 For I know my transgressions, and my sin is always before me.
- 4 You're the One I've violated, and you've seen it all, seen the full extent of my evil. You have all the facts before you; whatever you decide about me is fair.
- 4 Against you, you only, have I sinned and done what is evil in your sight, so that you are proved right when you speak and justified when you judge.
- 5 I've been out of step with you for a long time, in the wrong since before I was born.
- 5 Surely I was sinful at birth, sinful from the time my mother conceived me.
- 6 What you're after is truth from the inside out. Enter me, then; conceive a new, true life.
- 6 Surely you desire truth in the inner parts; you teach me wisdom in the inmost place.
- 7 Soak me in your laundry and I'll come out clean, scrub me and I'll have a snow-white life.
- 7 Cleanse me with hyssop, and I will be clean; wash me, and I will be whiter than snow.
- 8 Tune me in to foot-tapping songs, set these once-broken bones to dancing.
- 8 Let me hear joy and gladness; let the bones you have crushed rejoice.
- 9 Don't look too close for blemishes, give me a clean bill of health.

- 9 Hide your face from my sins and blot out all my iniquity.
- 10 God, make a fresh start in me, shape a Genesis week from the chaos of my life.
- 10 Create in me a pure heart, O God, and renew a steadfast spirit within me.
- 11 Don't throw me out with the trash, or fail to breathe holiness in me.
- 11 Do not cast me from your presence or take your Holy Spirit from me.
- 12 Bring me back from gray exile, put a fresh wind in my sails!
- 12 Restore to me the joy of your salvation and grant me a willing spirit, to sustain me.
- 13 Give me a job teaching rebels your ways so the lost can find their way home.
- 13 Then I will teach transgressors your ways, and sinners will turn back to you.
- 14 Commute my death sentence, God, my salvation God, and I'll sing anthems to your life-giving ways.
- 14 Save me from bloodguilt, O God, the God who saves me, and my tongue will sing of your righteousness.
- 15 Unbutton my lips, dear God; I'll let loose with your praise.
- 15 O Lord, open my lips, and my mouth will declare your praise.
- 16 Going through the motions doesn't please you, a flawless performance is nothing to you.
- 16 You do not delight in sacrifice, or I would bring it; you do not take pleasure in burnt offerings.
- 17 I learned God-worship when my pride was shattered. Heart-shattered lives ready for love don't for a moment escape God's notice.
- 17 The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit; a broken and contrite heart, O God, you will not despise.
- 18 Make Zion the place you delight in, repair Jerusalem's broken-down walls.
- 18 In your good pleasure make Zion prosper; build up the walls of Jerusalem.
- 19 Then you'll get real worship from us, acts of worship small and large, Including all the bulls they can heave onto your altar! A David psalm, when Doeg the Edomite reported to Saul,"David's at Ahimelech's house."

19 Then there will be righteous sacrifices, whole burnt offerings to delight you; then bulls will be offered on your altar.

Psalms 52

MSG

NIV

- 1 Why do you brag of evil, "Big Man"? God's mercy carries the day.
- 1 For the director of music. A maskil of David. When Doeg the Edomite had gone to Saul and told him: "David has gone to the house of Ahimelech." Why do you boast of evil, you mighty man? Why do you boast all day long, you who are a disgrace in the eyes of God?
- 2 You scheme catastrophe; your tongue cuts razor-sharp, artisan in lies.
- 2 Your tongue plots destruction; it is like a sharpened razor, you who practice deceit.
- 3 You love evil more than good, you call black white.
- 3 You love evil rather than good, falsehood rather than speaking the truth.
Selah
- 4 You love malicious gossip, you foul-mouth.
- 4 You love every harmful word, O you deceitful tongue!
- 5 God will tear you limb from limb, sweep you up and throw you out, Pull you up by the roots from the land of life.
- 5 Surely God will bring you down to everlasting ruin: He will snatch you up and tear you from your tent; he will uproot you from the land of the living. Selah
- 6 Good people will watch and worship. They'll laugh in relief:
- 6 The righteous will see and fear; they will laugh at him, saying,
- 7 "Big Man bet on the wrong horse, trusted in big money, made his living from catastrophe."
- 7 Here now is the man who did not make God his stronghold but trusted in his great wealth and grew strong by destroying others!
- 8 And I'm an olive tree, growing green in God's house. I trusted in the generous mercy of God then and now.
- 8 But I am like an olive tree flourishing in the house of God; I trust in God's unfailing love for ever and ever.

- 9 I thank you always that you went into action. And I'll stay right here, your good name my hope, in company with your faithful friends.
- 9 I will praise you forever for what you have done; in your name I will hope, for your name is good. I will praise you in the presence of your saints.

Psalms 53

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Biliious and bloated, they gas, "God is gone." It's poison gas-- they foul themselves, they poison Rivers and skies; thistles are their cash crop.
- 1 For the director of music. According to mahalath. A maskil of David. The fool says in his heart, "There is no God." They are corrupt, and their ways are vile; there is no one who does good.
- 2 God sticks his head out of heaven. He looks around. He's looking for someone not stupid-- one man, even, God-expectant, just one God-ready woman.
- 2 God looks down from heaven on the sons of men to see if there are any who understand, any who seek God.
- 3 He comes up empty. A string of zeros. Useless, unshepherded Sheep, taking turns pretending to be Shepherd. The ninety and nine follow the one.
- 3 Everyone has turned away, they have together become corrupt; there is no one who does good, not even one.
- 4 Don't they know anything, all these impostors? Don't they know they can't get away with this, Treating people like a fast-food meal over which they're too busy to pray?
- 4 Will the evildoers never learn-- those who devour my people as men eat bread and who do not call on God?
- 5 Night is coming for them, and nightmare-- a nightmare they'll never wake up from. God will make hash of these squatters, send them packing for good.
- 5 There they were, overwhelmed with dread, where there was nothing to dread. God scattered the bones of those who attacked you; you put them

- to shame, for God despised them.
- 6 Is there anyone around to save Israel? God turns life around. Turned-around Jacob skips rope, turned-around Israel sings laughter. A David psalm, when the Ziphites reported to Saul, "David is hiding out with us."
- 6 Oh, that salvation for Israel would come out of Zion! When God restores the fortunes of his people, let Jacob rejoice and Israel be glad!

Psalms 54

MSG

NIV

- 1 God, for your sake, help me! Use your influence to clear me.
- 1 For the director of music. With stringed instruments. A maskil of David. When the Ziphites had gone to Saul and said, "Is not David hiding among us?" Save me, O God, by your name; vindicate me by your might.
- 2 Listen, God--I'm desperate. Don't be too busy to hear me.
- 2 Hear my prayer, O God; listen to the words of my mouth.
- 3 Outlaws are out to get me, hit men are trying to kill me. Nothing will stop them; God means nothing to them.
- 3 Strangers are attacking me; ruthless men seek my life-- men without regard for God. Selah
- 4 Oh, look! God's right here helping! GOD's on my side,
- 4 Surely God is my help; the Lord is the one who sustains me.
- 5 Evil is looping back on my enemies. Don't let up! Finish them off!
- 5 Let evil recoil on those who slander me; in your faithfulness destroy them.
- 6 I'm ready now to worship, so ready. I thank you, GOD--you're so good.
- 6 I will sacrifice a freewill offering to you; I will praise your name, O LORD, for it is good.
- 7 You got me out of every scrape, and I saw my enemies get it.
- 7 For he has delivered me from all my troubles, and my eyes have looked in triumph on my foes.

Psalms 55

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Open your ears, God, to my prayer; don't pretend you don't hear me knocking.
- 1 For the director of music. With stringed instruments. A maskil of David. Listen to my prayer, O God, do not ignore my plea;
- 2 Come close and whisper your answer. I really need you. I shudder
- 2 hear me and answer me. My thoughts trouble me and I am distraught
- 3 at the mean voice, quail before the evil eye, As they pile on the guilt, stockpile angry slander.
- 3 at the voice of the enemy, at the stares of the wicked; for they bring down suffering upon me and revile me in their anger.
- 4 My insides are turned inside out; specters of death have me down.
- 4 My heart is in anguish within me; the terrors of death assail me.
- 5 I shake with fear, I shudder from head to foot.
- 5 Fear and trembling have beset me; horror has overwhelmed me.
- 6 "Who will give me wings," I ask-- "wings like a dove?" Get me out of here on dove wings;
- 6 I said, "Oh, that I had the wings of a dove! I would fly away and be at rest--
- 7 I want some peace and quiet. I want a walk in the country,
- 7 I would flee far away and stay in the desert; Selah
- 8 I want a cabin in the woods. I'm desperate for a change from rage and stormy weather.
- 8 I would hurry to my place of shelter, far from the tempest and storm."
- 9 Come down hard, Lord--slit their tongues. I'm appalled how they've split the city Into rival gangs prowling the alleys
- 9 Confuse the wicked, O Lord, confound their speech, for I see violence and strife in the city.
- 10 Day and night spoiling for a fight, trash piled in the streets,
- 10 Day and night they prowl about on its walls; malice and abuse are within it.
- 11 Even shopkeepers gouging and cheating in broad daylight.
- 11 Destructive forces are at work in the city; threats and lies never leave its streets.

12 This isn't the neighborhood bully mocking me--I could take that. This isn't a foreign devil spitting invective--I could tune that out.

12 If an enemy were insulting me, I could endure it; if a foe were raising himself against me, I could hide from him.

13 It's you! We grew up together! You! My best friend!

13 But it is you, a man like myself, my companion, my close friend,

14 Those long hours of leisure as we walked arm in arm, God a third party to our conversation.

14 with whom I once enjoyed sweet fellowship as we walked with the throng at the house of God.

15 Haul my betrayers off alive to hell--let them experience the horror, let them feel every desolate detail of a damned life.

15 Let death take my enemies by surprise; let them go down alive to the grave, for evil finds lodging among them.

16 I call to God; GOD will help me.

16 But I call to God, and the LORD saves me.

17 At dusk, dawn, and noon I sigh deep sighs--he hears, he rescues.

17 Evening, morning and noon I cry out in distress, and he hears my voice.

18 My life is well and whole, secure in the middle of danger Even while thousands are lined up against me.

18 He ransoms me unharmed from the battle waged against me, even though many oppose me.

19 God hears it all, and from his judge's bench puts them in their place. But, set in their ways, they won't change; they pay him no mind.

19 God, who is enthroned forever, will hear them and afflict them-- Selah men who never change their ways and have no fear of God.

20 And this, my best friend, betrayed his best friends; his life betrayed his word.

20 My companion attacks his friends; he violates his covenant.

21 All my life I've been charmed by his speech, never dreaming he'd turn on me. His words, which were music to my ears, turned to daggers in my heart.

21 His speech is smooth as butter, yet war is in his heart; his words are more soothing than oil, yet they are drawn swords.

22 Pile your troubles on GOD's shoulders-- he'll carry your load, he'll help you out. He'll never let good people topple into ruin.

- 22 Cast your cares on the LORD and he will sustain you; he will never let the righteous fall.
- 23 But you, God, will throw the others into a muddy bog, Cut the lifespan of assassins and traitors in half. And I trust in you. A David psalm, when he was captured by the Philistines in Gath.
- 23 But you, O God, will bring down the wicked into the pit of corruption; bloodthirsty and deceitful men will not live out half their days. But as for me, I trust in you.

Psalms 56

MSG

NIV

- 1 Take my side, God--I'm getting kicked around, stomped on every day.
- 1 For the director of music. To the tune of "A Dove on Distant Oaks." Of David. A miktam. When the Philistines had seized him in Gath. Be merciful to me, O God, for men hotly pursue me; all day long they press their attack.
- 2 Not a day goes by but somebody beats me up; They make it their duty to beat me up.
- 2 My slanderers pursue me all day long; many are attacking me in their pride.
- 3 When I get really afraid I come to you in trust.
- 3 When I am afraid, I will trust in you.
- 4 I'm proud to praise God; fearless now, I trust in God. What can mere mortals do?
- 4 In God, whose word I praise, in God I trust; I will not be afraid. What can mortal man do to me?
- 5 They don't let up-- they smear my reputation and huddle to plot my collapse.
- 5 All day long they twist my words; they are always plotting to harm me.
- 6 They gang up, sneak together through the alleys To take me by surprise, wait their chance to get me.
- 6 They conspire, they lurk, they watch my steps, eager to take my life.
- 7 Pay them back in evil! Get angry, God! Down with these people!

- 7 On no account let them escape; in your anger, O God, bring down the nations.
- 8 You've kept track of my every toss and turn through the sleepless nights, Each tear entered in your ledger, each ache written in your book.
- 8 Record my lament; list my tears on your scroll-- are they not in your record?
- 9 If my enemies run away, turn tail when I yell at them, Then I'll know that God is on my side.
- 9 Then my enemies will turn back when I call for help. By this I will know that God is for me.
- 10 I'm proud to praise God, proud to praise GOD.
- 10 In God, whose word I praise, in the LORD, whose word I praise--
- 11 Fearless now, I trust in God; what can mere mortals do to me?
- 11 in God I trust; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?
- 12 God, you did everything you promised, and I'm thanking you with all my heart.
- 12 I am under vows to you, O God; I will present my thank offerings to you.
- 13 You pulled me from the brink of death, my feet from the cliff-edge of doom. Now I stroll at leisure with God in the sunlit fields of life. A David psalm, when he hid in a cave from Saul.
- 13 For you have delivered me from death and my feet from stumbling, that I may walk before God in the light of life.

Psalms 57

MSG

NIV

- 1 Be good to me, God--and now! I've run to you for dear life. I'm hiding out under your wings until the hurricane blows over.
- 1 For the director of music. To the tune of "Do Not Destroy." Of David. A miktam. When he had fled from Saul into the cave. Have mercy on me, O God, have mercy on me, for in you my soul takes refuge. I will take refuge in the shadow of your wings until the disaster has passed.
- 2 I call out to High God, the God who holds me together.
- 2 I cry out to God Most High, to God, who fulfills his purpose for me.

- 3 He sends orders from heaven and saves me, he humiliates those who kick me around. God delivers generous love, he makes good on his word.
- 3 He sends from heaven and saves me, rebuking those who hotly pursue me; Selah God sends his love and his faithfulness.
- 4 I find myself in a pride of lions who are wild for a taste of human flesh; Their teeth are lances and arrows, their tongues are sharp daggers.
- 4 I am in the midst of lions; I lie among ravenous beasts-- men whose teeth are spears and arrows, whose tongues are sharp swords.
- 5 Soar high in the skies, O God! Cover the whole earth with your glory!
- 5 Be exalted, O God, above the heavens; let your glory be over all the earth.
- 6 They booby trapped my path; I thought I was dead and done for. They dug a mantrap to catch me, and fell in headlong themselves.
- 6 They spread a net for my feet-- I was bowed down in distress. They dug a pit in my path-- but they have fallen into it themselves. Selah
- 7 I'm ready, God, so ready, ready from head to toe, Ready to sing, ready to raise a tune:
- 7 My heart is steadfast, O God, my heart is steadfast; I will sing and make music.
- 8 "Wake up, soul! Wake up, harp! wake up, lute! Wake up, you sleepyhead sun!"
- 8 Awake, my soul! Awake, harp and lyre! I will awaken the dawn.
- 9 I'm thanking you, GOD, out loud in the streets, singing your praises in town and country.
- 9 I will praise you, O Lord, among the nations; I will sing of you among the peoples.
- 10 The deeper your love, the higher it goes; every cloud is a flag to your faithfulness.
- 10 For great is your love, reaching to the heavens; your faithfulness reaches to the skies.
- 11 Soar high in the skies, O God! Cover the whole earth with your glory!
- 11 Be exalted, O God, above the heavens; let your glory be over all the earth.

Psalms 58

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Is this any way to run a country? Is there an honest politician in the house?
- 1 For the director of music. To the tune of "Do Not Destroy." Of David. A miktam. Do you rulers indeed speak justly? Do you judge uprightly among men?
- 2 Behind the scenes you brew cauldrons of evil, behind closed doors you make deals with demons.
- 2 No, in your heart you devise injustice, and your hands mete out violence on the earth.
- 3 The wicked crawl from the wrong side of the cradle; their first words out of the womb are lies.
- 3 Even from birth the wicked go astray; from the womb they are wayward and speak lies.
- 4 Poison, lethal rattlesnake poison, drips from their forked tongues--
- 4 Their venom is like the venom of a snake, like that of a cobra that has stopped its ears,
- 5 Deaf to threats, deaf to charm, decades of wax built up in their ears.
- 5 that will not heed the tune of the charmer, however skillful the enchanter may be.
- 6 God, smash their teeth to bits, leave them toothless tigers.
- 6 Break the teeth in their mouths, O God; tear out, O LORD, the fangs of the lions!
- 7 Let their lives be buckets of water spilled, all that's left, a damp stain in the sand. Let them be trampled grass worn smooth by the traffic.
- 7 Let them vanish like water that flows away; when they draw the bow, let their arrows be blunted.
- 8 Let them dissolve into snail slime, be a miscarried fetus that never sees sunlight.
- 8 Like a slug melting away as it moves along, like a stillborn child, may they not see the sun.
- 9 Before what they cook up is half-done, God, throw it out with the garbage!
- 9 Before your pots can feel the heat of the thorns-- whether they be green or dry--the wicked will be swept away.

- 10 The righteous will call up their friends when they see the wicked get their reward, Serve up their blood in goblets as they toast one another,
- 10 The righteous will be glad when they are avenged, when they bathe their feet in the blood of the wicked.
- 11 Everyone cheering, "It's worth it to play by the rules! God's handing out trophies and tending the earth!" A David psalm, when Saul set a watch on David's house in order to kill him.
- 11 Then men will say, "Surely the righteous still are rewarded; surely there is a God who judges the earth."

Psalms 59

MSG

NIV

- 1 My God! Rescue me from my enemies, defend me from these mutineers.
- 1 For the director of music. To the tune of "Do Not Destroy." Of David. A miktam. When Saul had sent men to watch David's house in order to kill him. Deliver me from my enemies, O God; protect me from those who rise up against me.
- 2 Rescue me from their dirty tricks, save me from their hit men.
- 2 Deliver me from evildoers and save me from bloodthirsty men.
- 3 Desperadoes have ganged up on me, they're hiding in ambush for me. I did nothing to deserve this, GOD,
- 3 See how they lie in wait for me! Fierce men conspire against me for no offense or sin of mine, O LORD.
- 4 crossed no one, wronged no one. All the same, they're after me, determined to get me. Wake up and see for yourself!
- 4 I have done no wrong, yet they are ready to attack me. Arise to help me; look on my plight!
- 5 You're GOD, God of angel armies, Israel's God! Get on the job and take care of these pagans, don't be soft on these hard cases.
- 5 O LORD God Almighty, the God of Israel, rouse yourself to punish all the nations; show no mercy to wicked traitors. Selah
- 6 They return when the sun goes down, They howl like coyotes, ringing the city.
- 6 They return at evening, snarling like dogs, and prowl about the city.

7 Then suddenly they're all at the gate, Snarling invective, drawn daggers
in their teeth. They think they'll never get caught.

7 See what they spew from their mouths-- they spew out swords from their
lips, and they say, "Who can hear us?"

8 But you, GOD, break out laughing; you treat the godless nations like
jokes.

8 But you, O LORD, laugh at them; you scoff at all those nations.

9 Strong God, I'm watching you do it, I can always count on you.

9 O my Strength, I watch for you; you, O God, are my fortress,

10 God in dependable love shows up on time, shows me my enemies in
ruin.

10 my loving God. God will go before me and will let me gloat over those
who slander me.

11 Don't make quick work of them, GOD, lest my people forget. Bring
them down in slow motion, take them apart piece by piece.

11 But do not kill them, O Lord our shield, or my people will forget. In
your might make them wander about, and bring them down.

12 Let all their mean-mouthed arrogance catch up with them, Catch them
out and bring them down --every muttered curse --every barefaced lie.

12 For the sins of their mouths, for the words of their lips, let them be
caught in their pride. For the curses and lies they utter,

13 Finish them off in fine style! Finish them off for good! Then all the
world will see that God rules well in Jacob, everywhere that God's in
charge.

13 consume them in wrath, consume them till they are no more. Then it
will be known to the ends of the earth that God rules over Jacob. Selah

14 They return when the sun goes down, They howl like coyotes, ringing
the city.

14 They return at evening, snarling like dogs, and prowl about the city.

15 They scavenge for bones, And bite the hand that feeds them.

15 They wander about for food and howl if not satisfied.

16 And me? I'm singing your prowess, shouting at cockcrow your largesse,
For you've been a safe place for me, a good place to hide.

16 But I will sing of your strength, in the morning I will sing of your love;
for you are my fortress, my refuge in times of trouble.

17 Strong God, I'm watching you do it, I can always count on you-- God, my dependable love. A David psalm, when he fought against Aram-naharaim and Aram-zobah and Joab killed twelve thousand Edomites at the Valley of Salt.

17 O my Strength, I sing praise to you; you, O God, are my fortress, my loving God.

Psalms 60

MSG

NIV

1 God! you walked off and left us, kicked our defenses to bits And stalked off angry. Come back. Oh please, come back!

1 For the director of music. To the tune of "The Lily of the Covenant." A miktam of David. For teaching. When he fought Aram Naharaim and Aram Zobah, and when Joab returned and struck down twelve thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt. You have rejected us, O God, and burst forth upon us; you have been angry--now restore us!

2 You shook earth to the foundations, ripped open huge crevasses. Heal the breaks! Everything's coming apart at the seams.

2 You have shaken the land and torn it open; mend its fractures, for it is quaking.

3 You made your people look doom in the face, then gave us cheap wine to drown our troubles.

3 You have shown your people desperate times; you have given us wine that makes us stagger.

4 Then you planted a flag to rally your people, an unfurled flag to look to for courage.

4 But for those who fear you, you have raised a banner to be unfurled against the bow. Selah

5 Now do something quickly, answer right now, so the one you love best is saved.

5 Save us and help us with your right hand, that those you love may be delivered.

6 That's when God spoke in holy splendor, "Bursting with joy, I make a present of Shechem, I hand out Succoth Valley as a gift.

- 6 God has spoken from his sanctuary: "In triumph I will parcel out Shechem and measure off the Valley of Succoth.
- 7 Gilead's in my pocket, to say nothing of Manasseh. Ephraim's my hard hat, Judah my hammer;
- 7 Gilead is mine, and Manasseh is mine; Ephraim is my helmet, Judah my scepter.
- 8 Moab's a scrub bucket, I mop the floor with Moab, Spit on Edom, rain fireworks all over Philistia."
- 8 Moab is my washbasin, upon Edom I toss my sandal; over Philistia I shout in triumph."
- 9 Who will take me to the thick of the fight? Who'll show me the road to Edom?
- 9 Who will bring me to the fortified city? Who will lead me to Edom?
- 10 You aren't giving up on us, are you, God? refusing to go out with our troops?
- 10 Is it not you, O God, you who have rejected us and no longer go out with our armies?
- 11 Give us help for the hard task; human help is worthless.
- 11 Give us aid against the enemy, for the help of man is worthless.
- 12 In God we'll do our very best; he'll flatten the opposition for good.
- 12 With God we will gain the victory, and he will trample down our enemies.

Psalms 61

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. God, listen to me shout, bend an ear to my prayer.
- 1 For the director of music. With stringed instruments. Of David. Hear my cry, O God; listen to my prayer.
- 2 When I'm far from anywhere, down to my last gasp, I call out, "Guide me up High Rock Mountain!"
- 2 From the ends of the earth I call to you, I call as my heart grows faint; lead me to the rock that is higher than I.
- 3 You've always given me breathing room, a place to get away from it all,
- 3 For you have been my refuge, a strong tower against the foe.

- 4 A lifetime pass to your safe-house, an open invitation as your guest.
4 I long to dwell in your tent forever and take refuge in the shelter of your wings. Selah
5 You've always taken me seriously, God, made me welcome among those who know and love you.
5 For you have heard my vows, O God; you have given me the heritage of those who fear your name.
6 Let the days of the king add up to years and years of good rule.
6 Increase the days of the king's life, his years for many generations.
7 Set his throne in the full light of God; post Steady Love and Good Faith as lookouts,
7 May he be enthroned in God's presence forever; appoint your love and faithfulness to protect him.
8 And I'll be the poet who sings your glory-- and live what I sing every day.
8 Then will I ever sing praise to your name and fulfill my vows day after day.

Psalms 62

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. God, the one and only-- I'll wait as long as he says. Everything I need comes from him, so why not?
1 For the director of music. For Jeduthun. A psalm of David. My soul finds rest in God alone; my salvation comes from him.
2 He's solid rock under my feet, breathing room for my soul, An impregnable castle: I'm set for life.
2 He alone is my rock and my salvation; he is my fortress, I will never be shaken.
3 How long will you gang up on me? How long will you run with the bullies? There's nothing to you, any of you-- rotten floorboards, worm-eaten rafters,
3 How long will you assault a man? Would all of you throw him down-- this leaning wall, this tottering fence?

- 4 Anthills plotting to bring down mountains, far gone in make-believe. You talk a good line, but every "blessing" breathes a curse.
- 4 They fully intend to topple him from his lofty place; they take delight in lies. With their mouths they bless, but in their hearts they curse. Selah
- 5 God, the one and only-- I'll wait as long as he says. Everything I hope for comes from him, so why not?
- 5 Find rest, O my soul, in God alone; my hope comes from him.
- 6 He's solid rock under my feet, breathing room for my soul, An impregnable castle: I'm set for life.
- 6 He alone is my rock and my salvation; he is my fortress, I will not be shaken.
- 7 My help and glory are in God --granite-strength and safe-harbor-God--
- 7 My salvation and my honor depend on God; he is my mighty rock, my refuge.
- 8 So trust him absolutely, people; lay your lives on the line for him. God is a safe place to be.
- 8 Trust in him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts to him, for God is our refuge. Selah
- 9 Man as such is smoke, woman as such, a mirage. Put them together, they're nothing; two times nothing is nothing.
- 9 Lowborn men are but a breath, the highborn are but a lie; if weighed on a balance, they are nothing; together they are only a breath.
- 10 And a windfall, if it comes-- don't make too much of it.
- 10 Do not trust in extortion or take pride in stolen goods; though your riches increase, do not set your heart on them.
- 11 God said this once and for all; how many times Have I heard it repeated? "Strength comes Straight from God."
- 11 One thing God has spoken, two things have I heard: that you, O God, are strong,
- 12 Love to you, Lord God! You pay a fair wage for a good day's work! A David psalm, when he was out in the Judean wilderness.
- 12 and that you, O Lord, are loving. Surely you will reward each person according to what he has done.

Psalms 63

MSG

NIV

- 1 God--you're my God! I can't get enough of you! I've worked up such hunger and thirst for God, traveling across dry and weary deserts.
- 1 A psalm of David. When he was in the Desert of Judah. O God, you are my God, earnestly I seek you; my soul thirsts for you, my body longs for you, in a dry and weary land where there is no water.
- 2 So here I am in the place of worship, eyes open, drinking in your strength and glory.
- 2 I have seen you in the sanctuary and beheld your power and your glory.
- 3 In your generous love I am really living at last! My lips brim praises like fountains.
- 3 Because your love is better than life, my lips will glorify you.
- 4 I bless you every time I take a breath; My arms wave like banners of praise to you.
- 4 I will praise you as long as I live, and in your name I will lift up my hands.
- 5 I eat my fill of prime rib and gravy; I smack my lips. It's time to shout praises!
- 5 My soul will be satisfied as with the richest of foods; with singing lips my mouth will praise you.
- 6 If I'm sleepless at midnight, I spend the hours in grateful reflection.
- 6 On my bed I remember you; I think of you through the watches of the night.
- 7 Because you've always stood up for me, I'm free to run and play.
- 7 Because you are my help, I sing in the shadow of your wings.
- 8 I hold on to you for dear life, and you hold me steady as a post.
- 8 My soul clings to you; your right hand upholds me.
- 9 Those who are out to get me are marked for doom, marked for death, bound for hell.
- 9 They who seek my life will be destroyed; they will go down to the depths of the earth.
- 10 They'll die violent deaths; jackals will tear them limb from limb.
- 10 They will be given over to the sword and become food for jackals.
- 11 But the king is glad in God; his true friends spread the joy, While small-minded gossips are gagged for good.

- 11 But the king will rejoice in God; all who swear by God's name will praise him, while the mouths of liars will be silenced.

Psalms 64

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Listen and help, O God. I'm reduced to a whine And a whimper, obsessed with feelings of doomsday.
- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. Hear me, O God, as I voice my complaint; protect my life from the threat of the enemy.
- 2 Don't let them find me-- the conspirators out to get me,
- 2 Hide me from the conspiracy of the wicked, from that noisy crowd of evildoers.
- 3 Using their tongues as weapons, flinging poison words, poison-tipped arrow-words.
- 3 They sharpen their tongues like swords and aim their words like deadly arrows.
- 4 They shoot from ambush, shoot without warning, not caring who they hit.
- 4 They shoot from ambush at the innocent man; they shoot at him suddenly, without fear.
- 5 They keep fit doing calisthenics of evil purpose, They keep lists of the traps they've secretly set. They say to each other, "No one can catch us,
- 5 They encourage each other in evil plans, they talk about hiding their snares; they say, "Who will see them?"
- 6 no one can detect our perfect crime." The Detective detects the mystery in the dark of the cellar heart.
- 6 They plot injustice and say, "We have devised a perfect plan!" Surely the mind and heart of man are cunning.
- 7 The God of the Arrow shoots! They double up in pain,
- 7 But God will shoot them with arrows; suddenly they will be struck down.
- 8 Fall flat on their faces in full view of the grinning crowd.
- 8 He will turn their own tongues against them and bring them to ruin; all who see them will shake their heads in scorn.
- 9 Everyone sees it. God's work is the talk of the town.

- 9 All mankind will fear; they will proclaim the works of God and ponder what he has done.
- 10 Be glad, good people! Fly to GOD! Good-hearted people, make praise your habit.
- 10 Let the righteous rejoice in the LORD and take refuge in him; let all the upright in heart praise him!

Psalms 65

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Silence is praise to you, Zion-dwelling God, And also obedience.
- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. A song. Praise awaits you, O God, in Zion; to you our vows will be fulfilled.
- 2 You hear the prayer in it all. We all arrive at your doorstep sooner or later, loaded with guilt,
- 2 O you who hear prayer, to you all men will come.
- 3 Our sins too much for us-- but you get rid of them once and for all.
- 3 When we were overwhelmed by sins, you forgave our transgressions.
- 4 Blessed are the chosen! Blessed the guest at home in your place! We expect our fill of good things in your house, your heavenly manse.
- 4 Blessed are those you choose and bring near to live in your courts! We are filled with the good things of your house, of your holy temple.
- 5 All your salvation wonders are on display in your trophy room. Earth-Tamer, Ocean-Pourer,
- 5 You answer us with awesome deeds of righteousness, O God our Savior, the hope of all the ends of the earth and of the farthest seas,
- 6 Mountain-Maker, Hill-Dresser,
- 6 who formed the mountains by your power, having armed yourself with strength,
- 7 Muzzler of sea storm and wave crash, of mobs in noisy riot--
- 7 who stilled the roaring of the seas, the roaring of their waves, and the turmoil of the nations.
- 8 Far and wide they'll come to a stop, they'll stare in awe, in wonder. Dawn and dusk take turns calling, "Come and worship."

- 8 Those living far away fear your wonders; where morning dawns and evening fades you call forth songs of joy.
- 9 Oh, visit the earth, ask her to join the dance! Deck her out in spring showers, fill the God-River with living water. Paint the wheat fields golden. Creation was made for this!
- 9 You care for the land and water it; you enrich it abundantly. The streams of God are filled with water to provide the people with grain, for so you have ordained it.
- 10 Drench the plowed fields, soak the dirt clods With rainfall as harrow and rake bring her to blossom and fruit.
- 10 You drench its furrows and level its ridges; you soften it with showers and bless its crops.
- 11 Snow-crown the peaks with splendor, scatter rose petals down your paths,
- 11 You crown the year with your bounty, and your carts overflow with abundance.
- 12 All through the wild meadows, rose petals. Set the hills to dancing,
- 12 The grasslands of the desert overflow; the hills are clothed with gladness.
- 13 Dress the canyon walls with live sheep, a drape of flax across the valleys. Let them shout, and shout, and shout! Oh, oh, let them sing!
- 13 The meadows are covered with flocks and the valleys are mantled with grain; they shout for joy and sing.

Psalms 66

MSG

NIV

- 1 All together now--applause for God!
- 1 For the director of music. A song. A psalm. Shout with joy to God, all the earth!
- 2 Sing songs to the tune of his glory, set glory to the rhythms of his praise.
- 2 Sing the glory of his name; make his praise glorious!
- 3 Say of God, "We've never seen anything like him!" When your enemies see you in action, they slink off like scolded dogs.

- 3 Say to God, "How awesome are your deeds! So great is your power that your enemies cringe before you.
- 4 The whole earth falls to its knees-- it worships you, sings to you, can't stop enjoying your name and fame.
- 4 All the earth bows down to you; they sing praise to you, they sing praise to your name." Selah
- 5 Take a good look at God's wonders-- they'll take your breath away.
- 5 Come and see what God has done, how awesome his works in man's behalf!
- 6 He converted sea to dry land; travelers crossed the river on foot. Now isn't that cause for a song?
- 6 He turned the sea into dry land, they passed through the waters on foot-- come, let us rejoice in him.
- 7 Ever sovereign in his high tower, he keeps his eye on the godless nations. Rebels don't dare raise a finger against him.
- 7 He rules forever by his power, his eyes watch the nations-- let not the rebellious rise up against him. Selah
- 8 Bless our God, O peoples! Give him a thunderous welcome!
- 8 Praise our God, O peoples, let the sound of his praise be heard;
- 9 Didn't he set us on the road to life? Didn't he keep us out of the ditch?
- 9 he has preserved our lives and kept our feet from slipping.
- 10 He trained us first, passed us like silver through refining fires,
- 10 For you, O God, tested us; you refined us like silver.
- 11 Brought us into hardships country, pushed us to our very limit,
- 11 You brought us into prison and laid burdens on our backs.
- 12 Road-tested us inside and out, took us to hell and back; Finally he brought us to this well-watered place.
- 12 You let men ride over our heads; we went through fire and water, but you brought us to a place of abundance.
- 13 I'm bringing my prizes and presents to your house. I'm doing what I said I'd do,
- 13 I will come to your temple with burnt offerings and fulfill my vows to you--
- 14 What I solemnly swore I'd do that day when I was in so much trouble:
- 14 vows my lips promised and my mouth spoke when I was in trouble.

- 15 The choicest cuts of meat for the sacrificial meal; Even the fragrance of roasted lamb is like a meal! Or make it an ox garnished with goat meat!
- 15 I will sacrifice fat animals to you and an offering of rams; I will offer bulls and goats. Selah
- 16 All believers, come here and listen, let me tell you what God did for me.
- 16 Come and listen, all you who fear God; let me tell you what he has done for me.
- 17 I called out to him with my mouth, my tongue shaped the sounds of music.
- 17 I cried out to him with my mouth; his praise was on my tongue.
- 18 If I had been cozy with evil, the Lord would never have listened.
- 18 If I had cherished sin in my heart, the Lord would not have listened;
- 19 But he most surely did listen, he came on the double when he heard my prayer.
- 19 but God has surely listened and heard my voice in prayer.
- 20 Blessed be God: he didn't turn a deaf ear, he stayed with me, loyal in his love.
- 20 Praise be to God, who has not rejected my prayer or withheld his love from me!

Psalms 67

MSG

NIV

- 1 God, mark us with grace and blessing! Smile!
- 1 For the director of music. With stringed instruments. A psalm. A song.
May God be gracious to us and bless us and make his face shine upon us,
Selah
- 2 The whole country will see how you work, all the godless nations see how you save.
- 2 that your ways may be known on earth, your salvation among all nations.
- 3 God! Let people thank and enjoy you. Let all people thank and enjoy you.
- 3 May the peoples praise you, O God; may all the peoples praise you.
- 4 Let all far-flung people become happy and shout their happiness because
You judge them fair and square, you tend the far-flung peoples.

- 4 May the nations be glad and sing for joy, for you rule the peoples justly and guide the nations of the earth. Selah
- 5 God! Let people thank and enjoy you. Let all people thank and enjoy you.
- 5 May the peoples praise you, O God; may all the peoples praise you.
- 6 Earth, display your exuberance! You mark us with blessing, O God, our God.
- 6 Then the land will yield its harvest, and God, our God, will bless us.
- 7 You mark us with blessing, O God. Earth's four corners--honor him!
- 7 God will bless us, and all the ends of the earth will fear him.

Psalms 68

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Up with God! Down with his enemies! Adversaries, run for the hills!
- 1 For the director of music. Of David. A psalm. A song. May God arise, may his enemies be scattered; may his foes flee before him.
- 2 Gone like a puff of smoke, like a blob of wax in the fire-- one look at God and the wicked vanish.
- 2 As smoke is blown away by the wind, may you blow them away; as wax melts before the fire, may the wicked perish before God.
- 3 When the righteous see God in action they'll laugh, they'll sing, they'll laugh and sing for joy.
- 3 But may the righteous be glad and rejoice before God; may they be happy and joyful.
- 4 Sing hymns to God; all heaven, sing out; clear the way for the coming of Cloud-Rider. Enjoy GOD, cheer when you see him!
- 4 Sing to God, sing praise to his name, extol him who rides on the clouds-- his name is the LORD-- and rejoice before him.
- 5 Father of orphans, champion of widows, is God in his holy house.
- 5 A father to the fatherless, a defender of widows, is God in his holy dwelling.
- 6 God makes homes for the homeless, leads prisoners to freedom, but leaves rebels to rot in hell.

- 6 God sets the lonely in families, he leads forth the prisoners with singing;
but the rebellious live in a sun-scorched land.
- 7 God, when you took the lead with your people, when you marched out
into the wild,
- 7 When you went out before your people, O God, when you marched
through the wasteland, Selah
- 8 Earth shook, sky broke out in a sweat; God was on the march. Even Sinai
trembled at the sight of God on the move, at the sight of Israel's God.
- 8 the earth shook, the heavens poured down rain, before God, the One of
Sinai, before God, the God of Israel.
- 9 You pour out rain in buckets, O God; thorn and cactus become an oasis
- 9 You gave abundant showers, O God; you refreshed your weary
inheritance.
- 10 For your people to camp in and enjoy. You set them up in business; they
went from rags to riches.
- 10 Your people settled in it, and from your bounty, O God, you provided
for the poor.
- 11 The Lord gave the word; thousands called out the good news:
- 11 The Lord announced the word, and great was the company of those who
proclaimed it:
- 12 "Kings of the armies are on the run, on the run!"
- 12 Kings and armies flee in haste; in the camps men divide the plunder.
- 13 While housewives, safe and sound back home, divide up the plunder,
the plunder of Canaanite silver and gold.
- 13 Even while you sleep among the campfires, the wings of my dove are
sheathed with silver, its feathers with shining gold."
- 14 On that day that Shaddai scattered the kings, snow fell on Black
Mountain.
- 14 When the Almighty scattered the kings in the land, it was like snow
fallen on Zalmon.
- 15 You huge mountains, Bashan mountains, mighty mountains, dragon
mountains.
- 15 The mountains of Bashan are majestic mountains; rugged are the
mountains of Bashan.
- 16 All you mountains not chosen, sulk now, and feel sorry for yourselves,
For this is the mountain God has chosen to live on; he'll rule from this

mountain forever.

16 Why gaze in envy, O rugged mountains, at the mountain where God chooses to reign, where the LORD himself will dwell forever?

17 The chariots of God, twice ten thousand, and thousands more besides,
The Lord in the lead, riding down Sinai-- straight to the Holy Place!

17 The chariots of God are tens of thousands and thousands of thousands;
the Lord has come from Sinai into his sanctuary.

18 You climbed to the High Place, captives in tow, your arms full of booty
from rebels, And now you sit there in state, GOD, sovereign GOD!

18 When you ascended on high, you led captives in your train; you
received gifts from men, even from the rebellious-- that you, O LORD
God, might dwell there.

19 Blessed be the Lord-- day after day he carries us along.

19 Praise be to the Lord, to God our Savior, who daily bears our burdens.
Selah

20 He's our Savior, our God, oh yes! He's God-for-us, he's God-who-saves-
us. Lord GOD knows all death's ins and outs.

20 Our God is a God who saves; from the Sovereign LORD comes escape
from death.

21 What's more, he made heads roll, split the skulls of the enemy As he
marched out of heaven,

21 Surely God will crush the heads of his enemies, the hairy crowns of
those who go on in their sins.

22 saying, "I tied up the Dragon in knots, put a muzzle on the Deep Blue
Sea."

22 The Lord says, "I will bring them from Bashan; I will bring them from
the depths of the sea,

23 You can wade through your enemies' blood, and your dogs taste of your
enemies from your boots.

23 that you may plunge your feet in the blood of your foes, while the
tongues of your dogs have their share."

24 See God on parade to the sanctuary, my God, my King on the march!

24 Your procession has come into view, O God, the procession of my God
and King into the sanctuary.

25 Singers out front, the band behind, maidens in the middle with
castanets.

- 25 In front are the singers, after them the musicians; with them are the maidens playing tambourines.
- 26 The whole choir blesses God. Like a fountain of praise, Israel blesses GOD.
- 26 Praise God in the great congregation; praise the LORD in the assembly of Israel.
- 27 Look--little Benjamin's out front and leading Princes of Judah in their royal robes, princes of Zebulun, princes of Naphtali.
- 27 There is the little tribe of Benjamin, leading them, there the great throng of Judah's princes, and there the princes of Zebulun and of Naphtali.
- 28 Parade your power, O God, the power, O God, that made us what we are.
- 28 Summon your power, O God; show us your strength, O God, as you have done before.
- 29 Your temple, High God, is Jerusalem; kings bring gifts to you.
- 29 Because of your temple at Jerusalem kings will bring you gifts.
- 30 Rebuke that old crocodile, Egypt, with her herd of wild bulls and calves, Rapacious in her lust for silver, crushing peoples, spoiling for a fight.
- 30 Rebuke the beast among the reeds, the herd of bulls among the calves of the nations. Humbled, may it bring bars of silver. Scatter the nations who delight in war.
- 31 Let Egyptian traders bring blue cloth and Cush come running to God, her hands outstretched.
- 31 Envoys will come from Egypt; Cush will submit herself to God.
- 32 Sing, O kings of the earth! Sing praises to the Lord!
- 32 Sing to God, O kingdoms of the earth, sing praise to the Lord, Selah
- 33 There he is: Sky-Rider, striding the ancient skies. Listen--he's calling in thunder, rumbling, rolling thunder.
- 33 to him who rides the ancient skies above, who thunders with mighty voice.
- 34 Call out "Bravo!" to God, the High God of Israel. His splendor and strength rise huge as thunderheads.
- 34 Proclaim the power of God, whose majesty is over Israel, whose power is in the skies.
- 35 A terrible beauty, O God, streams from your sanctuary. It's Israel's strong God! He gives power and might to his people! O you, his people--

bless God!

35 You are awesome, O God, in your sanctuary; the God of Israel gives power and strength to his people. Praise be to God!

Psalms 69

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. God, God, save me! I'm in over my head,
- 1 For the director of music. To the tune of "Lilies." Of David. Save me, O God, for the waters have come up to my neck.
- 2 Quicksand under me, swamp water over me; I'm going down for the third time.
- 2 I sink in the miry depths, where there is no foothold. I have come into the deep waters; the floods engulf me.
- 3 I'm hoarse from calling for help, Bleary-eyed from searching the sky for God.
- 3 I am worn out calling for help; my throat is parched. My eyes fail, looking for my God.
- 4 I've got more enemies than hairs on my head; Sneaks and liars are out to knife me in the back. What I never stole Must I now give back?
- 4 Those who hate me without reason outnumber the hairs of my head; many are my enemies without cause, those who seek to destroy me. I am forced to restore what I did not steal.
- 5 God, you know every sin I've committed; My life's a wide-open book before you.
- 5 You know my folly, O God; my guilt is not hidden from you.
- 6 Don't let those who look to you in hope Be discouraged by what happens to me, Dear Lord! GOD of the armies! Don't let those out looking for you Come to a dead end by following me-- Please, dear God of Israel!
- 6 May those who hope in you not be disgraced because of me, O Lord, the LORD Almighty; may those who seek you not be put to shame because of me, O God of Israel.
- 7 Because of you I look like an idiot, I walk around ashamed to show my face.
- 7 For I endure scorn for your sake, and shame covers my face.

8 My brothers shun me like a bum off the street; My family treats me like an unwanted guest.

8 I am a stranger to my brothers, an alien to my own mother's sons;

9 I love you more than I can say. Because I'm madly in love with you, They blame me for everything they dislike about you.

9 for zeal for your house consumes me, and the insults of those who insult you fall on me.

10 When I poured myself out in prayer and fasting, All it got me was more contempt.

10 When I weep and fast, I must endure scorn;

11 When I put on a sad face, They treated me like a clown.

11 when I put on sackcloth, people make sport of me.

12 Now drunks and gluttons Make up drinking songs about me.

12 Those who sit at the gate mock me, and I am the song of the drunkards.

13 And me? I pray. GOD, it's time for a break! God, answer in love! Answer with your sure salvation!

13 But I pray to you, O LORD, in the time of your favor; in your great love, O God, answer me with your sure salvation.

14 Rescue me from the swamp, Don't let me go under for good, Pull me out of the clutch of the enemy; This whirlpool is sucking me down.

14 Rescue me from the mire, do not let me sink; deliver me from those who hate me, from the deep waters.

15 Don't let the swamp be my grave, the Black Hole Swallow me, its jaws clenched around me.

15 Do not let the floodwaters engulf me or the depths swallow me up or the pit close its mouth over me.

16 Now answer me, GOD, because you love me; Let me see your great mercy full-face.

16 Answer me, O LORD, out of the goodness of your love; in your great mercy turn to me.

17 Don't look the other way; your servant can't take it. I'm in trouble. Answer right now!

17 Do not hide your face from your servant; answer me quickly, for I am in trouble.

18 Come close, God; get me out of here. Rescue me from this deathtrap.

18 Come near and rescue me; redeem me because of my foes.

19 You know how they kick me around-- Pin on me the donkey's ears, the dunce's cap.

19 You know how I am scorned, disgraced and shamed; all my enemies are before you.

20 I'm broken by their taunts, Flat on my face, reduced to a nothing. I looked in vain for one friendly face. Not one. I couldn't find one shoulder to cry on.

20 Scorn has broken my heart and has left me helpless; I looked for sympathy, but there was none, for comforters, but I found none.

21 They put poison in my soup, Vinegar in my drink.

21 They put gall in my food and gave me vinegar for my thirst.

22 Let their supper be bait in a trap that snaps shut; May their best friends be trappers who'll skin them alive.

22 May the table set before them become a snare; may it become retribution and a trap.

23 Make them become blind as bats, Give them the shakes from morning to night.

23 May their eyes be darkened so they cannot see, and their backs be bent forever.

24 Let them know what you think of them, Blast them with your red-hot anger.

24 Pour out your wrath on them; let your fierce anger overtake them.

25 Burn down their houses, Leave them desolate with nobody at home.

25 May their place be deserted; let there be no one to dwell in their tents.

26 They gossiped about the one you disciplined, Made up stories about anyone wounded by God.

26 For they persecute those you wound and talk about the pain of those you hurt.

27 Pile on the guilt, Don't let them off the hook.

27 Charge them with crime upon crime; do not let them share in your salvation.

28 Strike their names from the list of the living; No rock-carved honor for them among the righteous.

28 May they be blotted out of the book of life and not be listed with the righteous.

29 I'm hurt and in pain; Give me space for healing, and mountain air.

29 I am in pain and distress; may your salvation, O God, protect me.
30 Let me shout God's name with a praising song, Let me tell his greatness in a prayer of thanks.
30 I will praise God's name in song and glorify him with thanksgiving.
31 For GOD, this is better than oxen on the altar, Far better than blue-ribbon bulls.
31 This will please the LORD more than an ox, more than a bull with its horns and hoofs.
32 The poor in spirit see and are glad-- Oh, you God-seekers, take heart!
32 The poor will see and be glad-- you who seek God, may your hearts live!
33 For GOD listens to the poor, He doesn't walk out on the wretched.
33 The LORD hears the needy and does not despise his captive people.
34 You heavens, praise him; praise him, earth; Also ocean and all things that swim in it.
34 Let heaven and earth praise him, the seas and all that move in them,
35 For God is out to help Zion, Rebuilding the wrecked towns of Judah. Guess who will live there-- The proud owners of the land?
35 for God will save Zion and rebuild the cities of Judah. Then people will settle there and possess it;
36 No, the children of his servants will get it, The lovers of his name will live in it.
36 the children of his servants will inherit it, and those who love his name will dwell there.

Psalms 70

MSG

NIV

1 A David prayer. God! Please hurry to my rescue! God, come quickly to my side!
1 For the director of music. Of David. A petition. Hasten, O God, to save me; O LORD, come quickly to help me.
2 Those who are out to get me-- let them fall all over themselves. Those who relish my downfall-- send them down a blind alley.

- 2 May those who seek my life be put to shame and confusion; may all who desire my ruin be turned back in disgrace.
- 3 Give them a taste of their own medicine, those gossips off clucking their tongues.
- 3 May those who say to me, "Aha! Aha!" turn back because of their shame.
- 4 Let those on the hunt for you sing and celebrate. Let all who love your saving way say over and over, "God is mighty!"
- 4 But may all who seek you rejoice and be glad in you; may those who love your salvation always say, "Let God be exalted!"
- 5 But I've lost it. I'm wasted. God--quickly, quickly! Quick to my side, quick to my rescue! GOD, don't lose a minute.
- 5 Yet I am poor and needy; come quickly to me, O God. You are my help and my deliverer; O LORD, do not delay.

Psalms 71

MSG

NIV

- 1 I run for dear life to GOD, I'll never live to regret it.
- 1 In you, O LORD, I have taken refuge; let me never be put to shame.
- 2 Do what you do so well: get me out of this mess and up on my feet. Put your ear to the ground and listen, give me space for salvation.
- 2 Rescue me and deliver me in your righteousness; turn your ear to me and save me.
- 3 Be a guest room where I can retreat; you said your door was always open! You're my salvation--my vast, granite fortress.
- 3 Be my rock of refuge, to which I can always go; give the command to save me, for you are my rock and my fortress.
- 4 My God, free me from the grip of Wicked, from the clutch of Bad and Bully.
- 4 Deliver me, O my God, from the hand of the wicked, from the grasp of evil and cruel men.
- 5 You keep me going when times are tough-- my bedrock, GOD, since my childhood.
- 5 For you have been my hope, O Sovereign LORD, my confidence since my youth.

6 I've hung on you from the day of my birth, the day you took me from the cradle; I'll never run out of praise.

6 From birth I have relied on you; you brought me forth from my mother's womb. I will ever praise you.

7 Many gasp in alarm when they see me, but you take me in stride.

7 I have become like a portent to many, but you are my strong refuge.

8 Just as each day brims with your beauty, my mouth brims with praise.

8 My mouth is filled with your praise, declaring your splendor all day long.

9 But don't turn me out to pasture when I'm old or put me on the shelf when I can't pull my weight.

9 Do not cast me away when I am old; do not forsake me when my strength is gone.

10 My enemies are talking behind my back, watching for their chance to knife me.

10 For my enemies speak against me; those who wait to kill me conspire together.

11 The gossip is: "God has abandoned him. Pounce on him now; no one will help him."

11 They say, "God has forsaken him; pursue him and seize him, for no one will rescue him."

12 God, don't just watch from the sidelines. Come on! Run to my side!

12 Be not far from me, O God; come quickly, O my God, to help me.

13 My accusers--make them lose face. Those out to get me--make them look Like idiots,

13 May my accusers perish in shame; may those who want to harm me be covered with scorn and disgrace.

14 while I stretch out, reaching for you, and daily add praise to praise.

14 But as for me, I will always have hope; I will praise you more and more.

15 I'll write the book on your righteousness, talk up your salvation the livelong day, never run out of good things to write or say.

15 My mouth will tell of your righteousness, of your salvation all day long, though I know not its measure.

16 I come in the power of the Lord GOD, I post signs marking his right-of-way.

16 I will come and proclaim your mighty acts, O Sovereign LORD; I will proclaim your righteousness, yours alone.

17 You got me when I was an unformed youth, God, and taught me everything I know. Now I'm telling the world your wonders;
17 Since my youth, O God, you have taught me, and to this day I declare your marvelous deeds.
18 I'll keep at it until I'm old and gray. God, don't walk off and leave me until I get out the news Of your strong right arm to this world, news of your power to the world yet to come,
18 Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, O God, till I declare your power to the next generation, your might to all who are to come.
19 Your famous and righteous ways, O God. God, you've done it all! Who is quite like you?
19 Your righteousness reaches to the skies, O God, you who have done great things. Who, O God, is like you?
20 You, who made me stare trouble in the face, Turn me around; Now let me look life in the face. I've been to the bottom; Bring me up,
20 Though you have made me see troubles, many and bitter, you will restore my life again; from the depths of the earth you will again bring me up.
21 streaming with honors; turn to me, be tender to me,
21 You will increase my honor and comfort me once again.
22 And I'll take up the lute and thank you to the tune of your faithfulness, God. I'll make music for you on a harp, Holy One of Israel.
22 I will praise you with the harp for your faithfulness, O my God; I will sing praise to you with the lyre, O Holy One of Israel.
23 When I open up in song to you, I let out lungsful of praise, my rescued life a song.
23 My lips will shout for joy when I sing praise to you-- I, whom you have redeemed.
24 All day long I'm chanting about you and your righteous ways, While those who tried to do me in slink off looking ashamed.
24 My tongue will tell of your righteous acts all day long, for those who wanted to harm me have been put to shame and confusion.

Psalms 72

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Solomon psalm. Give the gift of wise rule to the king, O God, the gift of just rule to the crown prince.
- 1 Of Solomon. Endow the king with your justice, O God, the royal son with your righteousness.
- 2 May he judge your people rightly, be honorable to your meek and lowly.
- 2 He will judge your people in righteousness, your afflicted ones with justice.
- 3 Let the mountains give exuberant witness; shape the hills with the contours of right living.
- 3 The mountains will bring prosperity to the people, the hills the fruit of righteousness.
- 4 Please stand up for the poor, help the children of the needy, come down hard on the cruel tyrants.
- 4 He will defend the afflicted among the people and save the children of the needy; he will crush the oppressor.
- 5 Outlast the sun, outlive the moon-- age after age after age.
- 5 He will endure as long as the sun, as long as the moon, through all generations.
- 6 Be rainfall on cut grass, earth-refreshing rain showers.
- 6 He will be like rain falling on a mown field, like showers watering the earth.
- 7 Let righteousness burst into blossom and peace abound until the moon fades to nothing.
- 7 In his days the righteous will flourish; prosperity will abound till the moon is no more.
- 8 Rule from sea to sea, from the River to the Rim.
- 8 He will rule from sea to sea and from the River to the ends of the earth.
- 9 Foes will fall on their knees before God, his enemies lick the dust.
- 9 The desert tribes will bow before him and his enemies will lick the dust.
- 10 Kings remote and legendary will pay homage, kings rich and resplendent will turn over their wealth.
- 10 The kings of Tarshish and of distant shores will bring tribute to him; the kings of Sheba and Seba will present him gifts.
- 11 All kings will fall down and worship, and godless nations sign up to serve him,

- 11 All kings will bow down to him and all nations will serve him.
- 12 Because he rescues the poor at the first sign of need, the destitute who have run out of luck.
- 12 For he will deliver the needy who cry out, the afflicted who have no one to help.
- 13 He opens a place in his heart for the down-and-out, he restores the wretched of the earth.
- 13 He will take pity on the weak and the needy and save the needy from death.
- 14 He frees them from tyranny and torture-- when they bleed, he bleeds; when they die, he dies.
- 14 He will rescue them from oppression and violence, for precious is their blood in his sight.
- 15 And live! Oh, let him live! Deck him out in Sheba gold. Offer prayers unceasing to him, bless him from morning to night.
- 15 Long may he live! May gold from Sheba be given him. May people ever pray for him and bless him all day long.
- 16 Fields of golden grain in the land, cresting the mountains in wild exuberance, Cornucopias of praise, praises springing from the city like grass from the earth.
- 16 Let grain abound throughout the land; on the tops of the hills may it sway. Let its fruit flourish like Lebanon; let it thrive like the grass of the field.
- 17 May he never be forgotten, his fame shine on like sunshine. May all godless people enter his circle of blessing and bless the One who blessed them.
- 17 May his name endure forever; may it continue as long as the sun. All nations will be blessed through him, and they will call him blessed.
- 18 Blessed GOD, Israel's God, the one and only wonder-working God!
- 18 Praise be to the LORD God, the God of Israel, who alone does marvelous deeds.
- 19 Blessed always his blazing glory! All earth brims with his glory.
- 19 Praise be to his glorious name forever; may the whole earth be filled with his glory. Amen and Amen.
- 20 Yes and Yes and Yes.
- 20 This concludes the prayers of David son of Jesse.

Psalms 73

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. No doubt about it! God is good-- good to good people, good to the good-hearted.
- 1 A psalm of Asaph. Surely God is good to Israel, to those who are pure in heart.
- 2 But I nearly missed it, missed seeing his goodness.
- 2 But as for me, my feet had almost slipped; I had nearly lost my foothold.
- 3 I was looking the other way, looking up to the people
- 3 For I envied the arrogant when I saw the prosperity of the wicked.
- 4 At the top, envying the wicked who have it made,
- 4 They have no struggles; their bodies are healthy and strong.
- 5 Who have nothing to worry about, not a care in the whole wide world.
- 5 They are free from the burdens common to man; they are not plagued by human ills.
- 6 Pretentious with arrogance, they wear the latest fashions in violence,
- 6 Therefore pride is their necklace; they clothe themselves with violence.
- 7 Pampered and overfed, decked out in silk bows of silliness.
- 7 From their callous hearts comes iniquity; the evil conceits of their minds know no limits.
- 8 They jeer, using words to kill; they bully their way with words.
- 8 They scoff, and speak with malice; in their arrogance they threaten oppression.
- 9 They're full of hot air, loudmouths disturbing the peace.
- 9 Their mouths lay claim to heaven, and their tongues take possession of the earth.
- 10 People actually listen to them--can you believe it? Like thirsty puppies, they lap up their words.
- 10 Therefore their people turn to them and drink up waters in abundance.
- 11 What's going on here? Is God out to lunch? Nobody's tending the store.
- 11 They say, "How can God know? Does the Most High have knowledge?"
- 12 The wicked get by with everything; they have it made, piling up riches
- 12 This is what the wicked are like-- always carefree, they increase in wealth.

13 I've been stupid to play by the rules; what has it gotten me?
13 Surely in vain have I kept my heart pure; in vain have I washed my hands in innocence.
14 A long run of bad luck, that's what-- a slap in the face every time I walk out the door.
14 All day long I have been plagued; I have been punished every morning.
15 If I'd have given in and talked like this, I would have betrayed your dear children.
15 If I had said, "I will speak thus," I would have betrayed your children.
16 Still, when I tried to figure it out, all I got was a splitting headache . . .
16 When I tried to understand all this, it was oppressive to me
17 Until I entered the sanctuary of God. Then I saw the whole picture:
17 till I entered the sanctuary of God; then I understood their final destiny.
18 The slippery road you've put them on, with a final crash in a ditch of delusions.
18 Surely you place them on slippery ground; you cast them down to ruin.
19 In the blink of an eye, disaster! A blind curve in the dark, and-- nightmare!
19 How suddenly are they destroyed, completely swept away by terrors!
20 We wake up and rub our eyes. . . . Nothing. There's nothing to them. And there never was.
20 As a dream when one awakes, so when you arise, O Lord, you will despise them as fantasies.
21 When I was beleaguered and bitter, totally consumed by envy,
21 When my heart was grieved and my spirit embittered,
22 I was totally ignorant, a dumb ox in your very presence.
22 I was senseless and ignorant; I was a brute beast before you.
23 I'm still in your presence, but you've taken my hand.
23 Yet I am always with you; you hold me by my right hand.
24 You wisely and tenderly lead me, and then you bless me.
24 You guide me with your counsel, and afterward you will take me into glory.
25 You're all I want in heaven! You're all I want on earth!
25 Whom have I in heaven but you? And earth has nothing I desire besides you.

- 26 When my skin sags and my bones get brittle, GOD is rock-firm and faithful.
- 26 My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever.
- 27 Look! Those who left you are falling apart! Deserters, they'll never be heard from again.
- 27 Those who are far from you will perish; you destroy all who are unfaithful to you.
- 28 But I'm in the very presence of God-- oh, how refreshing it is! I've made Lord GOD my home. God, I'm telling the world what you do!
- 28 But as for me, it is good to be near God. I have made the Sovereign LORD my refuge; I will tell of all your deeds.

Psalms 74

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. You walked off and left us, and never looked back. God, how could you do that? We're your very own sheep; how can you stomp off in anger?
- 1 A maskil of Asaph. Why have you rejected us forever, O God? Why does your anger smolder against the sheep of your pasture?
- 2 Refresh your memory of us--you bought us a long time ago. Your most precious tribe--you paid a good price for us! Your very own Mount Zion--you actually lived here once!
- 2 Remember the people you purchased of old, the tribe of your inheritance, whom you redeemed-- Mount Zion, where you dwelt.
- 3 Come and visit the site of disaster, see how they've wrecked the sanctuary.
- 3 Turn your steps toward these everlasting ruins, all this destruction the enemy has brought on the sanctuary.
- 4 While your people were at worship, your enemies barged in, brawling and scrawling graffiti.
- 4 Your foes roared in the place where you met with us; they set up their standards as signs.

5 They set fire to the porch; axes swinging, they chopped up the
woodwork,
5 They behaved like men wielding axes to cut through a thicket of trees.
6 Beat down the doors with sledgehammers, then split them into kindling.
6 They smashed all the carved paneling with their axes and hatchets.
7 They burned your holy place to the ground, violated the place of worship.
7 They burned your sanctuary to the ground; they defiled the dwelling
place of your Name.
8 They said to themselves, "We'll wipe them all out," and burned down all
the places of worship.
8 They said in their hearts, "We will crush them completely!" They burned
every place where God was worshiped in the land.
9 There's not a sign or symbol of God in sight, nor anyone to speak in his
name, no one who knows what's going on.
9 We are given no miraculous signs; no prophets are left, and none of us
knows how long this will be.
10 How long, God, will barbarians blaspheme, enemies curse and get by
with it?
10 How long will the enemy mock you, O God? Will the foe revile your
name forever?
11 Why don't you do something? How long are you going to sit there with
your hands folded in your lap?
11 Why do you hold back your hand, your right hand? Take it from the
folds of your garment and destroy them!
12 God is my King from the very start; he works salvation in the womb of
the earth.
12 But you, O God, are my king from of old; you bring salvation upon the
earth.
13 With one blow you split the sea in two, you made mincemeat of the
dragon Tannin.
13 It was you who split open the sea by your power; you broke the heads of
the monster in the waters.
14 You lopped off the heads of Leviathan, then served them up in a stew
for the animals.
14 It was you who crushed the heads of Leviathan and gave him as food to
the creatures of the desert.

- 15 With your finger you opened up springs and creeks, and dried up the wild floodwaters.
- 15 It was you who opened up springs and streams; you dried up the ever flowing rivers.
- 16 You own the day, you own the night; you put stars and sun in place.
- 16 The day is yours, and yours also the night; you established the sun and moon.
- 17 You laid out the four corners of earth, shaped the seasons of summer and winter.
- 17 It was you who set all the boundaries of the earth; you made both summer and winter.
- 18 Mark and remember, GOD, all the enemy taunts, each idiot desecration.
- 18 Remember how the enemy has mocked you, O LORD, how foolish people have reviled your name.
- 19 Don't throw your lambs to the wolves; after all we've been through, don't forget us.
- 19 Do not hand over the life of your dove to wild beasts; do not forget the lives of your afflicted people forever.
- 20 Remember your promises; the city is in darkness, the countryside violent.
- 20 Have regard for your covenant, because haunts of violence fill the dark places of the land.
- 21 Don't leave the victims to rot in the street; make them a choir that sings your praises.
- 21 Do not let the oppressed retreat in disgrace; may the poor and needy praise your name.
- 22 On your feet, O God-- stand up for yourself! Do you hear what they're saying about you, all the vile obscenities?
- 22 Rise up, O God, and defend your cause; remember how fools mock you all day long.
- 23 Don't tune out their malicious filth, the brawling invective that never lets up.
- 23 Do not ignore the clamor of your adversaries, the uproar of your enemies, which rises continually.

Psalms 75

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. We thank you, God, we thank you-- your Name is our favorite word; your mighty works are all we talk about.
- 1 For the director of music. To the tune of "Do Not Destroy." A psalm of Asaph. A song. We give thanks to you, O God, we give thanks, for your Name is near; men tell of your wonderful deeds.
- 2 You say, "I'm calling this meeting to order, I'm ready to set things right.
- 2 You say, "I choose the appointed time; it is I who judge uprightly.
- 3 When the earth goes topsy-turvy And nobody knows which end is up, I nail it all down, I put everything in place again.
- 3 When the earth and all its people quake, it is I who hold its pillars firm. Selah
- 4 I say to the smart alecks, 'That's enough,' to the bullies, 'Not so fast.'"
- 4 To the arrogant I say, 'Boast no more,' and to the wicked, 'Do not lift up your horns.
- 5 Don't raise your fist against High God. Don't raise your voice against Rock of Ages.
- 5 Do not lift your horns against heaven; do not speak with outstretched neck.' "
- 6 He's the One from east to west; from desert to mountains, he's the One.
- 6 No one from the east or the west or from the desert can exalt a man.
- 7 God rules: he brings this one down to his knees, pulls that one up on her feet.
- 7 But it is God who judges: He brings one down, he exalts another.
- 8 GOD has a cup in his hand, a bowl of wine, full to the brim. He draws from it and pours; it's drained to the dregs. Earth's wicked ones drink it all, drink it down to the last bitter drop!
- 8 In the hand of the LORD is a cup full of foaming wine mixed with spices; he pours it out, and all the wicked of the earth drink it down to its very dregs.
- 9 And I'm telling the story of God Eternal, singing the praises of Jacob's God.

- 9 As for me, I will declare this forever; I will sing praise to the God of Jacob.
- 10 The fists of the wicked are bloody stumps, The arms of the righteous are lofty green branches.
- 10 I will cut off the horns of all the wicked, but the horns of the righteous will be lifted up.

Psalms 76

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. God is well-known in Judah; in Israel, he's a household name.
- 1 For the director of music. With stringed instruments. A psalm of Asaph. A song. In Judah God is known; his name is great in Israel.
- 2 He keeps a house in Salem, his own suite of rooms in Zion.
- 2 His tent is in Salem, his dwelling place in Zion.
- 3 That's where, using arrows for kindling, he made a bonfire of weapons of war.
- 3 There he broke the flashing arrows, the shields and the swords, the weapons of war. Selah
- 4 Oh, how bright you shine! Outshining their huge piles of loot!
- 4 You are resplendent with light, more majestic than mountains rich with game.
- 5 The warriors were plundered and left there impotent. And now there's nothing to them, nothing to show for their swagger and threats.
- 5 Valiant men lie plundered, they sleep their last sleep; not one of the warriors can lift his hands.
- 6 Your sudden roar, God of Jacob, knocked the wind out of horse and rider.
- 6 At your rebuke, O God of Jacob, both horse and chariot lie still.
- 7 Fierce you are, and fearsome! Who can stand up to your rising anger?
- 7 You alone are to be feared. Who can stand before you when you are angry?
- 8 From heaven you thunder judgment; earth falls to her knees and holds her breath.
- 8 From heaven you pronounced judgment, and the land feared and was quiet--
- 9 God stands tall and makes things right, he saves all the wretched on earth.
- 9 when you, O God, rose up to judge, to save all the afflicted of the land. Selah

- 10 Instead of smoldering rage--God-praise! All that sputtering rage--now a garland for God!
- 10 Surely your wrath against men brings you praise, and the survivors of your wrath are restrained.
- 11 Do for GOD what you said you'd do-- he is, after all, your God. Let everyone in town bring offerings to the One Who Watches our every move.
- 11 Make vows to the LORD your God and fulfill them; let all the neighboring lands bring gifts to the One to be feared.
- 12 Nobody gets by with anything, no one plays fast and loose with him.
- 12 He breaks the spirit of rulers; he is feared by the kings of the earth.

Psalms 77

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. I yell out to my God, I yell with all my might, I yell at the top of my lungs. He listens.
- 1 For the director of music. For Jeduthun. Of Asaph. A psalm. I cried out to God for help; I cried out to God to hear me.
- 2 I found myself in trouble and went looking for my Lord; my life was an open wound that wouldn't heal. When friends said, "Everything will turn out all right," I didn't believe a word they said.
- 2 When I was in distress, I sought the Lord; at night I stretched out untiring hands and my soul refused to be comforted.
- 3 I remember God--and shake my head. I bow my head--then wring my hands.
- 3 I remembered you, O God, and I groaned; I mused, and my spirit grew faint. Selah
- 4 I'm awake all night--not a wink of sleep; I can't even say what's bothering me.
- 4 You kept my eyes from closing; I was too troubled to speak.
- 5 I go over the days one by one, I ponder the years gone by.
- 5 I thought about the former days, the years of long ago;
- 6 I strum my lute all through the night, wondering how to get my life together.

6 I remembered my songs in the night. My heart mused and my spirit inquired:
7 Will the Lord walk off and leave us for good? Will he never smile again?
7 Will the Lord reject forever? Will he never show his favor again?
8 Is his love worn threadbare? Has his salvation promise burned out?
8 Has his unfailing love vanished forever? Has his promise failed for all time?
9 Has God forgotten his manners? Has he angrily stalked off and left us?
9 Has God forgotten to be merciful? Has he in anger withheld his compassion?" Selah
10 "Just my luck," I said. "The High God goes out of business just the moment I need him."
10 Then I thought, "To this I will appeal: the years of the right hand of the Most High."
11 Once again I'll go over what GOD has done, lay out on the table the ancient wonders;
11 I will remember the deeds of the LORD; yes, I will remember your miracles of long ago.
12 I'll ponder all the things you've accomplished, and give a long, loving look at your acts.
12 I will meditate on all your works and consider all your mighty deeds.
13 O God! Your way is holy! No god is great like God!
13 Your ways, O God, are holy. What god is so great as our God?
14 You're the God who makes things happen; you showed everyone what you can do--
14 You are the God who performs miracles; you display your power among the peoples.
15 You pulled your people out of the worst kind of trouble, rescued the children of Jacob and Joseph.
15 With your mighty arm you redeemed your people, the descendants of Jacob and Joseph. Selah
16 Ocean saw you in action, God, saw you and trembled with fear; Deep Ocean was scared to death.
16 The waters saw you, O God, the waters saw you and writhed; the very depths were convulsed.

- 17 Clouds belched buckets of rain, Sky exploded with thunder, your arrows flashing this way and that.
- 17 The clouds poured down water, the skies resounded with thunder; your arrows flashed back and forth.
- 18 From Whirlwind came your thundering voice, Lightning exposed the world, Earth reeled and rocked.
- 18 Your thunder was heard in the whirlwind, your lightning lit up the world; the earth trembled and quaked.
- 19 You strode right through Ocean, walked straight through roaring Ocean, but nobody saw you come or go.
- 19 Your path led through the sea, your way through the mighty waters, though your footprints were not seen.
- 20 Hidden in the hands of Moses and Aaron, You led your people like a flock of sheep.
- 20 You led your people like a flock by the hand of Moses and Aaron.

Psalms 78

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. Listen, dear friends, to God's truth, bend your ears to what I tell you.
- 1 A maskil of Asaph. O my people, hear my teaching; listen to the words of my mouth.
- 2 I'm chewing on the morsel of a proverb; I'll let you in on the sweet old truths,
- 2 I will open my mouth in parables, I will utter hidden things, things from of old--
- 3 Stories we heard from our fathers, counsel we learned at our mother's knee.
- 3 what we have heard and known, what our fathers have told us.
- 4 We're not keeping this to ourselves, we're passing it along to the next generation-- GOD's fame and fortune, the marvelous things he has done.
- 4 We will not hide them from their children; we will tell the next generation the praiseworthy deeds of the LORD, his power, and the wonders he has done.

- 5 He planted a witness in Jacob, set his Word firmly in Israel, Then
commanded our parents to teach it to their children
- 5 He decreed statutes for Jacob and established the law in Israel, which he
commanded our forefathers to teach their children,
- 6 So the next generation would know, and all the generations to come--
Know the truth and tell the stories so their children
- 6 so the next generation would know them, even the children yet to be
born, and they in turn would tell their children.
- 7 can trust in God, Never forget the works of God but keep his commands
to the letter.
- 7 Then they would put their trust in God and would not forget his deeds but
would keep his commands.
- 8 Heaven forbid they should be like their parents, bullheaded and bad, A
fickle and faithless bunch who never stayed true to God.
- 8 They would not be like their forefathers-- a stubborn and rebellious
generation, whose hearts were not loyal to God, whose spirits were not
faithful to him.
- 9 The Ephraimites, armed to the teeth, ran off when the battle began.
- 9 The men of Ephraim, though armed with bows, turned back on the day of
battle;
- 10 They were cowards to God's Covenant, refused to walk by his Word.
- 10 they did not keep God's covenant and refused to live by his law.
- 11 They forgot what he had done-- marvels he'd done right before their
eyes.
- 11 They forgot what he had done, the wonders he had shown them.
- 12 He performed miracles in plain sight of their parents in Egypt, out on
the fields of Zoan.
- 12 He did miracles in the sight of their fathers in the land of Egypt, in the
region of Zoan.
- 13 He split the Sea and they walked right through it; he piled the waters to
the right and the left.
- 13 He divided the sea and led them through; he made the water stand firm
like a wall.
- 14 He led them by day with a cloud, led them all the night long with a fiery
torch.

- 14 He guided them with the cloud by day and with light from the fire all night.
- 15 He split rocks in the wilderness, gave them all they could drink from underground springs;
- 15 He split the rocks in the desert and gave them water as abundant as the seas;
- 16 He made creeks flow out from sheer rock, and water pour out like a river.
- 16 he brought streams out of a rocky crag and made water flow down like rivers.
- 17 All they did was sin even more, rebel in the desert against the High God.
- 17 But they continued to sin against him, rebelling in the desert against the Most High.
- 18 They tried to get their own way with God, clamored for favors, for special attention.
- 18 They willfully put God to the test by demanding the food they craved.
- 19 They whined like spoiled children, "Why can't God give us a decent meal in this desert?"
- 19 They spoke against God, saying, "Can God spread a table in the desert?"
- 20 Sure, he struck the rock and the water flowed, creeks cascaded from the rock. But how about some fresh-baked bread? How about a nice cut of meat?"
- 20 When he struck the rock, water gushed out, and streams flowed abundantly. But can he also give us food? Can he supply meat for his people?"
- 21 When GOD heard that, he was furious-- his anger flared against Jacob, he lost his temper with Israel.
- 21 When the LORD heard them, he was very angry; his fire broke out against Jacob, and his wrath rose against Israel,
- 22 It was clear they didn't believe God, had no intention of trusting in his help.
- 22 for they did not believe in God or trust in his deliverance.
- 23 But God helped them anyway, commanded the clouds and gave orders that opened the gates of heaven.

23 Yet he gave a command to the skies above and opened the doors of the heavens;

24 He rained down showers of manna to eat, he gave them the Bread of Heaven.

24 he rained down manna for the people to eat, he gave them the grain of heaven.

25 They ate the bread of the mighty angels; he sent them all the food they could eat.

25 Men ate the bread of angels; he sent them all the food they could eat.

26 He let East Wind break loose from the skies, gave a strong push to South Wind.

26 He let loose the east wind from the heavens and led forth the south wind by his power.

27 This time it was birds that rained down-- succulent birds, an abundance of birds.

27 He rained meat down on them like dust, flying birds like sand on the seashore.

28 He aimed them right for the center of their camp; all round their tents there were birds.

28 He made them come down inside their camp, all around their tents.

29 They ate and had their fill; he handed them everything they craved on a platter.

29 They ate till they had more than enough, for he had given them what they craved.

30 But their greed knew no bounds; they stuffed their mouths with more and more.

30 But before they turned from the food they craved, even while it was still in their mouths,

31 Finally, God was fed up, his anger erupted-- he cut down their brightest and best, he laid low Israel's finest young men.

31 God's anger rose against them; he put to death the sturdiest among them, cutting down the young men of Israel.

32 And--can you believe it?--they kept right on sinning; all those wonders and they still wouldn't believe!

32 In spite of all this, they kept on sinning; in spite of his wonders, they did not believe.

33 So their lives dribbled off to nothing-- nothing to show for their lives but a ghost town.

33 So he ended their days in futility and their years in terror.

34 When he cut them down, they came running for help; they turned and pled for mercy.

34 Whenever God slew them, they would seek him; they eagerly turned to him again.

35 They gave witness that God was their rock, that High God was their redeemer,

35 They remembered that God was their Rock, that God Most High was their Redeemer.

36 But they didn't mean a word of it; they lied through their teeth the whole time.

36 But then they would flatter him with their mouths, lying to him with their tongues;

37 They could not have cared less about him, wanted nothing to do with his Covenant.

37 their hearts were not loyal to him, they were not faithful to his covenant.

38 And God? Compassionate! Forgave the sin! Didn't destroy! Over and over he reined in his anger, restrained his considerable wrath.

38 Yet he was merciful; he forgave their iniquities and did not destroy them. Time after time he restrained his anger and did not stir up his full wrath.

39 He knew what they were made of; he knew there wasn't much to them,

39 He remembered that they were but flesh, a passing breeze that does not return.

40 How often in the desert they had spurned him, tried his patience in those wilderness years.

40 How often they rebelled against him in the desert and grieved him in the wasteland!

41 Time and again they pushed him to the limit, provoked Israel's Holy God.

41 Again and again they put God to the test; they vexed the Holy One of Israel.

42 How quickly they forgot what he'd done, forgot their day of rescue from the enemy,

42 They did not remember his power-- the day he redeemed them from the oppressor,
43 When he did miracles in Egypt, wonders on the plain of Zoan.
43 the day he displayed his miraculous signs in Egypt, his wonders in the region of Zoan.
44 He turned the River and its streams to blood-- not a drop of water fit to drink.
44 He turned their rivers to blood; they could not drink from their streams.
45 He sent flies, which ate them alive, and frogs, which bedeviled them.
45 He sent swarms of flies that devoured them, and frogs that devastated them.
46 He turned their harvest over to caterpillars, everything they had worked for to the locusts.
46 He gave their crops to the grasshopper, their produce to the locust.
47 He flattened their grapevines with hail; a killing frost ruined their orchards.
47 He destroyed their vines with hail and their sycamore-figs with sleet.
48 He pounded their cattle with hail, let thunderbolts loose on their herds.
48 He gave over their cattle to the hail, their livestock to bolts of lightning.
49 His anger flared, a wild firestorm of havoc, An advance guard of disease-carrying angels
49 He unleashed against them his hot anger, his wrath, indignation and hostility-- a band of destroying angels.
50 to clear the ground, preparing the way before him. He didn't spare those people, he let the plague rage through their lives.
50 He prepared a path for his anger; he did not spare them from death but gave them over to the plague.
51 He killed all the Egyptian firstborns, lusty infants, offspring of Ham's virility.
51 He struck down all the firstborn of Egypt, the firstfruits of manhood in the tents of Ham.
52 Then he led his people out like sheep, took his flock safely through the wilderness.
52 But he brought his people out like a flock; he led them like sheep through the desert.

53 He took good care of them; they had nothing to fear. The Sea took care of their enemies for good.

53 He guided them safely, so they were unafraid; but the sea engulfed their enemies.

54 He brought them into his holy land, this mountain he claimed for his own.

54 Thus he brought them to the border of his holy land, to the hill country his right hand had taken.

55 He scattered everyone who got in their way; he staked out an inheritance for them-- the tribes of Israel all had their own places.

55 He drove out nations before them and allotted their lands to them as an inheritance; he settled the tribes of Israel in their homes.

56 But they kept on giving him a hard time, rebelled against God, the High God, refused to do anything he told them.

56 But they put God to the test and rebelled against the Most High; they did not keep his statutes.

57 They were worse, if that's possible, than their parents: traitors--crooked as a corkscrew.

57 Like their fathers they were disloyal and faithless, as unreliable as a faulty bow.

58 Their pagan orgies provoked God's anger, their obscene idolatries broke his heart.

58 They angered him with their high places; they aroused his jealousy with their idols.

59 When God heard their carryings-on, he was furious; he posted a huge No over Israel.

59 When God heard them, he was very angry; he rejected Israel completely.

60 He walked off and left Shiloh empty, abandoned the shrine where he had met with Israel.

60 He abandoned the tabernacle of Shiloh, the tent he had set up among men.

61 He let his pride and joy go to the dogs, turned his back on the pride of his life.

61 He sent the ark of his might into captivity, his splendor into the hands of the enemy.

62 He turned them loose on fields of battle; angry, he let them fend for themselves.

62 He gave his people over to the sword; he was very angry with his inheritance.

63 Their young men went to war and never came back; their young women waited in vain.

63 Fire consumed their young men, and their maidens had no wedding songs;

64 Their priests were massacred, and their widows never shed a tear.

64 their priests were put to the sword, and their widows could not weep.

65 Suddenly the Lord was up on his feet like someone roused from deep sleep, shouting like a drunken warrior.

65 Then the Lord awoke as from sleep, as a man wakes from the stupor of wine.

66 He hit his enemies hard, sent them running, yelping, not daring to look back.

66 He beat back his enemies; he put them to everlasting shame.

67 He disqualified Joseph as leader, told Ephraim he didn't have what it takes,

67 Then he rejected the tents of Joseph, he did not choose the tribe of Ephraim;

68 And chose the Tribe of Judah instead, Mount Zion, which he loves so much.

68 but he chose the tribe of Judah, Mount Zion, which he loved.

69 He built his sanctuary there, resplendent, solid and lasting as the earth itself.

69 He built his sanctuary like the heights, like the earth that he established forever.

70 Then he chose David, his servant, handpicked him from his work in the sheep pens.

70 He chose David his servant and took him from the sheep pens;

71 One day he was caring for the ewes and their lambs, the next day God had him shepherding Jacob, his people Israel, his prize possession.

71 from tending the sheep he brought him to be the shepherd of his people Jacob, of Israel his inheritance.

72 His good heart made him a good shepherd; he guided the people wisely and well.

72 And David shepherded them with integrity of heart; with skillful hands he led them.

Psalms 79

MSG

NIV

1 An Asaph psalm. God! Barbarians have broken into your home, violated your holy temple, left Jerusalem a pile of rubble!

1 A psalm of Asaph. O God, the nations have invaded your inheritance; they have defiled your holy temple, they have reduced Jerusalem to rubble.

2 They've served up the corpses of your servants as carrion food for birds of prey, Threw the bones of your holy people out to the wild animals to gnaw on.

2 They have given the dead bodies of your servants as food to the birds of the air, the flesh of your saints to the beasts of the earth.

3 They dumped out their blood like buckets of water. All around Jerusalem, their bodies were left to rot, unburied.

3 They have poured out blood like water all around Jerusalem, and there is no one to bury the dead.

4 We're nothing but a joke to our neighbors, graffiti scrawled on the city walls.

4 We are objects of reproach to our neighbors, of scorn and derision to those around us.

5 How long do we have to put up with this, GOD? Do you have it in for us for good? Will your smoldering rage never cool down?

5 How long, O LORD? Will you be angry forever? How long will your jealousy burn like fire?

6 If you're going to be angry, be angry with the pagans who care nothing about you, or your rival kingdoms who ignore you.

6 Pour out your wrath on the nations that do not acknowledge you, on the kingdoms that do not call on your name;

- 7 They're the ones who ruined Jacob, who wrecked and looted the place where he lived.
- 7 for they have devoured Jacob and destroyed his homeland.
- 8 Don't blame us for the sins of our parents. Hurry up and help us; we're at the end of our rope.
- 8 Do not hold against us the sins of the fathers; may your mercy come quickly to meet us, for we are in desperate need.
- 9 You're famous for helping; God, give us a break. Your reputation is on the line. Pull us out of this mess, forgive us our sins-- do what you're famous for doing!
- 9 Help us, O God our Savior, for the glory of your name; deliver us and forgive our sins for your name's sake.
- 10 Don't let the heathen get by with their sneers: "Where's your God? Is he out to lunch?" Go public and show the godless world that they can't kill your servants and get by with it.
- 10 Why should the nations say, "Where is their God?" Before our eyes, make known among the nations that you avenge the outpoured blood of your servants.
- 11 Give groaning prisoners a hearing; pardon those on death row from their doom--you can do it!
- 11 May the groans of the prisoners come before you; by the strength of your arm preserve those condemned to die.
- 12 Give our jeering neighbors what they've got coming to them; let their God-taunts boomerang and knock them flat.
- 12 Pay back into the laps of our neighbors seven times the reproach they have hurled at you, O Lord.
- 13 Then we, your people, the ones you love and care for, will thank you over and over and over. We'll tell everyone we meet how wonderful you are, how praiseworthy you are!
- 13 Then we your people, the sheep of your pasture, will praise you forever; from generation to generation we will recount your praise.

Psalms 80

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. Listen, Shepherd, Israel's Shepherd-- get all your Joseph sheep together. Throw beams of light from your dazzling throne
- 1 For the director of music. To the tune of "The Lilies of the Covenant." Of Asaph. A psalm. Hear us, O Shepherd of Israel, you who lead Joseph like a flock; you who sit enthroned between the cherubim, shine forth
- 2 So Ephraim, Benjamin, and Manasseh can see where they're going. Get out of bed--you've slept long enough! Come on the run before it's too late.
- 2 before Ephraim, Benjamin and Manasseh. Awaken your might; come and save us.
- 3 God, come back! Smile your blessing smile: That will be our salvation.
- 3 Restore us, O God; make your face shine upon us, that we may be saved.
- 4 GOD, God of the angel armies, how long will you smolder like a sleeping volcano while your people call for fire and brimstone?
- 4 O LORD God Almighty, how long will your anger smolder against the prayers of your people?
- 5 You put us on a diet of tears, bucket after bucket of salty tears to drink.
- 5 You have fed them with the bread of tears; you have made them drink tears by the bowlful.
- 6 You make us look ridiculous to our friends; our enemies poke fun day after day.
- 6 You have made us a source of contention to our neighbors, and our enemies mock us.
- 7 God of the angel armies, come back! Smile your blessing smile: That will be our salvation.
- 7 Restore us, O God Almighty; make your face shine upon us, that we may be saved.
- 8 Remember how you brought a young vine from Egypt, cleared out the brambles and briars and planted your very own vineyard?
- 8 You brought a vine out of Egypt; you drove out the nations and planted it.
- 9 You prepared the good earth, you planted her roots deep; the vineyard filled the land.
- 9 You cleared the ground for it, and it took root and filled the land.
- 10 Your vine soared high and shaded the mountains, even dwarfing the giant cedars.

- 10 The mountains were covered with its shade, the mighty cedars with its branches.
- 11 Your vine ranged west to the Sea, east to the River.
- 11 It sent out its boughs to the Sea, its shoots as far as the River.
- 12 So why do you no longer protect your vine? Trespassers pick its grapes at will;
- 12 Why have you broken down its walls so that all who pass by pick its grapes?
- 13 Wild pigs crash through and crush it, and the mice nibble away at what's left.
- 13 Boars from the forest ravage it and the creatures of the field feed on it.
- 14 God of the angel armies, turn our way! Take a good look at what's happened and attend to this vine.
- 14 Return to us, O God Almighty! Look down from heaven and see! Watch over this vine,
- 15 Care for what you once tenderly planted-- the vine you raised from a shoot.
- 15 the root your right hand has planted, the son you have raised up for yourself.
- 16 And those who dared to set it on fire-- give them a look that will kill!
- 16 Your vine is cut down, it is burned with fire; at your rebuke your people perish.
- 17 Then take the hand of your once-favorite child, the child you raised to adulthood.
- 17 Let your hand rest on the man at your right hand, the son of man you have raised up for yourself.
- 18 We will never turn our back on you; breathe life into our lungs so we can shout your name!
- 18 Then we will not turn away from you; revive us, and we will call on your name.
- 19 GOD, God of the angel armies, come back! Smile your blessing smile: That will be our salvation.
- 19 Restore us, O LORD God Almighty; make your face shine upon us, that we may be saved.

Psalms 81

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. A song to our strong God! a shout to the God of Jacob!
- 1 For the director of music. According to gittith. Of Asaph. Sing for joy to God our strength; shout aloud to the God of Jacob!
- 2 Anthems from the choir, music from the band, sweet sounds from lute and harp,
- 2 Begin the music, strike the tambourine, play the melodious harp and lyre.
- 3 Trumpets and trombones and horns: it's festival day, a feast to God!
- 3 Sound the ram's horn at the New Moon, and when the moon is full, on the day of our Feast;
- 4 A day decreed by God, solemnly ordered by the God of Jacob.
- 4 this is a decree for Israel, an ordinance of the God of Jacob.
- 5 He commanded Joseph to keep this day so we'd never forget what he did in Egypt. I hear this most gentle whisper from One I never guessed would speak to me:
- 5 He established it as a statute for Joseph when he went out against Egypt, where we heard a language we did not understand.
- 6 "I took the world off your shoulders, freed you from a life of hard labor.
- 6 He says, "I removed the burden from their shoulders; their hands were set free from the basket.
- 7 You called to me in your pain; I got you out of a bad place. I answered you from where the thunder hides, I proved you at Meribah Fountain.
- 7 In your distress you called and I rescued you, I answered you out of a thundercloud; I tested you at the waters of Meribah. Selah
- 8 "Listen, dear ones--get this straight; O Israel, don't take this lightly.
- 8 Hear, O my people, and I will warn you-- if you would but listen to me, O Israel!
- 9 Don't take up with strange gods, don't worship the latest in gods.
- 9 You shall have no foreign god among you; you shall not bow down to an alien god.
- 10 I'm GOD, your God, the very God who rescued you from doom in Egypt, Then fed you all you could eat, filled your hungry stomachs.

- 10 I am the LORD your God, who brought you up out of Egypt. Open wide your mouth and I will fill it.
- 11 "But my people didn't listen, Israel paid no attention;
11 But my people would not listen to me; Israel would not submit to me.
12 So I let go of the reins and told them, 'Run! Do it your own way!'
12 So I gave them over to their stubborn hearts to follow their own devices.
13 "Oh, dear people, will you listen to me now? Israel, will you follow my map?
13 If my people would but listen to me, if Israel would follow my ways,
14 I'll make short work of your enemies, give your foes the back of my hand.
14 how quickly would I subdue their enemies and turn my hand against their foes!
15 I'll send the GOD-haters cringing like dogs, never to be heard from again.
15 Those who hate the LORD would cringe before him, and their punishment would last forever.
16 You'll feast on my fresh-baked bread spread with butter and rock-pure honey."
16 But you would be fed with the finest of wheat; with honey from the rock I would satisfy you."

Psalms 82

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. God calls the judges into his courtroom, he puts all the judges in the dock.
- 1 A psalm of Asaph. God presides in the great assembly; he gives judgment among the "gods":
- 2 "Enough! You've corrupted justice long enough, you've let the wicked get away with murder.
- 2 How long will you defend the unjust and show partiality to the wicked?
Selah
- 3 You're here to defend the defenseless, to make sure that underdogs get a fair break;

- 3 Defend the cause of the weak and fatherless; maintain the rights of the poor and oppressed.
- 4 Your job is to stand up for the powerless, and prosecute all those who exploit them."
- 4 Rescue the weak and needy; deliver them from the hand of the wicked.
- 5 Ignorant judges! Head-in-the-sand judges! They haven't a clue to what's going on. And now everything's falling apart, the world's coming unglued.
- 5 They know nothing, they understand nothing. They walk about in darkness; all the foundations of the earth are shaken.
- 6 "I commissioned you judges, each one of you, deputies of the High God, 6 I said, 'You are gods'; you are all sons of the Most High.'
- 7 But you've betrayed your commission and now you're stripped of your rank, busted."
- 7 But you will die like mere men; you will fall like every other ruler."
- 8 O God, give them their just deserts! You've got the whole world in your hands!
- 8 Rise up, O God, judge the earth, for all the nations are your inheritance.

Psalms 83

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Asaph psalm. GOD, don't shut me out; don't give me the silent treatment, O God.
- 1 A song. A psalm of Asaph. O God, do not keep silent; be not quiet, O God, be not still.
- 2 Your enemies are out there whooping it up, the God-haters are living it up;
- 2 See how your enemies are astir, how your foes rear their heads.
- 3 They're plotting to do your people in, conspiring to rob you of your precious ones.
- 3 With cunning they conspire against your people; they plot against those you cherish.
- 4 "Let's wipe this nation from the face of the earth," they say; "scratch Israel's name off the books."

4 Come, they say, "let us destroy them as a nation, that the name of Israel
be remembered no more."
5 And now they're putting their heads together, making plans to get rid of
you.
5 With one mind they plot together; they form an alliance against you--
6 Edom and the Ishmaelites, Moab and the Hagrites,
6 the tents of Edom and the Ishmaelites, of Moab and the Hagrites,
7 Gebal and Ammon and Amalek, Philistia and the Tyrians,
7 Gebal, Ammon and Amalek, Philistia, with the people of Tyre.
8 And now Assyria has joined up, Giving muscle to the gang of Lot.
8 Even Assyria has joined them to lend strength to the descendants of Lot.
Selah
9 Do to them what you did to Midian, to Sisera and Jabin at Kishon Brook;
9 Do to them as you did to Midian, as you did to Sisera and Jabin at the
river Kishon,
10 They came to a bad end at Endor, nothing but dung for the garden.
10 who perished at Endor and became like refuse on the ground.
11 Cut down their leaders as you did Oreb and Zeeb, their princes to
nothings like Zebah and Zalmunna,
11 Make their nobles like Oreb and Zeeb, all their princes like Zebah and
Zalmunna,
12 With their empty brags, "We're grabbing it all, grabbing God's gardens
for ourselves."
12 who said, "Let us take possession of the pasturelands of God."
13 My God! I've had it with them! Blow them away! Tumbleweeds in the
desert waste,
13 Make them like tumbleweed, O my God, like chaff before the wind.
14 charred sticks in the burned-over ground.
14 As fire consumes the forest or a flame sets the mountains ablaze,
15 Knock the breath right out of them, so they're gasping
15 so pursue them with your tempest and terrify them with your storm.
16 for breath, gasping, "GOD."
16 Cover their faces with shame so that men will seek your name, O
LORD.
17 Bring them to the end of their rope, and leave them there dangling,
helpless.

- 17 May they ever be ashamed and dismayed; may they perish in disgrace.
18 Then they'll learn your name: "GOD," the one and only High God on earth.
18 Let them know that you, whose name is the LORD-- that you alone are the Most High over all the earth.

Psalms 84

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Korah psalm. What a beautiful home, GOD of the Angel Armies! I've always longed to live in a place like this,
1 For the director of music. According to gittith. Of the Sons of Korah. A psalm. How lovely is your dwelling place, O LORD Almighty!
2 Always dreamed of a room in your house, where I could sing for joy to God-alive!
2 My soul yearns, even faints, for the courts of the LORD; my heart and my flesh cry out for the living God.
3 Birds find nooks and crannies in your house, sparrows and swallows make nests there. They lay their eggs and raise their young, singing their songs in the place where we worship. GOD of the Angel Armies! King! God!
3 Even the sparrow has found a home, and the swallow a nest for herself, where she may have her young-- a place near your altar, O LORD Almighty, my King and my God.
4 How blessed they are to live and sing there!
4 Blessed are those who dwell in your house; they are ever praising you. Selah
5 And how blessed all those in whom you live, whose lives become roads you travel;
5 Blessed are those whose strength is in you, who have set their hearts on pilgrimage.
6 They wind through lonesome valleys, come upon brooks, discover cool springs and pools brimming with rain!
6 As they pass through the Valley of Baca, they make it a place of springs; the autumn rains also cover it with pools.

- 7 God-traveled, these roads curve up the mountain, and at the last turn--
Zion! God in full view!
- 7 They go from strength to strength, till each appears before God in Zion.
- 8 God of the Angel Armies, listen: O God of Jacob, open your ears--I'm
praying!
- 8 Hear my prayer, O LORD God Almighty; listen to me, O God of Jacob.
Selah
- 9 Look at our shields, glistening in the sun, our faces, shining with your
gracious anointing.
- 9 Look upon our shield, O God; look with favor on your anointed one.
- 10 One day spent in your house, this beautiful place of worship, beats
thousands spent on Greek island beaches. I'd rather scrub floors in the
house of my God than be honored as a guest in the palace of sin.
- 10 Better is one day in your courts than a thousand elsewhere; I would
rather be a doorkeeper in the house of my God than dwell in the tents of
the wicked.
- 11 All sunshine and sovereign is GOD, generous in gifts and glory. He
doesn't scrimp with his traveling companions.
- 11 For the LORD God is a sun and shield; the LORD bestows favor and
honor; no good thing does he withhold from those whose walk is
blameless.
- 12 It's smooth sailing all the way with GOD of the Angel Armies.
- 12 O LORD Almighty, blessed is the man who trusts in you.

Psalms 85

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Korah psalm. GOD, you smiled on your good earth! You brought good
times back to Jacob!
- 1 For the director of music. Of the Sons of Korah. A psalm. You showed
favor to your land, O LORD; you restored the fortunes of Jacob.
- 2 You lifted the cloud of guilt from your people, you put their sins far out
of sight.
- 2 You forgave the iniquity of your people and covered all their sins. Selah

- 3 You took back your sin-provoked threats, you cooled your hot, righteous anger.
- 3 You set aside all your wrath and turned from your fierce anger.
- 4 Help us again, God of our help; don't hold a grudge against us forever.
- 4 Restore us again, O God our Savior, and put away your displeasure toward us.
- 5 You aren't going to keep this up, are you? scowling and angry, year after year?
- 5 Will you be angry with us forever? Will you prolong your anger through all generations?
- 6 Why not help us make a fresh start--a resurrection life? Then your people will laugh and sing!
- 6 Will you not revive us again, that your people may rejoice in you?
- 7 Show us how much you love us, GOD! Give us the salvation we need!
- 7 Show us your unfailing love, O LORD, and grant us your salvation.
- 8 I can't wait to hear what he'll say. GOD's about to pronounce his people well, The holy people he loves so much, so they'll never again live like fools.
- 8 I will listen to what God the LORD will say; he promises peace to his people, his saints-- but let them not return to folly.
- 9 See how close his salvation is to those who fear him? Our country is home base for Glory!
- 9 Surely his salvation is near those who fear him, that his glory may dwell in our land.
- 10 Love and Truth meet in the street, Right Living and Whole Living embrace and kiss!
- 10 Love and faithfulness meet together; righteousness and peace kiss each other.
- 11 Truth sprouts green from the ground, Right Living pours down from the skies!
- 11 Faithfulness springs forth from the earth, and righteousness looks down from heaven.
- 12 Oh yes! GOD gives Goodness and Beauty; our land responds with Bounty and Blessing.
- 12 The LORD will indeed give what is good, and our land will yield its harvest.

- 13 Right Living strides out before him, and clears a path for his passage.
13 Righteousness goes before him and prepares the way for his steps.

Psalms 86

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Bend an ear, GOD; answer me. I'm one miserable wretch!
- 1 A prayer of David. Hear, O LORD, and answer me, for I am poor and needy.
- 2 Keep me safe--haven't I lived a good life? Help your servant--I'm depending on you!
- 2 Guard my life, for I am devoted to you. You are my God; save your servant who trusts in you.
- 3 You're my God; have mercy on me. I count on you from morning to night.
- 3 Have mercy on me, O Lord, for I call to you all day long.
- 4 Give your servant a happy life; I put myself in your hands!
- 4 Bring joy to your servant, for to you, O Lord, I lift up my soul.
- 5 You're well-known as good and forgiving, bighearted to all who ask for help.
- 5 You are forgiving and good, O Lord, abounding in love to all who call to you.
- 6 Pay attention, GOD, to my prayer; bend down and listen to my cry for help.
- 6 Hear my prayer, O LORD; listen to my cry for mercy.
- 7 Every time I'm in trouble I call on you, confident that you'll answer.
- 7 In the day of my trouble I will call to you, for you will answer me.
- 8 There's no one quite like you among the gods, O Lord, and nothing to compare with your works.
- 8 Among the gods there is none like you, O Lord; no deeds can compare with yours.
- 9 All the nations you made are on their way, ready to give honor to you, O Lord, Ready to put your beauty on display,

- 9 All the nations you have made will come and worship before you, O Lord; they will bring glory to your name.
- 10 parading your greatness, And the great things you do-- God, you're the one, there's no one but you!
- 10 For you are great and do marvelous deeds; you alone are God.
- 11 Train me, GOD, to walk straight; then I'll follow your true path. Put me together, one heart and mind; then, undivided, I'll worship in joyful fear.
- 11 Teach me your way, O LORD, and I will walk in your truth; give me an undivided heart, that I may fear your name.
- 12 From the bottom of my heart I thank you, dear Lord; I've never kept secret what you're up to.
- 12 I will praise you, O Lord my God, with all my heart; I will glorify your name forever.
- 13 You've always been great toward me--what love! You snatched me from the brink of disaster!
- 13 For great is your love toward me; you have delivered me from the depths of the grave.
- 14 God, these bullies have reared their heads! A gang of thugs is after me--and they don't care a thing about you.
- 14 The arrogant are attacking me, O God; a band of ruthless men seeks my life-- men without regard for you.
- 15 But you, O God, are both tender and kind, not easily angered, immense in love, and you never, never quit.
- 15 But you, O Lord, are a compassionate and gracious God, slow to anger, abounding in love and faithfulness.
- 16 So look me in the eye and show kindness, give your servant the strength to go on, save your dear, dear child!
- 16 Turn to me and have mercy on me; grant your strength to your servant and save the son of your maidservant.
- 17 Make a show of how much you love me so the bullies who hate me will stand there slack-jawed, As you, GOD, gently and powerfully put me back on my feet.
- 17 Give me a sign of your goodness, that my enemies may see it and be put to shame, for you, O LORD, have helped me and comforted me.

Psalms 87

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Korah psalm. He founded Zion on the Holy Mountain--
- 1 Of the Sons of Korah. A psalm. A song. He has set his foundation on the holy mountain;
- 2 and oh, how GOD loves his home! Loves it far better than all the homes of Jacob put together!
- 2 the LORD loves the gates of Zion more than all the dwellings of Jacob.
- 3 God's hometown--oh! everyone there is talking about you!
- 3 Glorious things are said of you, O city of God: Selah
- 4 I name them off, those among whom I'm famous: Egypt and Babylon, also Philistia, even Tyre, along with Cush. Word's getting around; they point them out: "This one was born again here!"
- 4 I will record Rahab and Babylon among those who acknowledge me-- Philistia too, and Tyre, along with Cush-- and will say, 'This one was born in Zion.'
- 5 The word's getting out on Zion: "Men and women, right and left, get born again in her!"
- 5 Indeed, of Zion it will be said, "This one and that one were born in her, and the Most High himself will establish her."
- 6 GOD registers their names in his book: "This one, this one, and this one-- born again, right here."
- 6 The LORD will write in the register of the peoples: "This one was born in Zion." Selah
- 7 Singers and dancers give credit to Zion: "All my springs are in you!"
- 7 As they make music they will sing, "All my fountains are in you."

Psalms 88

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Korah prayer of Heman. GOD, you're my last chance of the day. I spend the night on my knees before you.

- 1 A song. A psalm of the Sons of Korah. For the director of music. According to mahalath leannoth. A maskil of Heman the Ezrahite. O LORD, the God who saves me, day and night I cry out before you.
- 2 Put me on your salvation agenda; take notes on the trouble I'm in.
- 2 May my prayer come before you; turn your ear to my cry.
- 3 I've had my fill of trouble; I'm camped on the edge of hell.
- 3 For my soul is full of trouble and my life draws near the grave.
- 4 I'm written off as a lost cause, one more statistic, a hopeless case.
- 4 I am counted among those who go down to the pit; I am like a man without strength.
- 5 Abandoned as already dead, one more body in a stack of corpses, And not so much as a gravestone-- I'm a black hole in oblivion.
- 5 I am set apart with the dead, like the slain who lie in the grave, whom you remember no more, who are cut off from your care.
- 6 You've dropped me into a bottomless pit, sunk me in a pitch-black abyss.
- 6 You have put me in the lowest pit, in the darkest depths.
- 7 I'm battered senseless by your rage, relentlessly pounded by your waves of anger.
- 7 Your wrath lies heavily upon me; you have overwhelmed me with all your waves. Selah
- 8 You turned my friends against me, made me horrible to them. I'm caught in a maze and can't find my way out,
- 8 You have taken from me my closest friends and have made me repulsive to them. I am confined and cannot escape;
- 9 blinded by tears of pain and frustration. I call to you, GOD; all day I call. I wring my hands, I plead for help.
- 9 my eyes are dim with grief. I call to you, O LORD, every day; I spread out my hands to you.
- 10 Are the dead a live audience for your miracles? Do ghosts ever join the choirs that praise you?
- 10 Do you show your wonders to the dead? Do those who are dead rise up and praise you? Selah
- 11 Does your love make any difference in a graveyard? Is your faithful presence noticed in the corridors of hell?
- 11 Is your love declared in the grave, your faithfulness in Destruction?

- 12 Are your marvelous wonders ever seen in the dark, your righteous ways noticed in the Land of No Memory?
- 12 Are your wonders known in the place of darkness, or your righteous deeds in the land of oblivion?
- 13 I'm standing my ground, GOD, shouting for help, at my prayers every morning, on my knees each daybreak.
- 13 But I cry to you for help, O LORD; in the morning my prayer comes before you.
- 14 Why, GOD, do you turn a deaf ear? Why do you make yourself scarce?
- 14 Why, O LORD, do you reject me and hide your face from me?
- 15 For as long as I remember I've been hurting; I've taken the worst you can hand out, and I've had it.
- 15 From my youth I have been afflicted and close to death; I have suffered your terrors and am in despair.
- 16 Your wildfire anger has blazed through my life; I'm bleeding, black and blue.
- 16 Your wrath has swept over me; your terrors have destroyed me.
- 17 You've attacked me fiercely from every side, raining down blows till I'm nearly dead.
- 17 All day long they surround me like a flood; they have completely engulfed me.
- 18 You made lover and neighbor alike dump me; the only friend I have left is Darkness.
- 18 You have taken my companions and loved ones from me; the darkness is my closest friend.

Psalms 89

MSG

NIV

- 1 An Ethan prayer. Your love, GOD, is my song, and I'll sing it! I'm forever telling everyone how faithful you are.
- 1 A maskil of Ethan the Ezrahite. I will sing of the LORD's great love forever; with my mouth I will make your faithfulness known through all generations.

- 2 I'll never quit telling the story of your love-- how you built the cosmos and guaranteed everything in it. Your love has always been our lives' foundation, your fidelity has been the roof over our world.
- 2 I will declare that your love stands firm forever, that you established your faithfulness in heaven itself.
- 3 You once said, "I joined forces with my chosen leader, I pledged my word to my servant, David, saying,
- 3 You said, "I have made a covenant with my chosen one, I have sworn to David my servant,
- 4 'Everyone descending from you is guaranteed life; I'll make your rule as solid and lasting as rock.'"
- 4 'I will establish your line forever and make your throne firm through all generations.' " Selah
- 5 GOD! Let the cosmos praise your wonderful ways, the choir of holy angels sing anthems to your faithful ways!
- 5 The heavens praise your wonders, O LORD, your faithfulness too, in the assembly of the holy ones.
- 6 Search high and low, scan skies and land, you'll find nothing and no one quite like GOD.
- 6 For who in the skies above can compare with the LORD? Who is like the LORD among the heavenly beings?
- 7 The holy angels are in awe before him; he looms immense and august over everyone around him.
- 7 In the council of the holy ones God is greatly feared; he is more awesome than all who surround him.
- 8 GOD of the Angel Armies, who is like you, powerful and faithful from every angle?
- 8 O LORD God Almighty, who is like you? You are mighty, O LORD, and your faithfulness surrounds you.
- 9 You put the arrogant ocean in its place and calm its waves when they turn unruly.
- 9 You rule over the surging sea; when its waves mount up, you still them.
- 10 You gave that old hag Egypt the back of your hand, you brushed off your enemies with a flick of your wrist.
- 10 You crushed Rahab like one of the slain; with your strong arm you scattered your enemies.

- 11 You own the cosmos--you made everything in it, everything from atom to archangel.
- 11 The heavens are yours, and yours also the earth; you founded the world and all that is in it.
- 12 You positioned the North and South Poles; the mountains Tabor and Hermon sing duets to you.
- 12 You created the north and the south; Tabor and Hermon sing for joy at your name.
- 13 With your well-muscled arm and your grip of steel-- nobody trifles with you!
- 13 Your arm is endued with power; your hand is strong, your right hand exalted.
- 14 The Right and Justice are the roots of your rule; Love and Truth are its fruits.
- 14 Righteousness and justice are the foundation of your throne; love and faithfulness go before you.
- 15 Blessed are the people who know the passwords of praise, who shout on parade in the bright presence of GOD.
- 15 Blessed are those who have learned to acclaim you, who walk in the light of your presence, O LORD.
- 16 Delighted, they dance all day long; they know who you are, what you do--they can't keep it quiet!
- 16 They rejoice in your name all day long; they exult in your righteousness.
- 17 Your vibrant beauty has gotten inside us-- you've been so good to us! We're walking on air!
- 17 For you are their glory and strength, and by your favor you exalt our horn.
- 18 All we are and have we owe to GOD, Holy God of Israel, our King!
- 18 Indeed, our shield belongs to the LORD, our king to the Holy One of Israel.
- 19 A long time ago you spoke in a vision, you spoke to your faithful beloved: "I've crowned a hero, I chose the best I could find;
- 19 Once you spoke in a vision, to your faithful people you said: "I have bestowed strength on a warrior; I have exalted a young man from among the people.

20 I found David, my servant, poured holy oil on his head,
20 I have found David my servant; with my sacred oil I have anointed him.
21 And I'll keep my hand steadily on him, yes, I'll stick with him through
thick and thin.
21 My hand will sustain him; surely my arm will strengthen him.
22 No enemy will get the best of him, no scoundrel will do him in.
22 No enemy will subject him to tribute; no wicked man will oppress him.
23 I'll weed out all who oppose him, I'll clean out all who hate him.
23 I will crush his foes before him and strike down his adversaries.
24 I'm with him for good and I'll love him forever; I've set him on high--
he's riding high!
24 My faithful love will be with him, and through my name his horn will
be exalted.
25 I've put Ocean in his one hand, River in the other;
25 I will set his hand over the sea, his right hand over the rivers.
26 he'll call out, 'Oh, my Father--my God, my Rock of Salvation!'
26 He will call out to me, 'You are my Father, my God, the Rock my
Savior.'
27 Yes, I'm setting him apart as the First of the royal line, High King over
all of earth's kings.
27 I will also appoint him my firstborn, the most exalted of the kings of the
earth.
28 I'll preserve him eternally in my love, I'll faithfully do all I so solemnly
promised.
28 I will maintain my love to him forever, and my covenant with him will
never fail.
29 I'll guarantee his family tree and underwrite his rule.
29 I will establish his line forever, his throne as long as the heavens endure.
30 If his children refuse to do what I tell them, if they refuse to walk in the
way I show them,
30 If his sons forsake my law and do not follow my statutes,
31 If they spit on the directions I give them and tear up the rules I post for
them--
31 if they violate my decrees and fail to keep my commands,
32 I'll rub their faces in the dirt of their rebellion and make them face the
music.

32 I will punish their sin with the rod, their iniquity with flogging;
33 But I'll never throw them out, never abandon or disown them.
33 but I will not take my love from him, nor will I ever betray my
faithfulness.
34 Do you think I'd withdraw my holy promise? or take back words I'd
already spoken?
34 I will not violate my covenant or alter what my lips have uttered.
35 I've given my word, my whole and holy word; do you think I would lie
to David?
35 Once for all, I have sworn by my holiness-- and I will not lie to David--
36 His family tree is here for good, his sovereignty as sure as the sun,
36 that his line will continue forever and his throne endure before me like
the sun;
37 Dependable as the phases of the moon, inescapable as weather."
37 it will be established forever like the moon, the faithful witness in the
sky." Selah
38 But GOD, you did walk off and leave us, you lost your temper with the
one you anointed.
38 But you have rejected, you have spurned, you have been very angry
with your anointed one.
39 You tore up the promise you made to your servant, you stomped his
crown in the mud.
39 You have renounced the covenant with your servant and have defiled his
crown in the dust.
40 You blasted his home to kingdom come, reduced his city to a pile of
rubble
40 You have broken through all his walls and reduced his strongholds to
ruins.
41 Picked clean by wayfaring strangers, a joke to all the neighbors.
41 All who pass by have plundered him; he has become the scorn of his
neighbors.
42 You declared a holiday for all his enemies, and they're celebrating for
all they're worth.
42 You have exalted the right hand of his foes; you have made all his
enemies rejoice.
43 Angry, you opposed him in battle, refused to fight on his side;

43 You have turned back the edge of his sword and have not supported him in battle.

44 You robbed him of his splendor, humiliated this warrior, ground his kingly honor in the dirt.

44 You have put an end to his splendor and cast his throne to the ground.

45 You took the best years of his life and left him an impotent, ruined husk.

45 You have cut short the days of his youth; you have covered him with a mantle of shame. Selah

46 How long do we put up with this, GOD? Are you gone for good? Will you hold this grudge forever?

46 How long, O LORD? Will you hide yourself forever? How long will your wrath burn like fire?

47 Remember my sorrow and how short life is. Did you create men and women for nothing but this?

47 Remember how fleeting is my life. For what futility you have created all men!

48 We'll see death soon enough. Everyone does. And there's no back door out of hell.

48 What man can live and not see death, or save himself from the power of the grave? Selah

49 So where is the love you're so famous for, Lord? What happened to your promise to David?

49 O Lord, where is your former great love, which in your faithfulness you swore to David?

50 Take a good look at your servant, dear Lord; I'm the butt of the jokes of all nations,

50 Remember, Lord, how your servant has been mocked, how I bear in my heart the taunts of all the nations,

51 The taunting jokes of your enemies, GOD, as they dog the steps of your dear anointed.

51 the taunts with which your enemies have mocked, O LORD, with which they have mocked every step of your anointed one.

52 Blessed be GOD forever and always! Yes. Oh, yes.

52 Praise be to the LORD forever! Amen and Amen.

Psalms 90

MSG

NIV

- 1 A prayer of Moses, man of God. God, it seems you've been our home forever;
- 1 A prayer of Moses the man of God. Lord, you have been our dwelling place throughout all generations.
- 2 long before the mountains were born, Long before you brought earth itself to birth, from "once upon a time" to "kingdom come"--you are God.
- 2 Before the mountains were born or you brought forth the earth and the world, from everlasting to everlasting you are God.
- 3 So don't return us to mud, saying, "Back to where you came from!"
- 3 You turn men back to dust, saying, "Return to dust, O sons of men."
- 4 Patience! You've got all the time in the world--whether a thousand years or a day, it's all the same to you.
- 4 For a thousand years in your sight are like a day that has just gone by, or like a watch in the night.
- 5 Are we no more to you than a wispy dream, no more than a blade of grass
- 5 You sweep men away in the sleep of death; they are like the new grass of the morning--
- 6 That springs up gloriously with the rising sun and is cut down without a second thought?
- 6 though in the morning it springs up new, by evening it is dry and withered.
- 7 Your anger is far and away too much for us; we're at the end of our rope.
- 7 We are consumed by your anger and terrified by your indignation.
- 8 You keep track of all our sins; every misdeed since we were children is entered in your books.
- 8 You have set our iniquities before you, our secret sins in the light of your presence.
- 9 All we can remember is that frown on your face. Is that all we're ever going to get?

- 9 All our days pass away under your wrath; we finish our years with a moan.
- 10 We live for seventy years or so (with luck we might make it to eighty),
And what do we have to show for it? Trouble. Toil and trouble and a marker in the graveyard.
- 10 The length of our days is seventy years-- or eighty, if we have the strength; yet their span is but trouble and sorrow, for they quickly pass, and we fly away.
- 11 Who can make sense of such rage, such anger against the very ones who fear you?
- 11 Who knows the power of your anger? For your wrath is as great as the fear that is due you.
- 12 Oh! Teach us to live well! Teach us to live wisely and well!
- 12 Teach us to number our days aright, that we may gain a heart of wisdom.
- 13 Come back, GOD--how long do we have to wait?-- and treat your servants with kindness for a change.
- 13 Relent, O LORD! How long will it be? Have compassion on your servants.
- 14 Surprise us with love at daybreak; then we'll skip and dance all the day long.
- 14 Satisfy us in the morning with your unfailing love, that we may sing for joy and be glad all our days.
- 15 Make up for the bad times with some good times; we've seen enough evil to last a lifetime.
- 15 Make us glad for as many days as you have afflicted us, for as many years as we have seen trouble.
- 16 Let your servants see what you're best at-- the ways you rule and bless your children.
- 16 May your deeds be shown to your servants, your splendor to their children.
- 17 And let the loveliness of our Lord, our God, rest on us, confirming the work that we do. Oh, yes. Affirm the work that we do!
- 17 May the favor of the Lord our God rest upon us; establish the work of our hands for us-- yes, establish the work of our hands.

Psalms 91

MSG

NIV

- 1 You who sit down in the High God's presence, spend the night in Shaddai's shadow,
- 1 He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will rest in the shadow of the Almighty.
- 2 Say this: "GOD, you're my refuge. I trust in you and I'm safe!"
- 2 I will say of the LORD, "He is my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust."
- 3 That's right--he rescues you from hidden traps, shields you from deadly hazards.
- 3 Surely he will save you from the fowler's snare and from the deadly pestilence.
- 4 His huge outstretched arms protect you-- under them you're perfectly safe; his arms fend off all harm.
- 4 He will cover you with his feathers, and under his wings you will find refuge; his faithfulness will be your shield and rampart.
- 5 Fear nothing--not wild wolves in the night, not flying arrows in the day,
- 5 You will not fear the terror of night, nor the arrow that flies by day,
- 6 Not disease that prowls through the darkness, not disaster that erupts at high noon.
- 6 nor the pestilence that stalks in the darkness, nor the plague that destroys at midday.
- 7 Even though others succumb all around, drop like flies right and left, no harm will even graze you.
- 7 A thousand may fall at your side, ten thousand at your right hand, but it will not come near you.
- 8 You'll stand untouched, watch it all from a distance, watch the wicked turn into corpses.
- 8 You will only observe with your eyes and see the punishment of the wicked.
- 9 Yes, because GOD's your refuge, the High God your very own home,
- 9 If you make the Most High your dwelling-- even the LORD, who is my refuge--

- 10 Evil can't get close to you, harm can't get through the door.
10 then no harm will befall you, no disaster will come near your tent.
11 He ordered his angels to guard you wherever you go.
11 For he will command his angels concerning you to guard you in all your ways;
12 If you stumble, they'll catch you; their job is to keep you from falling.
12 they will lift you up in their hands, so that you will not strike your foot against a stone.
13 You'll walk unharmed among lions and snakes, and kick young lions and serpents from the path.
13 You will tread upon the lion and the cobra; you will trample the great lion and the serpent.
14 "If you'll hold on to me for dear life," says GOD, "I'll get you out of any trouble. I'll give you the best of care if you'll only get to know and trust me.
14 Because he loves me, says the LORD, "I will rescue him; I will protect him, for he acknowledges my name.
15 Call me and I'll answer, be at your side in bad times; I'll rescue you, then throw you a party.
15 He will call upon me, and I will answer him; I will be with him in trouble, I will deliver him and honor him.
16 I'll give you a long life, give you a long drink of salvation!"
16 With long life will I satisfy him and show him my salvation."

Psalms 92

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Sabbath song. What a beautiful thing, GOD, to give thanks, to sing an anthem to you, the High God!
1 A psalm. A song. For the Sabbath day. It is good to praise the LORD and make music to your name, O Most High,
2 To announce your love each daybreak, sing your faithful presence all through the night,
2 to proclaim your love in the morning and your faithfulness at night,
3 Accompanied by dulcimer and harp, the full-bodied music of strings.

3 to the music of the ten-stringed lyre and the melody of the harp.
4 You made me so happy, GOD. I saw your work and I shouted for joy.
4 For you make me glad by your deeds, O LORD; I sing for joy at the works of your hands.
5 How magnificent your work, GOD! How profound your thoughts!
5 How great are your works, O LORD, how profound your thoughts!
6 Dullards never notice what you do; fools never do get it.
6 The senseless man does not know, fools do not understand,
7 When the wicked popped up like weeds and all the evil men and women took over, You mowed them down, finished them off once and for all.
7 that though the wicked spring up like grass and all evildoers flourish, they will be forever destroyed.
8 You, GOD, are High and Eternal.
8 But you, O LORD, are exalted forever.
9 Look at your enemies, GOD! Look at your enemies--ruined! Scattered to the winds, all those hirelings of evil!
9 For surely your enemies, O LORD, surely your enemies will perish; all evildoers will be scattered.
10 But you've made me strong as a charging bison, you've honored me with a festive parade.
10 You have exalted my horn like that of a wild ox; fine oils have been poured upon me.
11 The sight of my critics going down is still fresh, the rout of my malicious detractors. My ears are filled with the sounds of promise:
11 My eyes have seen the defeat of my adversaries; my ears have heard the rout of my wicked foes.
12 "Good people will prosper like palm trees, Grow tall like Lebanon cedars;
12 The righteous will flourish like a palm tree, they will grow like a cedar of Lebanon;
13 transplanted to GOD's courtyard, They'll grow tall in the presence of God,
13 planted in the house of the LORD, they will flourish in the courts of our God.
14 lithe and green, virile still in old age."
14 They will still bear fruit in old age, they will stay fresh and green,

15 Such witnesses to upright GOD! My Mountain, my huge, holy Mountain!

15 proclaiming, "The LORD is upright; he is my Rock, and there is no wickedness in him."

Psalms 93

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD is King, robed and ruling, GOD is robed and surging with strength.
And yes, the world is firm, immovable,
- 1 The LORD reigns, he is robed in majesty; the LORD is robed in majesty
and is armed with strength. The world is firmly established; it cannot be
moved.
- 2 Your throne ever firm--you're Eternal!
- 2 Your throne was established long ago; you are from all eternity.
- 3 Sea storms are up, GOD, Sea storms wild and roaring, Sea storms with
thunderous breakers.
- 3 The seas have lifted up, O LORD, the seas have lifted up their voice; the
seas have lifted up their pounding waves.
- 4 Stronger than wild sea storms, Mightier than sea-storm breakers, Mighty
GOD rules from High Heaven.
- 4 Mightier than the thunder of the great waters, mightier than the breakers
of the sea-- the LORD on high is mighty.
- 5 What you say goes--it always has. "Beauty" and "Holy" mark your palace
rule, GOD, to the very end of time.
- 5 Your statutes stand firm; holiness adorns your house for endless days, O
LORD.

Psalms 94

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD, put an end to evil; avenging God, show your colors!
- 1 O LORD, the God who avenges, O God who avenges, shine forth.
- 2 Judge of the earth, take your stand; throw the book at the arrogant.

- 2 Rise up, O Judge of the earth; pay back to the proud what they deserve.
- 3 GOD, the wicked get away with murder-- how long will you let this go on?
- 3 How long will the wicked, O LORD, how long will the wicked be jubilant?
- 4 They brag and boast and crow about their crimes!
- 4 They pour out arrogant words; all the evildoers are full of boasting.
- 5 They walk all over your people, GOD, exploit and abuse your precious people.
- 5 They crush your people, O LORD; they oppress your inheritance.
- 6 They take out anyone who gets in their way; if they can't use them, they kill them.
- 6 They slay the widow and the alien; they murder the fatherless.
- 7 They think, "GOD isn't looking, Jacob's God is out to lunch."
- 7 They say, "The LORD does not see; the God of Jacob pays no heed."
- 8 Well, think again, you idiots, fools--how long before you get smart?
- 8 Take heed, you senseless ones among the people; you fools, when will you become wise?
- 9 Do you think Ear-Maker doesn't hear, Eye-Shaper doesn't see?
- 9 Does he who implanted the ear not hear? Does he who formed the eye not see?
- 10 Do you think the trainer of nations doesn't correct, the teacher of Adam doesn't know?
- 10 Does he who disciplines nations not punish? Does he who teaches man lack knowledge?
- 11 GOD knows, all right-- knows your stupidity, sees your shallowness.
- 11 The LORD knows the thoughts of man; he knows that they are futile.
- 12 How blessed the man you train, GOD, the woman you instruct in your Word,
- 12 Blessed is the man you discipline, O LORD, the man you teach from your law;
- 13 Providing a circle of quiet within the clamor of evil, while a jail is being built for the wicked.
- 13 you grant him relief from days of trouble, till a pit is dug for the wicked.
- 14 GOD will never walk away from his people, never desert his precious people.

- 14 For the LORD will not reject his people; he will never forsake his inheritance.
- 15 Rest assured that justice is on its way and every good heart put right.
- 15 Judgment will again be founded on righteousness, and all the upright in heart will follow it.
- 16 Who stood up for me against the wicked? Who took my side against evil workers?
- 16 Who will rise up for me against the wicked? Who will take a stand for me against evildoers?
- 17 If GOD hadn't been there for me, I never would have made it.
- 17 Unless the LORD had given me help, I would soon have dwelt in the silence of death.
- 18 The minute I said, "I'm slipping, I'm falling," your love, GOD, took hold and held me fast.
- 18 When I said, "My foot is slipping," your love, O LORD, supported me.
- 19 When I was upset and beside myself, you calmed me down and cheered me up.
- 19 When anxiety was great within me, your consolation brought joy to my soul.
- 20 Can Misrule have anything in common with you? Can Troublemaker pretend to be on your side?
- 20 Can a corrupt throne be allied with you-- one that brings on misery by its decrees?
- 21 They ganged up on good people, plotted behind the backs of the innocent.
- 21 They band together against the righteous and condemn the innocent to death.
- 22 But GOD became my hideout, God was my high mountain retreat,
- 22 But the LORD has become my fortress, and my God the rock in whom I take refuge.
- 23 Then boomeranged their evil back on them: for their evil ways he wiped them out, our GOD cleaned them out for good.
- 23 He will repay them for their sins and destroy them for their wickedness; the LORD our God will destroy them.

Psalms 95

MSG

NIV

- 1 Come, let's shout praises to GOD, raise the roof for the Rock who saved us!
- 1 Come, let us sing for joy to the LORD; let us shout aloud to the Rock of our salvation.
- 2 Let's march into his presence singing praises, lifting the rafters with our hymns!
- 2 Let us come before him with thanksgiving and extol him with music and song.
- 3 And why? Because GOD is the best, High King over all the gods.
- 3 For the LORD is the great God, the great King above all gods.
- 4 In one hand he holds deep caves and caverns, in the other hand grasps the high mountains.
- 4 In his hand are the depths of the earth, and the mountain peaks belong to him.
- 5 He made Ocean--he owns it! His hands sculpted Earth!
- 5 The sea is his, for he made it, and his hands formed the dry land.
- 6 So come, let us worship: bow before him, on your knees before GOD, who made us!
- 6 Come, let us bow down in worship, let us kneel before the LORD our Maker;
- 7 Oh yes, he's our God, and we're the people he pastures, the flock he feeds. Drop everything and listen, listen as he speaks:
- 7 for he is our God and we are the people of his pasture, the flock under his care. Today, if you hear his voice,
- 8 "Don't turn a deaf ear as in the Bitter Uprising, As on the day of the Wilderness Test,
- 8 do not harden your hearts as you did at Meribah, as you did that day at Massah in the desert,
- 9 when your ancestors turned and put me to the test.
- 9 where your fathers tested and tried me, though they had seen what I did.
- 10 For forty years they watched me at work among them, as over and over they tried my patience. And I was provoked--oh, was I provoked! 'Can't

- they keep their minds on God for five minutes? Do they simply refuse to walk down my road?'
- 10 For forty years I was angry with that generation; I said, "They are a people whose hearts go astray, and they have not known my ways."
- 11 Exasperated, I exploded, "They'll never get where they're headed, never be able to sit down and rest."
- 11 So I declared on oath in my anger, "They shall never enter my rest."

Psalms 96

MSG

NIV

- 1 Sing GOD a brand-new song! Earth and everyone in it, sing!
- 1 Sing to the LORD a new song; sing to the LORD, all the earth.
- 2 Sing to GOD--worship GOD! Shout the news of his victory from sea to sea,
- 2 Sing to the LORD, praise his name; proclaim his salvation day after day.
- 3 Take the news of his glory to the lost, News of his wonders to one and all!
- 3 Declare his glory among the nations, his marvelous deeds among all peoples.
- 4 For GOD is great, and worth a thousand Hallelujahs. His terrible beauty makes the gods look cheap;
- 4 For great is the LORD and most worthy of praise; he is to be feared above all gods.
- 5 Pagan gods are mere tatters and rags. GOD made the heavens--
- 5 For all the gods of the nations are idols, but the LORD made the heavens.
- 6 Royal splendor radiates from him, A powerful beauty sets him apart.
- 6 Splendor and majesty are before him; strength and glory are in his sanctuary.
- 7 Bravo, GOD, Bravo! Everyone join in the great shout: Encore! In awe before the beauty, in awe before the might.
- 7 Ascribe to the LORD, O families of nations, ascribe to the LORD glory and strength.
- 8 Bring gifts and celebrate,

- 8 Ascribe to the LORD the glory due his name; bring an offering and come into his courts.
- 9 Bow before the beauty of GOD, Then to your knees--everyone worship!
- 9 Worship the LORD in the splendor of his holiness; tremble before him, all the earth.
- 10 Get out the message--GOD Rules! He put the world on a firm foundation; He treats everyone fair and square.
- 10 Say among the nations, "The LORD reigns." The world is firmly established, it cannot be moved; he will judge the peoples with equity.
- 11 Let's hear it from Sky, With Earth joining in, And a huge round of applause from Sea.
- 11 Let the heavens rejoice, let the earth be glad; let the sea resound, and all that is in it;
- 12 Let Wilderness turn cartwheels, Animals, come dance, Put every tree of the forest in the choir--
- 12 let the fields be jubilant, and everything in them. Then all the trees of the forest will sing for joy;
- 13 An extravaganza before GOD as he comes, As he comes to set everything right on earth, Set everything right, treat everyone fair.
- 13 they will sing before the LORD, for he comes, he comes to judge the earth. He will judge the world in righteousness and the peoples in his truth.

Psalms 97

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD rules: there's something to shout over! On the double, mainlands and islands--celebrate!
- 1 The LORD reigns, let the earth be glad; let the distant shores rejoice.
- 2 Bright clouds and storm clouds circle 'round him; Right and justice anchor his rule.
- 2 Clouds and thick darkness surround him; righteousness and justice are the foundation of his throne.
- 3 Fire blazes out before him, Flaming high up the craggy mountains.
- 3 Fire goes before him and consumes his foes on every side.

- 4 His lightnings light up the world; Earth, wide-eyed, trembles in fear.
4 His lightning lights up the world; the earth sees and trembles.
5 The mountains take one look at GOD And melt, melt like wax before earth's Lord.
5 The mountains melt like wax before the LORD, before the Lord of all the earth.
6 The heavens announce that he'll set everything right, And everyone will see it happen--glorious!
6 The heavens proclaim his righteousness, and all the peoples see his glory.
7 All who serve handcrafted gods will be sorry-- And they were so proud of their ragamuffin gods! On your knees, all you gods--worship him!
7 All who worship images are put to shame, those who boast in idols--worship him, all you gods!
8 And Zion, you listen and take heart! Daughters of Zion, sing your hearts out: GOD has done it all, has set everything right.
8 Zion hears and rejoices and the villages of Judah are glad because of your judgments, O LORD.
9 You, GOD, are High God of the cosmos, Far, far higher than any of the gods.
9 For you, O LORD, are the Most High over all the earth; you are exalted far above all gods.
10 GOD loves all who hate evil, And those who love him he keeps safe, Snatches them from the grip of the wicked.
10 Let those who love the LORD hate evil, for he guards the lives of his faithful ones and delivers them from the hand of the wicked.
11 Light-seeds are planted in the souls of God's people, Joy-seeds are planted in good heart-soil.
11 Light is shed upon the righteous and joy on the upright in heart.
12 So, God's people, shout praise to GOD, Give thanks to our Holy God!
12 Rejoice in the LORD, you who are righteous, and praise his holy name.

Psalms 98

MSG

NIV

- 1 Sing to GOD a brand-new song. He's made a world of wonders! He rolled up his sleeves, He set things right.
- 1 A psalm. Sing to the LORD a new song, for he has done marvelous things; his right hand and his holy arm have worked salvation for him.
- 2 GOD made history with salvation, He showed the world what he could do.
- 2 The LORD has made his salvation known and revealed his righteousness to the nations.
- 3 He remembered to love us, a bonus To his dear family, Israel--indefatigable love. The whole earth comes to attention. Look--God's work of salvation!
- 3 He has remembered his love and his faithfulness to the house of Israel; all the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God.
- 4 Shout your praises to GOD, everybody! Let loose and sing! Strike up the band!
- 4 Shout for joy to the LORD, all the earth, burst into jubilant song with music;
- 5 Round up an orchestra to play for GOD, Add on a hundred-voice choir.
- 5 make music to the LORD with the harp, with the harp and the sound of singing,
- 6 Feature trumpets and big trombones, Fill the air with praises to King GOD.
- 6 with trumpets and the blast of the ram's horn-- shout for joy before the LORD, the King.
- 7 Let the sea and its fish give a round of applause, With everything living on earth joining in.
- 7 Let the sea resound, and everything in it, the world, and all who live in it.
- 8 Let ocean breakers call out, "Encore!" And mountains harmonize the finale--
- 8 Let the rivers clap their hands, let the mountains sing together for joy;
- 9 A tribute to GOD when he comes, When he comes to set the earth right. He'll straighten out the whole world, He'll put the world right, and everyone in it.
- 9 let them sing before the LORD, for he comes to judge the earth. He will judge the world in righteousness and the peoples with equity.

Psalms 99

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD rules. On your toes, everybody! He rules from his angel throne-- take notice!
- 1 The LORD reigns, let the nations tremble; he sits enthroned between the cherubim, let the earth shake.
- 2 GOD looms majestic in Zion, He towers in splendor over all the big names.
- 2 Great is the LORD in Zion; he is exalted over all the nations.
- 3 Great and terrible your beauty: let everyone praise you! Holy. Yes, holy.
- 3 Let them praise your great and awesome name-- he is holy.
- 4 Strong King, lover of justice, You laid things out fair and square; You set down the foundations in Jacob, Foundation stones of just and right ways.
- 4 The King is mighty, he loves justice-- you have established equity; in Jacob you have done what is just and right.
- 5 Honor GOD, our God; worship his rule! Holy. Yes, holy.
- 5 Exalt the LORD our God and worship at his footstool; he is holy.
- 6 Moses and Aaron were his priests, Samuel among those who prayed to him. They prayed to GOD and he answered them;
- 6 Moses and Aaron were among his priests, Samuel was among those who called on his name; they called on the LORD and he answered them.
- 7 He spoke from the pillar of cloud. And they did what he said; they kept the law he gave them.
- 7 He spoke to them from the pillar of cloud; they kept his statutes and the decrees he gave them.
- 8 And then GOD, our God, answered them (But you were never soft on their sins).
- 8 O LORD our God, you answered them; you were to Israel a forgiving God, though you punished their misdeeds.
- 9 Lift high GOD, our God; worship at his holy mountain. Holy. Yes, holy is GOD our God.
- 9 Exalt the LORD our God and worship at his holy mountain, for the LORD our God is holy.

Psalms 100

MSG

NIV

- 1 A thanksgiving psalm. On your feet now--applaud GOD!
- 1 A psalm. For giving thanks. Shout for joy to the LORD, all the earth.
- 2 Bring a gift of laughter, sing yourselves into his presence.
- 2 Worship the LORD with gladness; come before him with joyful songs.
- 3 Know this: GOD is God, and God, GOD. He made us; we didn't make him. We're his people, his well-tended sheep.
- 3 Know that the LORD is God. It is he who made us, and we are his; we are his people, the sheep of his pasture.
- 4 Enter with the password: "Thank you!" Make yourselves at home, talking praise. Thank him. Worship him.
- 4 Enter his gates with thanksgiving and his courts with praise; give thanks to him and praise his name.
- 5 For GOD is sheer beauty, all-generous in love, loyal always and ever.
- 5 For the LORD is good and his love endures forever; his faithfulness continues through all generations.]

Psalms 101

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. My theme song is God's love and justice, and I'm singing it right to you, GOD.
- 1 Of David. A psalm. I will sing of your love and justice; to you, O LORD, I will sing praise.
- 2 I'm finding my way down the road of right living, but how long before you show up? I'm doing the very best I can, and I'm doing it at home, where it counts.
- 2 I will be careful to lead a blameless life-- when will you come to me? I will walk in my house with blameless heart.
- 3 I refuse to take a second look at corrupting people and degrading things. I reject made-in-Canaan gods, stay clear of contamination.

- 3 I will set before my eyes no vile thing. The deeds of faithless men I hate; they will not cling to me.
- 4 The crooked in heart keep their distance; I refuse to shake hands with those who plan evil.
- 4 Men of perverse heart shall be far from me; I will have nothing to do with evil.
- 5 I put a gag on the gossip who bad-mouths his neighbor; I can't stand arrogance.
- 5 Whoever slanders his neighbor in secret, him will I put to silence; whoever has haughty eyes and a proud heart, him will I not endure.
- 6 But I have my eye on salt-of-the-earth people-- they're the ones I want working with me; Men and women on the straight and narrow-- these are the ones I want at my side.
- 6 My eyes will be on the faithful in the land, that they may dwell with me; he whose walk is blameless will minister to me.
- 7 But no one who traffics in lies gets a job with me; I have no patience with liars. I've rounded up all the wicked like cattle and herded them right out of the country.
- 7 No one who practices deceit will dwell in my house; no one who speaks falsely will stand in my presence.
- 8 I purged GOD's city of all who make a business of evil. A prayer of one whose life is falling to pieces, and who lets God know just how bad it is.
- 8 Every morning I will put to silence all the wicked in the land; I will cut off every evildoer from the city of the LORD.

Psalms 102

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD, listen! Listen to my prayer, listen to the pain in my cries.
- 1 A prayer of an afflicted man. When he is faint and pours out his lament before the LORD. Hear my prayer, O LORD; let my cry for help come to you.
- 2 Don't turn your back on me just when I need you so desperately. Pay attention! This is a cry for help! And hurry--this can't wait!

2 Do not hide your face from me when I am in distress. Turn your ear to me; when I call, answer me quickly.

3 I'm wasting away to nothing, I'm burning up with fever.

3 For my days vanish like smoke; my bones burn like glowing embers.

4 I'm a ghost of my former self, half-consumed already by terminal illness.

4 My heart is blighted and withered like grass; I forget to eat my food.

5 My jaws ache from gritting my teeth; I'm nothing but skin and bones.

5 Because of my loud groaning I am reduced to skin and bones.

6 I'm like a buzzard in the desert, a crow perched on the rubble.

6 I am like a desert owl, like an owl among the ruins.

7 Insomniac, I twitter away, mournful as a sparrow in the gutter.

7 I lie awake; I have become like a bird alone on a roof.

8 All day long my enemies taunt me, while others just curse.

8 All day long my enemies taunt me; those who rail against me use my name as a curse.

9 They bring in meals--casseroles of ashes! I draw drink from a barrel of my tears.

9 For I eat ashes as my food and mingle my drink with tears

10 And all because of your furious anger; you swept me up and threw me out.

10 because of your great wrath, for you have taken me up and thrown me aside.

11 There's nothing left of me-- a withered weed, swept clean from the path.

11 My days are like the evening shadow; I wither away like grass.

12 Yet you, GOD, are sovereign still, always and ever sovereign.

12 But you, O LORD, sit enthroned forever; your renown endures through all generations.

13 You'll get up from your throne and help Zion-- it's time for compassionate help.

13 You will arise and have compassion on Zion, for it is time to show favor to her; the appointed time has come.

14 Oh, how your servants love this city's rubble and weep with compassion over its dust!

14 For her stones are dear to your servants; her very dust moves them to pity.

15 The godless nations will sit up and take notice --see your glory, worship your name--

15 The nations will fear the name of the LORD, all the kings of the earth will revere your glory.

16 When GOD rebuilds Zion, when he shows up in all his glory,

16 For the LORD will rebuild Zion and appear in his glory.

17 When he attends to the prayer of the wretched. He won't dismiss their prayer.

17 He will respond to the prayer of the destitute; he will not despise their plea.

18 Write this down for the next generation so people not yet born will praise GOD:

18 Let this be written for a future generation, that a people not yet created may praise the LORD:

19 "GOD looked out from his high holy place; from heaven he surveyed the earth.

19 The LORD looked down from his sanctuary on high, from heaven he viewed the earth,

20 He listened to the groans of the doomed, he opened the doors of their death cells."

20 to hear the groans of the prisoners and release those condemned to death."

21 Write it so the story can be told in Zion, so GOD's praise will be sung in Jerusalem's streets

21 So the name of the LORD will be declared in Zion and his praise in Jerusalem

22 And wherever people gather together along with their rulers to worship him.

22 when the peoples and the kingdoms assemble to worship the LORD.

23 GOD sovereignly brought me to my knees, he cut me down in my prime.

23 In the course of my life he broke my strength; he cut short my days.

24 "Oh, don't," I prayed, "please don't let me die. You have more years than you know what to do with!

24 So I said: "Do not take me away, O my God, in the midst of my days; your years go on through all generations.

25 You laid earth's foundations a long time ago, and handcrafted the very heavens;
25 In the beginning you laid the foundations of the earth, and the heavens are the work of your hands.
26 You'll still be around when they're long gone, threadbare and discarded like an old suit of clothes. You'll throw them away like a worn-out coat,
26 They will perish, but you remain; they will all wear out like a garment. Like clothing you will change them and they will be discarded.
27 but year after year you're as good as new.
27 But you remain the same, and your years will never end.
28 Your servants' children will have a good place to live and their children will be at home with you."
28 The children of your servants will live in your presence; their descendants will be established before you."

Psalms 103

MSG

NIV

1 A David psalm. O my soul, bless GOD. From head to toe, I'll bless his holy name!
1 Of David. Praise the LORD, O my soul; all my inmost being, praise his holy name.
2 O my soul, bless GOD, don't forget a single blessing!
2 Praise the LORD, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits--
3 He forgives your sins--every one. He heals your diseases--every one.
3 who forgives all your sins and heals all your diseases,
4 He redeems you from hell--saves your life! He crowns you with love and mercy--a paradise crown.
4 who redeems your life from the pit and crowns you with love and compassion,
5 He wraps you in goodness--beauty eternal. He renews your youth--you're always young in his presence.
5 who satisfies your desires with good things so that your youth is renewed like the eagle's.

6 GOD makes everything come out right; he puts victims back on their feet.

6 The LORD works righteousness and justice for all the oppressed.

7 He showed Moses how he went about his work, opened up his plans to all Israel.

7 He made known his ways to Moses, his deeds to the people of Israel:

8 GOD is sheer mercy and grace; not easily angered, he's rich in love.

8 The LORD is compassionate and gracious, slow to anger, abounding in love.

9 He doesn't endlessly nag and scold, nor hold grudges forever.

9 He will not always accuse, nor will he harbor his anger forever;

10 He doesn't treat us as our sins deserve, nor pay us back in full for our wrongs.

10 he does not treat us as our sins deserve or repay us according to our iniquities.

11 As high as heaven is over the earth, so strong is his love to those who fear him.

11 For as high as the heavens are above the earth, so great is his love for those who fear him;

12 And as far as sunrise is from sunset, he has separated us from our sins.

12 as far as the east is from the west, so far has he removed our transgressions from us.

13 As parents feel for their children, GOD feels for those who fear him.

13 As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear him;

14 He knows us inside and out, keeps in mind that we're made of mud.

14 for he knows how we are formed, he remembers that we are dust.

15 Men and women don't live very long; like wildflowers they spring up and blossom,

15 As for man, his days are like grass, he flourishes like a flower of the field;

16 But a storm snuffs them out just as quickly, leaving nothing to show they were here.

16 the wind blows over it and it is gone, and its place remembers it no more.

- 17 GOD's love, though, is ever and always, eternally present to all who fear him, Making everything right for them and their children
- 17 But from everlasting to everlasting the LORD's love is with those who fear him, and his righteousness with their children's children--
- 18 as they follow his Covenant ways and remember to do whatever he said.
- 18 with those who keep his covenant and remember to obey his precepts.
- 19 GOD has set his throne in heaven; he rules over us all. He's the King!
- 19 The LORD has established his throne in heaven, and his kingdom rules over all.
- 20 So bless GOD, you angels, ready and able to fly at his bidding, quick to hear and do what he says.
- 20 Praise the LORD, you his angels, you mighty ones who do his bidding, who obey his word.
- 21 Bless GOD, all you armies of angels, alert to respond to whatever he wills.
- 21 Praise the LORD, all his heavenly hosts, you his servants who do his will.
- 22 Bless GOD, all creatures, wherever you are-- everything and everyone made by GOD. And you, O my soul, bless GOD!
- 22 Praise the LORD, all his works everywhere in his dominion. Praise the LORD, O my soul.

Psalms 104

MSG

NIV

- 1 O my soul, bless GOD! GOD, my God, how great you are! beautifully, gloriously robed,
- 1 Praise the LORD, O my soul. O LORD my God, you are very great; you are clothed with splendor and majesty.
- 2 Dressed up in sunshine, and all heaven stretched out for your tent.
- 2 He wraps himself in light as with a garment; he stretches out the heavens like a tent
- 3 You built your palace on the ocean deeps, made a chariot out of clouds and took off on wind-wings.

- 3 and lays the beams of his upper chambers on their waters. He makes the clouds his chariot and rides on the wings of the wind.
- 4 You commandeered winds as messengers, appointed fire and flame as ambassadors.
- 4 He makes winds his messengers, flames of fire his servants.
- 5 You set earth on a firm foundation so that nothing can shake it, ever.
- 5 He set the earth on its foundations; it can never be moved.
- 6 You blanketed earth with ocean, covered the mountains with deep waters;
- 6 You covered it with the deep as with a garment; the waters stood above the mountains.
- 7 Then you roared and the water ran away-- your thunder crash put it to flight.
- 7 But at your rebuke the waters fled, at the sound of your thunder they took to flight;
- 8 Mountains pushed up, valleys spread out in the places you assigned them.
- 8 they flowed over the mountains, they went down into the valleys, to the place you assigned for them.
- 9 You set boundaries between earth and sea; never again will earth be flooded.
- 9 You set a boundary they cannot cross; never again will they cover the earth.
- 10 You started the springs and rivers, sent them flowing among the hills.
- 10 He makes springs pour water into the ravines; it flows between the mountains.
- 11 All the wild animals now drink their fill, wild donkeys quench their thirst.
- 11 They give water to all the beasts of the field; the wild donkeys quench their thirst.
- 12 Along the riverbanks the birds build nests, ravens make their voices heard.
- 12 The birds of the air nest by the waters; they sing among the branches.
- 13 You water the mountains from your heavenly cisterns; earth is supplied with plenty of water.
- 13 He waters the mountains from his upper chambers; the earth is satisfied by the fruit of his work.

14 You make grass grow for the livestock, hay for the animals that plow the ground. Oh yes, God brings grain from the land,
14 He makes grass grow for the cattle, and plants for man to cultivate-- bringing forth food from the earth:
15 wine to make people happy, Their faces glowing with health, a people well-fed and hearty.
15 wine that gladdens the heart of man, oil to make his face shine, and bread that sustains his heart.
16 GOD's trees are well-watered-- the Lebanon cedars he planted.
16 The trees of the LORD are well watered, the cedars of Lebanon that he planted.
17 Birds build their nests in those trees; look--the stork at home in the treetop.
17 There the birds make their nests; the stork has its home in the pine trees.
18 Mountain goats climb about the cliffs; badgers burrow among the rocks.
18 The high mountains belong to the wild goats; the crags are a refuge for the coneys.
19 The moon keeps track of the seasons, the sun is in charge of each day.
19 The moon marks off the seasons, and the sun knows when to go down.
20 When it's dark and night takes over, all the forest creatures come out.
20 You bring darkness, it becomes night, and all the beasts of the forest prowl.
21 The young lions roar for their prey, clamoring to God for their supper.
21 The lions roar for their prey and seek their food from God.
22 When the sun comes up, they vanish, lazily stretched out in their dens.
22 The sun rises, and they steal away; they return and lie down in their dens.
23 Meanwhile, men and women go out to work, busy at their jobs until evening.
23 Then man goes out to his work, to his labor until evening.
24 What a wildly wonderful world, GOD! You made it all, with Wisdom at your side, made earth overflow with your wonderful creations.
24 How many are your works, O LORD! In wisdom you made them all; the earth is full of your creatures.
25 Oh, look--the deep, wide sea, brimming with fish past counting, sardines and sharks and salmon.

25 There is the sea, vast and spacious, teeming with creatures beyond number-- living things both large and small.

26 Ships plow those waters, and Leviathan, your pet dragon, romps in them.

26 There the ships go to and fro, and the leviathan, which you formed to frolic there.

27 All the creatures look expectantly to you to give them their meals on time.

27 These all look to you to give them their food at the proper time.

28 You come, and they gather around; you open your hand and they eat from it.

28 When you give it to them, they gather it up; when you open your hand, they are satisfied with good things.

29 If you turned your back, they'd die in a minute-- Take back your Spirit and they die, revert to original mud;

29 When you hide your face, they are terrified; when you take away their breath, they die and return to the dust.

30 Send out your Spirit and they spring to life-- the whole countryside in bloom and blossom.

30 When you send your Spirit, they are created, and you renew the face of the earth.

31 The glory of GOD--let it last forever! Let GOD enjoy his creation!

31 May the glory of the LORD endure forever; may the LORD rejoice in his works--

32 He takes one look at earth and triggers an earthquake, points a finger at the mountains, and volcanoes erupt.

32 he who looks at the earth, and it trembles, who touches the mountains, and they smoke.

33 Oh, let me sing to GOD all my life long, sing hymns to my God as long as I live!

33 I will sing to the LORD all my life; I will sing praise to my God as long as I live.

34 Oh, let my song please him; I'm so pleased to be singing to GOD.

34 May my meditation be pleasing to him, as I rejoice in the LORD.

35 But clear the ground of sinners-- no more godless men and women! O my soul, bless GOD!

35 But may sinners vanish from the earth and the wicked be no more.
Praise the LORD, O my soul. Praise the LORD.

Psalms 105

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! Thank GOD! Pray to him by name! Tell everyone you meet what he has done!
- 1 Give thanks to the LORD, call on his name; make known among the nations what he has done.
- 2 Sing him songs, belt out hymns, translate his wonders into music!
- 2 Sing to him, sing praise to him; tell of all his wonderful acts.
- 3 Honor his holy name with Hallelujahs, you who seek GOD. Live a happy life!
- 3 Glory in his holy name; let the hearts of those who seek the LORD rejoice.
- 4 Keep your eyes open for GOD, watch for his works; be alert for signs of his presence.
- 4 Look to the LORD and his strength; seek his face always.
- 5 Remember the world of wonders he has made, his miracles, and the verdicts he's rendered--
- 5 Remember the wonders he has done, his miracles, and the judgments he pronounced,
- 6 O seed of Abraham, his servant, O child of Jacob, his chosen.
- 6 O descendants of Abraham his servant, O sons of Jacob, his chosen ones.
- 7 He's GOD, our God, in charge of the whole earth.
- 7 He is the LORD our God; his judgments are in all the earth.
- 8 And he remembers, remembers his Covenant-- for a thousand generations he's been as good as his word.
- 8 He remembers his covenant forever, the word he commanded, for a thousand generations,
- 9 It's the Covenant he made with Abraham, the same oath he swore to Isaac,
- 9 the covenant he made with Abraham, the oath he swore to Isaac.

10 The very statute he established with Jacob, the eternal Covenant with Israel,
10 He confirmed it to Jacob as a decree, to Israel as an everlasting covenant:
11 Namely, "I give you the land. Canaan is your hill-country inheritance."
11 To you I will give the land of Canaan as the portion you will inherit.
12 When they didn't count for much, a mere handful, and strangers at that,
12 When they were but few in number, few indeed, and strangers in it,
13 Wandering from country to country, drifting from pillar to post,
13 they wandered from nation to nation, from one kingdom to another.
14 He permitted no one to abuse them. He told kings to keep their hands off:
14 He allowed no one to oppress them; for their sake he rebuked kings:
15 "Don't you dare lay a hand on my anointed, don't hurt a hair on the heads of my prophets."
15 Do not touch my anointed ones; do my prophets no harm.
16 Then he called down a famine on the country, he broke every last blade of wheat.
16 He called down famine on the land and destroyed all their supplies of food;
17 But he sent a man on ahead: Joseph, sold as a slave.
17 and he sent a man before them-- Joseph, sold as a slave.
18 They put cruel chains on his ankles, an iron collar around his neck,
18 They bruised his feet with shackles, his neck was put in irons,
19 Until God's word came to the Pharaoh, and GOD confirmed his promise.
19 till what he foretold came to pass, till the word of the LORD proved him true.
20 God sent the king to release him. The Pharaoh set Joseph free;
20 The king sent and released him, the ruler of peoples set him free.
21 He appointed him master of his palace, put him in charge of all his business
21 He made him master of his household, ruler over all he possessed,
22 To personally instruct his princes and train his advisors in wisdom.
22 to instruct his princes as he pleased and teach his elders wisdom.
23 Then Israel entered Egypt, Jacob immigrated to the Land of Ham.

23 Then Israel entered Egypt; Jacob lived as an alien in the land of Ham.
24 God gave his people lots of babies; soon their numbers alarmed their foes.
24 The LORD made his people very fruitful; he made them too numerous for their foes,
25 He turned the Egyptians against his people; they abused and cheated God's servants.
25 whose hearts he turned to hate his people, to conspire against his servants.
26 Then he sent his servant Moses, and Aaron, whom he also chose.
26 He sent Moses his servant, and Aaron, whom he had chosen.
27 They worked marvels in that spiritual wasteland, miracles in the Land of Ham.
27 They performed his miraculous signs among them, his wonders in the land of Ham.
28 He spoke, "Darkness!" and it turned dark-- they couldn't see what they were doing.
28 He sent darkness and made the land dark-- for had they not rebelled against his words?
29 He turned all their water to blood so that all their fish died;
29 He turned their waters into blood, causing their fish to die.
30 He made frogs swarm through the land, even into the king's bedroom;
30 Their land teemed with frogs, which went up into the bedrooms of their rulers.
31 He gave the word and flies swarmed, gnats filled the air.
31 He spoke, and there came swarms of flies, and gnats throughout their country.
32 He substituted hail for rain, he stabbed their land with lightning;
32 He turned their rain into hail, with lightning throughout their land;
33 He wasted their vines and fig trees, smashed their groves of trees to splinters;
33 he struck down their vines and fig trees and shattered the trees of their country.
34 With a word he brought in locusts, millions of locusts, armies of locusts;
34 He spoke, and the locusts came, grasshoppers without number;

35 They consumed every blade of grass in the country and picked the ground clean of produce;
35 they ate up every green thing in their land, ate up the produce of their soil.
36 He struck down every firstborn in the land, the first fruits of their virile powers.
36 Then he struck down all the firstborn in their land, the firstfruits of all their manhood.
37 He led Israel out, their arms filled with loot, and not one among his tribes even stumbled.
37 He brought out Israel, laden with silver and gold, and from among their tribes no one faltered.
38 Egypt was glad to have them go-- they were scared to death of them.
38 Egypt was glad when they left, because dread of Israel had fallen on them.
39 God spread a cloud to keep them cool through the day and a fire to light their way through the night;
39 He spread out a cloud as a covering, and a fire to give light at night.
40 They prayed and he brought quail, filled them with the bread of heaven;
40 They asked, and he brought them quail and satisfied them with the bread of heaven.
41 He opened the rock and water poured out; it flowed like a river through that desert--
41 He opened the rock, and water gushed out; like a river it flowed in the desert.
42 All because he remembered his Covenant, his promise to Abraham, his servant.
42 For he remembered his holy promise given to his servant Abraham.
43 Remember this! He led his people out singing for joy; his chosen people marched, singing their hearts out!
43 He brought out his people with rejoicing, his chosen ones with shouts of joy;
44 He made them a gift of the country they entered, helped them seize the wealth of the nations
44 he gave them the lands of the nations, and they fell heir to what others had toiled for--

45 So they could do everything he told them-- could follow his instructions to the letter. Hallelujah!

45 that they might keep his precepts and observe his laws. Praise the LORD.

Psalms 106

MSG

NIV

1 Hallelujah! Thank GOD! And why? Because he's good, because his love lasts.

1 Praise the LORD. Give thanks to the LORD, for he is good; his love endures forever.

2 But who on earth can do it-- declaim GOD's mighty acts, broadcast all his praises?

2 Who can proclaim the mighty acts of the LORD or fully declare his praise?

3 You're one happy man when you do what's right, one happy woman when you form the habit of justice.

3 Blessed are they who maintain justice, who constantly do what is right.

4 Remember me, GOD, when you enjoy your people; include me when you save them;

4 Remember me, O LORD, when you show favor to your people, come to my aid when you save them,

5 I want to see your chosen succeed, celebrate with your celebrating nation, join the Hallelujahs of your pride and joy!

5 that I may enjoy the prosperity of your chosen ones, that I may share in the joy of your nation and join your inheritance in giving praise.

6 We've sinned a lot, both we and our parents; We've fallen short, hurt a lot of people.

6 We have sinned, even as our fathers did; we have done wrong and acted wickedly.

7 After our parents left Egypt, they took your wonders for granted, forgot your great and wonderful love. They were barely beyond the Red Sea when they defied the High God--

- 7 When our fathers were in Egypt, they gave no thought to your miracles; they did not remember your many kindnesses, and they rebelled by the sea, the Red Sea.
- 8 the very place he saved them! --the place he revealed his amazing power!
- 8 Yet he saved them for his name's sake, to make his mighty power known.
- 9 He rebuked the Red Sea so that it dried up on the spot --he paraded them right through! --no one so much as got wet feet!
- 9 He rebuked the Red Sea, and it dried up; he led them through the depths as through a desert.
- 10 He saved them from a life of oppression, pried them loose from the grip of the enemy.
- 10 He saved them from the hand of the foe; from the hand of the enemy he redeemed them.
- 11 Then the waters flowed back on their oppressors; there wasn't a single survivor.
- 11 The waters covered their adversaries; not one of them survived.
- 12 Then they believed his words were true and broke out in songs of praise.
- 12 Then they believed his promises and sang his praise.
- 13 But it wasn't long before they forgot the whole thing, wouldn't wait to be told what to do.
- 13 But they soon forgot what he had done and did not wait for his counsel.
- 14 They only cared about pleasing themselves in that desert, provoked God with their insistent demands.
- 14 In the desert they gave in to their craving; in the wasteland they put God to the test.
- 15 He gave them exactly what they asked for-- but along with it they got an empty heart.
- 15 So he gave them what they asked for, but sent a wasting disease upon them.
- 16 One day in camp some grew jealous of Moses, also of Aaron, holy priest of GOD.
- 16 In the camp they grew envious of Moses and of Aaron, who was consecrated to the LORD.
- 17 The ground opened and swallowed Dathan, then buried Abiram's gang.

17 The earth opened up and swallowed Dathan; it buried the company of Abiram.

18 Fire flared against that rebel crew and torched them to a cinder.

18 Fire blazed among their followers; a flame consumed the wicked.

19 They cast in metal a bull calf at Horeb and worshiped the statue they'd made.

19 At Horeb they made a calf and worshiped an idol cast from metal.

20 They traded the Glory for a cheap piece of sculpture--a grass-chewing bull!

20 They exchanged their Glory for an image of a bull, which eats grass.

21 They forgot God, their very own Savior, who turned things around in Egypt,

21 They forgot the God who saved them, who had done great things in Egypt,

22 Who created a world of wonders in the Land of Ham, who gave that stunning performance at the Red Sea.

22 miracles in the land of Ham and awesome deeds by the Red Sea.

23 Fed up, God decided to get rid of them-- and except for Moses, his chosen, he would have. But Moses stood in the gap and deflected God's anger, prevented it from destroying them utterly.

23 So he said he would destroy them-- had not Moses, his chosen one, stood in the breach before him to keep his wrath from destroying them.

24 They went on to reject the Blessed Land, didn't believe a word of what God promised.

24 Then they despised the pleasant land; they did not believe his promise.

25 They found fault with the life they had and turned a deaf ear to GOD's voice.

25 They grumbled in their tents and did not obey the LORD.

26 Exasperated, God swore that he'd lay them low in the desert,

26 So he swore to them with uplifted hand that he would make them fall in the desert,

27 Scattering their children hither and yon, strewing them all over the earth.

27 make their descendants fall among the nations and scatter them throughout the lands.

28 Then they linked up with Baal Peor, attending funeral banquets and eating idol food.

28 They yoked themselves to the Baal of Peor and ate sacrifices offered to lifeless gods;

29 That made God so angry that a plague spread through their ranks;

29 they provoked the LORD to anger by their wicked deeds, and a plague broke out among them.

30 Phinehas stood up and pled their case and the plague was stopped.

30 But Phinehas stood up and intervened, and the plague was checked.

31 This was counted to his credit; his descendants will never forget it.

31 This was credited to him as righteousness for endless generations to come.

32 They angered God again at Meribah Springs; this time Moses got mixed up in their evil;

32 By the waters of Meribah they angered the LORD, and trouble came to Moses because of them;

33 Because they defied GOD yet again, Moses exploded and lost his temper.

33 for they rebelled against the Spirit of God, and rash words came from Moses' lips.

34 They didn't wipe out those godless cultures as ordered by GOD;

34 They did not destroy the peoples as the LORD had commanded them,

35 Instead they intermarried with the heathen, and in time became just like them.

35 but they mingled with the nations and adopted their customs.

36 They worshiped their idols, were caught in the trap of idols.

36 They worshiped their idols, which became a snare to them.

37 They sacrificed their sons and daughters at the altars of demon gods.

37 They sacrificed their sons and their daughters to demons.

38 They slit the throats of their babies, murdered their infant girls and boys. They offered their babies to Canaan's gods; the blood of their babies stained the land.

38 They shed innocent blood, the blood of their sons and daughters, whom they sacrificed to the idols of Canaan, and the land was desecrated by their blood.

39 Their way of life stank to high heaven; they lived like whores.

39 They defiled themselves by what they did; by their deeds they prostituted themselves.

40 And GOD was furious--a wildfire anger; he couldn't stand even to look at his people.

40 Therefore the LORD was angry with his people and abhorred his inheritance.

41 He turned them over to the heathen so that the people who hated them ruled them.

41 He handed them over to the nations, and their foes ruled over them.

42 Their enemies made life hard for them; they were tyrannized under that rule.

42 Their enemies oppressed them and subjected them to their power.

43 Over and over God rescued them, but they never learned-- until finally their sins destroyed them.

43 Many times he delivered them, but they were bent on rebellion and they wasted away in their sin.

44 Still, when God saw the trouble they were in and heard their cries for help,

44 But he took note of their distress when he heard their cry;

45 He remembered his Covenant with them, and, immense with love, took them by the hand.

45 for their sake he remembered his covenant and out of his great love he relented.

46 He poured out his mercy on them while their captors looked on, amazed.

46 He caused them to be pitied by all who held them captive.

47 Save us, GOD, our God! Gather us back out of exile So we can give thanks to your holy name and join in the glory when you are praised!

47 Save us, O LORD our God, and gather us from the nations, that we may give thanks to your holy name and glory in your praise.

48 Blessed be GOD, Israel's God! Bless now, bless always! Oh! Let everyone say Amen! Hallelujah!

48 Praise be to the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting to everlasting. Let all the people say, "Amen!" Praise the LORD.

Psalms 107

MSG

NIV

- 1 Oh, thank GOD--he's so good! His love never runs out.
- 1 Give thanks to the LORD, for he is good; his love endures forever.
- 2 All of you set free by GOD, tell the world! Tell how he freed you from oppression,
- 2 Let the redeemed of the LORD say this-- those he redeemed from the hand of the foe,
- 3 Then rounded you up from all over the place, from the four winds, from the seven seas.
- 3 those he gathered from the lands, from east and west, from north and south.
- 4 Some of you wandered for years in the desert, looking but not finding a good place to live,
- 4 Some wandered in desert wastelands, finding no way to a city where they could settle.
- 5 Half-starved and parched with thirst, staggering and stumbling, on the brink of exhaustion.
- 5 They were hungry and thirsty, and their lives ebbed away.
- 6 Then, in your desperate condition, you called out to GOD. He got you out in the nick of time;
- 6 Then they cried out to the LORD in their trouble, and he delivered them from their distress.
- 7 He put your feet on a wonderful road that took you straight to a good place to live.
- 7 He led them by a straight way to a city where they could settle.
- 8 So thank GOD for his marvelous love, for his miracle mercy to the children he loves.
- 8 Let them give thanks to the LORD for his unfailing love and his wonderful deeds for men,
- 9 He poured great draughts of water down parched throats; the starved and hungry got plenty to eat.
- 9 for he satisfies the thirsty and fills the hungry with good things.
- 10 Some of you were locked in a dark cell, cruelly confined behind bars,

10 Some sat in darkness and the deepest gloom, prisoners suffering in iron chains,
11 Punished for defying God's Word, for turning your back on the High God's counsel--
11 for they had rebelled against the words of God and despised the counsel of the Most High.
12 A hard sentence, and your hearts so heavy, and not a soul in sight to help.
12 So he subjected them to bitter labor; they stumbled, and there was no one to help.
13 Then you called out to GOD in your desperate condition; he got you out in the nick of time.
13 Then they cried to the LORD in their trouble, and he saved them from their distress.
14 He led you out of your dark, dark cell, broke open the jail and led you out.
14 He brought them out of darkness and the deepest gloom and broke away their chains.
15 So thank GOD for his marvelous love, for his miracle mercy to the children he loves;
15 Let them give thanks to the LORD for his unfailing love and his wonderful deeds for men,
16 He shattered the heavy jailhouse doors, he snapped the prison bars like matchsticks!
16 for he breaks down gates of bronze and cuts through bars of iron.
17 Some of you were sick because you'd lived a bad life, your bodies feeling the effects of your sin;
17 Some became fools through their rebellious ways and suffered affliction because of their iniquities.
18 You couldn't stand the sight of food, so miserable you thought you'd be better off dead.
18 They loathed all food and drew near the gates of death.
19 Then you called out to GOD in your desperate condition; he got you out in the nick of time.
19 Then they cried to the LORD in their trouble, and he saved them from their distress.

20 He spoke the word that healed you, that pulled you back from the brink of death.

20 He sent forth his word and healed them; he rescued them from the grave.

21 So thank GOD for his marvelous love, for his miracle mercy to the children he loves;

21 Let them give thanks to the LORD for his unfailing love and his wonderful deeds for men.

22 Offer thanksgiving sacrifices, tell the world what he's done--sing it out!

22 Let them sacrifice thank offerings and tell of his works with songs of joy.

23 Some of you set sail in big ships; you put to sea to do business in faraway ports.

23 Others went out on the sea in ships; they were merchants on the mighty waters.

24 Out at sea you saw GOD in action, saw his breathtaking ways with the ocean:

24 They saw the works of the LORD, his wonderful deeds in the deep.

25 With a word he called up the wind-- an ocean storm, towering waves!

25 For he spoke and stirred up a tempest that lifted high the waves.

26 You shot high in the sky, then the bottom dropped out; your hearts were stuck in your throats.

26 They mounted up to the heavens and went down to the depths; in their peril their courage melted away.

27 You were spun like a top, you reeled like a drunk, you didn't know which end was up.

27 They reeled and staggered like drunken men; they were at their wits' end.

28 Then you called out to GOD in your desperate condition; he got you out in the nick of time.

28 Then they cried out to the LORD in their trouble, and he brought them out of their distress.

29 He quieted the wind down to a whisper, put a muzzle on all the big waves.

29 He stilled the storm to a whisper; the waves of the sea were hushed.

30 And you were so glad when the storm died down, and he led you safely back to harbor.

30 They were glad when it grew calm, and he guided them to their desired haven.

31 So thank GOD for his marvelous love, for his miracle mercy to the children he loves.

31 Let them give thanks to the LORD for his unfailing love and his wonderful deeds for men.

32 Lift high your praises when the people assemble, shout Hallelujah when the elders meet!

32 Let them exalt him in the assembly of the people and praise him in the council of the elders.

33 GOD turned rivers into wasteland, springs of water into sunbaked mud;

33 He turned rivers into a desert, flowing springs into thirsty ground,

34 Luscious orchards became alkali flats because of the evil of the people who lived there.

34 and fruitful land into a salt waste, because of the wickedness of those who lived there.

35 Then he changed wasteland into fresh pools of water, arid earth into springs of water,

35 He turned the desert into pools of water and the parched ground into flowing springs;

36 Brought in the hungry and settled them there; they moved in--what a great place to live!

36 there he brought the hungry to live, and they founded a city where they could settle.

37 They sowed the fields, they planted vineyards, they reaped a bountiful harvest.

37 They sowed fields and planted vineyards that yielded a fruitful harvest;

38 He blessed them and they prospered greatly; their herds of cattle never decreased.

38 he blessed them, and their numbers greatly increased, and he did not let their herds diminish.

39 But abuse and evil and trouble declined

39 Then their numbers decreased, and they were humbled by oppression, calamity and sorrow;

- 40 as he heaped scorn on princes and sent them away. He gave the poor a safe place to live,
40 he who pours contempt on nobles made them wander in a trackless waste.
41 treated their clans like well-cared-for sheep.
41 But he lifted the needy out of their affliction and increased their families like flocks.
42 Good people see this and are glad; bad people are speechless, stopped in their tracks.
42 The upright see and rejoice, but all the wicked shut their mouths.
43 If you are really wise, you'll think this over-- it's time you appreciated GOD's deep love.
43 Whoever is wise, let him heed these things and consider the great love of the LORD.

Psalms 108

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David prayer. I'm ready, God, so ready, ready from head to toe. Ready to sing, ready to raise a God-song:
1 A song. A psalm of David. My heart is steadfast, O God; I will sing and make music with all my soul.
2 "Wake, soul! Wake, lute! Wake up, you sleepyhead sun!"
2 Awake, harp and lyre! I will awaken the dawn.
3 I'm thanking you, GOD, out in the streets, singing your praises in town and country.
3 I will praise you, O LORD, among the nations; I will sing of you among the peoples.
4 The deeper your love, the higher it goes; every cloud's a flag to your faithfulness.
4 For great is your love, higher than the heavens; your faithfulness reaches to the skies.
5 Soar high in the skies, O God! Cover the whole earth with your glory!
5 Be exalted, O God, above the heavens, and let your glory be over all the earth.

- 6 And for the sake of the one you love so much, reach down and help me--
answer me!
- 6 Save us and help us with your right hand, that those you love may be
delivered.
- 7 That's when God spoke in holy splendor: "Brimming over with joy, I
make a present of Shechem, I hand out Succoth Valley as a gift.
- 7 God has spoken from his sanctuary: "In triumph I will parcel out
Shechem and measure off the Valley of Succoth.
- 8 Gilead's in my pocket, to say nothing of Manasseh. Ephraim's my hard
hat, Judah my hammer.
- 8 Gilead is mine, Manasseh is mine; Ephraim is my helmet, Judah my
scepter.
- 9 Moab's a scrub bucket-- I mop the floor with Moab, Spit on Edom, rain
fireworks all over Philistia."
- 9 Moab is my washbasin, upon Edom I toss my sandal; over Philistia I
shout in triumph."
- 10 Who will take me to the thick of the fight? Who'll show me the road to
Edom?
- 10 Who will bring me to the fortified city? Who will lead me to Edom?
- 11 You aren't giving up on us, are you, God? refusing to go out with our
troops?
- 11 Is it not you, O God, you who have rejected us and no longer go out
with our armies?
- 12 Give us help for the hard task; human help is worthless.
- 12 Give us aid against the enemy, for the help of man is worthless.
- 13 In God we'll do our very best; he'll flatten the opposition for good.
- 13 With God we will gain the victory, and he will trample down our
enemies.

Psalms 109

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David prayer. My God, don't turn a deaf ear to my hallelujah prayer.
- 1 For the director of music. Of David. A psalm. O God, whom I praise, do
not remain silent,

- 2 Liars are pouring out invective on me; Their lying tongues are like a pack of dogs out to get me,
- 2 for wicked and deceitful men have opened their mouths against me; they have spoken against me with lying tongues.
- 3 barking their hate, nipping my heels--and for no reason!
- 3 With words of hatred they surround me; they attack me without cause.
- 4 I loved them and now they slander me--yes, me!-- and treat my prayer like a crime;
- 4 In return for my friendship they accuse me, but I am a man of prayer.
- 5 They return my good with evil, they return my love with hate.
- 5 They repay me evil for good, and hatred for my friendship.
- 6 Send the Evil One to accuse my accusing judge; dispatch Satan to prosecute him.
- 6 Appoint an evil man to oppose him; let an accuser stand at his right hand.
- 7 When he's judged, let the verdict be, "Guilty," and when he prays, let his prayer turn to sin.
- 7 When he is tried, let him be found guilty, and may his prayers condemn him.
- 8 Give him a short life, and give his job to somebody else.
- 8 May his days be few; may another take his place of leadership.
- 9 Make orphans of his children, dress his wife in widow's weeds;
- 9 May his children be fatherless and his wife a widow.
- 10 Turn his children into begging street urchins, evicted from their homes--homeless.
- 10 May his children be wandering beggars; may they be driven from their ruined homes.
- 11 May the bank foreclose and wipe him out, and strangers, like vultures, pick him clean.
- 11 May a creditor seize all he has; may strangers plunder the fruits of his labor.
- 12 May there be no one around to help him out, no one willing to give his orphans a break.
- 12 May no one extend kindness to him or take pity on his fatherless children.
- 13 Chop down his family tree so that nobody even remembers his name.

13 May his descendants be cut off, their names blotted out from the next generation.

14 But erect a memorial to the sin of his father, and make sure his mother's name is there, too--

14 May the iniquity of his fathers be remembered before the LORD; may the sin of his mother never be blotted out.

15 Their sins recorded forever before GOD, but they themselves sunk in oblivion.

15 May their sins always remain before the LORD, that he may cut off the memory of them from the earth.

16 That's all he deserves since he was never once kind, hounded the afflicted and heartbroken to their graves.

16 For he never thought of doing a kindness, but hounded to death the poor and the needy and the brokenhearted.

17 Since he loved cursing so much, let curses rain down; Since he had no taste for blessing, let blessings flee far from him.

17 He loved to pronounce a curse-- may it come on him; he found no pleasure in blessing-- may it be far from him.

18 He dressed up in curses like a fine suit of clothes; he drank curses, took his baths in curses.

18 He wore cursing as his garment; it entered into his body like water, into his bones like oil.

19 So give him a gift--a costume of curses; he can wear curses every day of the week!

19 May it be like a cloak wrapped about him, like a belt tied forever around him.

20 That's what they'll get, those out to get me-- an avalanche of just deserts from GOD.

20 May this be the LORD's payment to my accusers, to those who speak evil of me.

21 Oh, GOD, my Lord, step in; work a miracle for me--you can do it! Get me out of here--your love is so great!--

21 But you, O Sovereign LORD, deal well with me for your name's sake; out of the goodness of your love, deliver me.

22 I'm at the end of my rope, my life in ruins.

22 For I am poor and needy, and my heart is wounded within me.

23 I'm fading away to nothing, passing away, my youth gone, old before my time.
23 I fade away like an evening shadow; I am shaken off like a locust.
24 I'm weak from hunger and can hardly stand up, my body a rack of skin and bones.
24 My knees give way from fasting; my body is thin and gaunt.
25 I'm a joke in poor taste to those who see me; they take one look and shake their heads.
25 I am an object of scorn to my accusers; when they see me, they shake their heads.
26 Help me, oh help me, GOD, my God, save me through your wonderful love;
26 Help me, O LORD my God; save me in accordance with your love.
27 Then they'll know that your hand is in this, that you, GOD, have been at work.
27 Let them know that it is your hand, that you, O LORD, have done it.
28 Let them curse all they want; you do the blessing.
28 They may curse, but you will bless; when they attack they will be put to shame, but your servant will rejoice.
29 Let them be jeered by the crowd when they stand up, followed by cheers for me, your servant. Dress my accusers in clothes dirty with shame, discarded and humiliating old ragbag clothes.
29 My accusers will be clothed with disgrace and wrapped in shame as in a cloak.
30 My mouth's full of great praise for GOD, I'm singing his hallelujahs surrounded by crowds,
30 With my mouth I will greatly extol the LORD; in the great throng I will praise him.
31 For he's always at hand to take the side of the needy, to rescue a life from the unjust judge.
31 For he stands at the right hand of the needy one, to save his life from those who condemn him.

Psalms 110

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David prayer. The word of GOD to my Lord: "Sit alongside me here on my throne until I make your enemies a stool for your feet."
- 1 Of David. A psalm. The LORD says to my Lord: "Sit at my right hand until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet."
- 2 You were forged a strong scepter by GOD of Zion; now rule, though surrounded by enemies!
- 2 The LORD will extend your mighty scepter from Zion; you will rule in the midst of your enemies.
- 3 Your people will freely join you, resplendent in holy armor on the great day of your conquest, Join you at the fresh break of day, join you with all the vigor of youth.
- 3 Your troops will be willing on your day of battle. Arrayed in holy majesty, from the womb of the dawn you will receive the dew of your youth.
- 4 GOD gave his word and he won't take it back: you're the permanent priest, the Melchizedek priest.
- 4 The LORD has sworn and will not change his mind: "You are a priest forever, in the order of Melchizedek."
- 5 The Lord stands true at your side, crushing kings in his terrible wrath,
- 5 The Lord is at your right hand; he will crush kings on the day of his wrath.
- 6 Bringing judgment on the nations, handing out convictions wholesale, crushing opposition across the wide earth.
- 6 He will judge the nations, heaping up the dead and crushing the rulers of the whole earth.
- 7 The King-Maker put his King on the throne; the True King rules with head held high!
- 7 He will drink from a brook beside the way; therefore he will lift up his head.

Psalms 111

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! I give thanks to GOD with everything I've got-- Wherever good people gather, and in the congregation.
- 1 Praise the LORD. I will extol the LORD with all my heart in the council of the upright and in the assembly.
- 2 GOD's works are so great, worth A lifetime of study--endless enjoyment!
- 2 Great are the works of the LORD; they are pondered by all who delight in them.
- 3 Splendor and beauty mark his craft; His generosity never gives out.
- 3 Glorious and majestic are his deeds, and his righteousness endures forever.
- 4 His miracles are his memorial-- This GOD of Grace, this GOD of Love.
- 4 He has caused his wonders to be remembered; the LORD is gracious and compassionate.
- 5 He gave food to those who fear him, He remembered to keep his ancient promise.
- 5 He provides food for those who fear him; he remembers his covenant forever.
- 6 He proved to his people that he could do what he said: Hand them the nations on a platter--a gift!
- 6 He has shown his people the power of his works, giving them the lands of other nations.
- 7 He manufactures truth and justice; All his products are guaranteed to last--
- 7 The works of his hands are faithful and just; all his precepts are trustworthy.
- 8 Never out-of-date, never obsolete, rust-proof. All that he makes and does is honest and true:
- 8 They are steadfast for ever and ever, done in faithfulness and uprightness.
- 9 He paid the ransom for his people, He ordered his Covenant kept forever. He's so personal and holy, worthy of our respect.
- 9 He provided redemption for his people; he ordained his covenant forever-- holy and awesome is his name.
- 10 The good life begins in the fear of GOD-- Do that and you'll know the blessing of GOD. His Hallelujah lasts forever!
- 10 The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom; all who follow his precepts have good understanding. To him belongs eternal praise.

Psalms 112

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! Blessed man, blessed woman, who fear GOD, Who cherish and relish his commandments,
- 1 Praise the LORD. Blessed is the man who fears the LORD, who finds great delight in his commands.
- 2 Their children robust on the earth, And the homes of the upright--how blessed!
- 2 His children will be mighty in the land; the generation of the upright will be blessed.
- 3 Their houses brim with wealth And a generosity that never runs dry.
- 3 Wealth and riches are in his house, and his righteousness endures forever.
- 4 Sunrise breaks through the darkness for good people-- God's grace and mercy and justice!
- 4 Even in darkness light dawns for the upright, for the gracious and compassionate and righteous man.
- 5 The good person is generous and lends lavishly;
- 5 Good will come to him who is generous and lends freely, who conducts his affairs with justice.
- 6 No shuffling or stumbling around for this one, But a sterling and solid and lasting reputation.
- 6 Surely he will never be shaken; a righteous man will be remembered forever.
- 7 Unfazed by rumor and gossip, Heart ready, trusting in GOD,
- 7 He will have no fear of bad news; his heart is steadfast, trusting in the LORD.
- 8 Spirit firm, unperturbed, Ever blessed, relaxed among enemies,
- 8 His heart is secure, he will have no fear; in the end he will look in triumph on his foes.
- 9 They lavish gifts on the poor-- A generosity that goes on, and on, and on. An honored life! A beautiful life!
- 9 He has scattered abroad his gifts to the poor, his righteousness endures forever; his horn will be lifted high in honor.

- 10 Someone wicked takes one look and rages, Blusters away but ends up speechless. There's nothing to the dreams of the wicked. Nothing.
- 10 The wicked man will see and be vexed, he will gnash his teeth and waste away; the longings of the wicked will come to nothing.

Psalms 113

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! You who serve GOD, praise GOD! Just to speak his name is praise!
- 1 Praise the LORD. Praise, O servants of the LORD, praise the name of the LORD.
- 2 Just to remember GOD is a blessing-- now and tomorrow and always.
- 2 Let the name of the LORD be praised, both now and forevermore.
- 3 From east to west, from dawn to dusk, keep lifting all your praises to GOD!
- 3 From the rising of the sun to the place where it sets, the name of the LORD is to be praised.
- 4 GOD is higher than anything and anyone, outshining everything you can see in the skies.
- 4 The LORD is exalted over all the nations, his glory above the heavens.
- 5 Who can compare with GOD, our God, so majestically enthroned,
- 5 Who is like the LORD our God, the One who sits enthroned on high,
- 6 Surveying his magnificent heavens and earth?
- 6 who stoops down to look on the heavens and the earth?
- 7 He picks up the poor from out of the dirt, rescues the wretched who've been thrown out with the trash,
- 7 He raises the poor from the dust and lifts the needy from the ash heap;
- 8 Seats them among the honored guests, a place of honor among the brightest and best.
- 8 he seats them with princes, with the princes of their people.
- 9 He gives childless couples a family, gives them joy as the parents of children. Hallelujah!
- 9 He settles the barren woman in her home as a happy mother of children. Praise the LORD.

Psalms 114

MSG

NIV

- 1 After Israel left Egypt, the clan of Jacob left those barbarians behind;
- 1 When Israel came out of Egypt, the house of Jacob from a people of foreign tongue,
- 2 Judah became holy land for him, Israel the place of holy rule.
- 2 Judah became God's sanctuary, Israel his dominion.
- 3 Sea took one look and ran the other way; River Jordan turned around and ran off.
- 3 The sea looked and fled, the Jordan turned back;
- 4 The mountains turned playful and skipped like rams, the hills frolicked like spring lambs.
- 4 the mountains skipped like rams, the hills like lambs.
- 5 What's wrong with you, Sea, that you ran away? and you, River Jordan, that you turned and ran off?
- 5 Why was it, O sea, that you fled, O Jordan, that you turned back,
- 6 And mountains, why did you skip like rams? and you, hills, frolic like spring lambs?
- 6 you mountains, that you skipped like rams, you hills, like lambs?
- 7 Tremble, Earth! You're in the Lord's presence! in the presence of Jacob's God.
- 7 Tremble, O earth, at the presence of the Lord, at the presence of the God of Jacob,
- 8 He turned the rock into a pool of cool water, turned flint into fresh spring water.
- 8 who turned the rock into a pool, the hard rock into springs of water.

Psalms 115

MSG

NIV

- 1 Not for our sake, GOD, no, not for our sake, but for your name's sake, show your glory. Do it on account of your merciful love, do it on account

of your faithful ways.

- 1 Not to us, O LORD, not to us but to your name be the glory, because of your love and faithfulness.
- 2 Do it so none of the nations can say, "Where now, oh where is their God?"
- 2 Why do the nations say, "Where is their God?"
- 3 Our God is in heaven doing whatever he wants to do.
- 3 Our God is in heaven; he does whatever pleases him.
- 4 Their gods are metal and wood, handmade in a basement shop:
- 4 But their idols are silver and gold, made by the hands of men.
- 5 Carved mouths that can't talk, painted eyes that can't see,
- 5 They have mouths, but cannot speak, eyes, but they cannot see;
- 6 Tin ears that can't hear, molded noses that can't smell,
- 6 they have ears, but cannot hear, noses, but they cannot smell;
- 7 Hands that can't grasp, feet that can't walk or run, throats that never utter a sound.
- 7 they have hands, but cannot feel, feet, but they cannot walk; nor can they utter a sound with their throats.
- 8 Those who make them have become just like them, have become just like the gods they trust.
- 8 Those who make them will be like them, and so will all who trust in them.
- 9 But you, Israel: put your trust in GOD! --trust your Helper! trust your Ruler!
- 9 O house of Israel, trust in the LORD-- he is their help and shield.
- 10 Clan of Aaron, trust in GOD! --trust your Helper! trust your Ruler!
- 10 O house of Aaron, trust in the LORD-- he is their help and shield.
- 11 You who fear GOD, trust in GOD! --trust your Helper! trust your Ruler!
- 11 You who fear him, trust in the LORD-- he is their help and shield.
- 12 O GOD, remember us and bless us, bless the families of Israel and Aaron.
- 12 The LORD remembers us and will bless us: He will bless the house of Israel, he will bless the house of Aaron,
- 13 And let GOD bless all who fear GOD-- bless the small, bless the great.
- 13 he will bless those who fear the LORD-- small and great alike.

- 14 Oh, let GOD enlarge your families-- giving growth to you, growth to your children.
- 14 May the LORD make you increase, both you and your children.
- 15 May you be blessed by GOD, by GOD, who made heaven and earth.
- 15 May you be blessed by the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth.
- 16 The heaven of heavens is for GOD, but he put us in charge of the earth.
- 16 The highest heavens belong to the LORD, but the earth he has given to man.
- 17 Dead people can't praise GOD-- not a word to be heard from those buried in the ground.
- 17 It is not the dead who praise the LORD, those who go down to silence;
- 18 But we bless GOD, oh yes-- we bless him now, we bless him always! Hallelujah!
- 18 it is we who extol the LORD, both now and forevermore. Praise the LORD.

Psalms 116

MSG

NIV

- 1 I love GOD because he listened to me, listened as I begged for mercy.
- 1 I love the LORD, for he heard my voice; he heard my cry for mercy.
- 2 He listened so intently as I laid out my case before him.
- 2 Because he turned his ear to me, I will call on him as long as I live.
- 3 Death stared me in the face, hell was hard on my heels. Up against it, I didn't know which way to turn;
- 3 The cords of death entangled me, the anguish of the grave came upon me; I was overcome by trouble and sorrow.
- 4 then I called out to GOD for help: "Please, GOD!" I cried out. "Save my life!"
- 4 Then I called on the name of the LORD: "O LORD, save me!"
- 5 GOD is gracious--it is he who makes things right, our most compassionate God.
- 5 The LORD is gracious and righteous; our God is full of compassion.
- 6 GOD takes the side of the helpless; when I was at the end of my rope, he saved me.

6 The LORD protects the simplehearted; when I was in great need, he saved me.

7 I said to myself, "Relax and rest. GOD has showered you with blessings.

7 Be at rest once more, O my soul, for the LORD has been good to you.

8 Soul, you've been rescued from death; Eye, you've been rescued from tears; And you, Foot, were kept from stumbling."

8 For you, O LORD, have delivered my soul from death, my eyes from tears, my feet from stumbling,

9 I'm striding in the presence of GOD, alive in the land of the living!

9 that I may walk before the LORD in the land of the living.

10 I stayed faithful, though bedeviled, and despite a ton of bad luck,

10 I believed; therefore I said, "I am greatly afflicted."

11 Despite giving up on the human race, saying, "They're all liars and cheats."

11 And in my dismay I said, "All men are liars."

12 What can I give back to GOD for the blessings he's poured out on me?

12 How can I repay the LORD for all his goodness to me?

13 I'll lift high the cup of salvation--a toast to GOD! I'll pray in the name of GOD;

13 I will lift up the cup of salvation and call on the name of the LORD.

14 I'll complete what I promised GOD I'd do, and I'll do it together with his people.

14 I will fulfill my vows to the LORD in the presence of all his people.

15 When they arrive at the gates of death, GOD welcomes those who love him.

15 Precious in the sight of the LORD is the death of his saints.

16 Oh, GOD, here I am, your servant, your faithful servant: set me free for your service!

16 O LORD, truly I am your servant; I am your servant, the son of your maidservant; you have freed me from my chains.

17 I'm ready to offer the thanksgiving sacrifice and pray in the name of GOD.

17 I will sacrifice a thank offering to you and call on the name of the LORD.

18 I'll complete what I promised GOD I'd do, and I'll do it in company with his people,

- 18 I will fulfill my vows to the LORD in the presence of all his people,
19 In the place of worship, in GOD's house, in Jerusalem, GOD's city.
Hallelujah!
19 in the courts of the house of the LORD-- in your midst, O Jerusalem.
Praise the LORD.

Psalms 117

MSG

NIV

- 1 Praise GOD, everybody! Applaud GOD, all people!
1 Praise the LORD, all you nations; extol him, all you peoples.
2 His love has taken over our lives; GOD's faithful ways are eternal.
Hallelujah!
2 For great is his love toward us, and the faithfulness of the LORD endures forever. Praise the LORD.

Psalms 118

MSG

NIV

- 1 Thank GOD because he's good, because his love never quits.
1 Give thanks to the LORD, for he is good; his love endures forever.
2 Tell the world, Israel, "His love never quits."
2 Let Israel say: "His love endures forever."
3 And you, clan of Aaron, tell the world, "His love never quits."
3 Let the house of Aaron say: "His love endures forever."
4 And you who fear GOD, join in, "His love never quits."
4 Let those who fear the LORD say: "His love endures forever."
5 Pushed to the wall, I called to GOD; from the wide open spaces, he answered.
5 In my anguish I cried to the LORD, and he answered by setting me free.
6 GOD's now at my side and I'm not afraid; who would dare lay a hand on me?
6 The LORD is with me; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?
7 GOD's my strong champion; I flick off my enemies like flies.

- 7 The LORD is with me; he is my helper. I will look in triumph on my enemies.
- 8 Far better to take refuge in GOD than trust in people;
- 8 It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man.
- 9 Far better to take refuge in GOD than trust in celebrities.
- 9 It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in princes.
- 10 Hemmed in by barbarians, in GOD's name I rubbed their faces in the dirt;
- 10 All the nations surrounded me, but in the name of the LORD I cut them off.
- 11 Hemmed in and with no way out, in GOD's name I rubbed their faces in the dirt;
- 11 They surrounded me on every side, but in the name of the LORD I cut them off.
- 12 Like swarming bees, like wild prairie fire, they hemmed me in; in GOD's name I rubbed their faces in the dirt.
- 12 They swarmed around me like bees, but they died out as quickly as burning thorns; in the name of the LORD I cut them off.
- 13 I was right on the cliff-edge, ready to fall, when GOD grabbed and held me.
- 13 I was pushed back and about to fall, but the LORD helped me.
- 14 GOD's my strength, he's also my song, and now he's my salvation.
- 14 The LORD is my strength and my song; he has become my salvation.
- 15 Hear the shouts, hear the triumph songs in the camp of the saved? "The hand of GOD has turned the tide!
- 15 Shouts of joy and victory resound in the tents of the righteous: "The LORD's right hand has done mighty things!
- 16 The hand of GOD is raised in victory! The hand of GOD has turned the tide!"
- 16 The LORD's right hand is lifted high; the LORD's right hand has done mighty things!"
- 17 I didn't die. I lived! And now I'm telling the world what GOD did.
- 17 I will not die but live, and will proclaim what the LORD has done.
- 18 GOD tested me, he pushed me hard, but he didn't hand me over to Death.

18 The LORD has chastened me severely, but he has not given me over to death.
19 Swing wide the city gates--the righteous gates! I'll walk right through and thank GOD!
19 Open for me the gates of righteousness; I will enter and give thanks to the LORD.
20 This Temple Gate belongs to GOD, so the victors can enter and praise.
20 This is the gate of the LORD through which the righteous may enter.
21 Thank you for responding to me; you've truly become my salvation!
21 I will give you thanks, for you answered me; you have become my salvation.
22 The stone the masons discarded as flawed is now the capstone!
22 The stone the builders rejected has become the capstone;
23 This is GOD's work. We rub our eyes--we can hardly believe it!
23 the LORD has done this, and it is marvelous in our eyes.
24 This is the very day GOD acted-- let's celebrate and be festive!
24 This is the day the LORD has made; let us rejoice and be glad in it.
25 Salvation now, GOD. Salvation now! Oh yes, GOD--a free and full life!
25 O LORD, save us; O LORD, grant us success.
26 Blessed are you who enter in GOD's name-- from GOD's house we bless you!
26 Blessed is he who comes in the name of the LORD. From the house of the LORD we bless you.
27 GOD is God, he has bathed us in light. Festoon the shrine with garlands, hang colored banners above the altar!
27 The LORD is God, and he has made his light shine upon us. With boughs in hand, join in the festal procession up to the horns of the altar.
28 You're my God, and I thank you. O my God, I lift high your praise.
28 You are my God, and I will give you thanks; you are my God, and I will exalt you.
29 Thank GOD--he's so good. His love never quits!
29 Give thanks to the LORD, for he is good; his love endures forever.

Psalms 119

MSG

NIV

- 1 You're blessed when you stay on course, walking steadily on the road revealed by GOD.
- 1 Aleph Blessed are they whose ways are blameless, who walk according to the law of the LORD.
- 2 You're blessed when you follow his directions, doing your best to find him.
- 2 Blessed are they who keep his statutes and seek him with all their heart.
- 3 That's right--you don't go off on your own; you walk straight along the road he set.
- 3 They do nothing wrong; they walk in his ways.
- 4 You, GOD, prescribed the right way to live; now you expect us to live it.
- 4 You have laid down precepts that are to be fully obeyed.
- 5 Oh, that my steps might be steady, keeping to the course you set;
- 5 Oh, that my ways were steadfast in obeying your decrees!
- 6 Then I'd never have any regrets in comparing my life with your counsel.
- 6 Then I would not be put to shame when I consider all your commands.
- 7 I thank you for speaking straight from your heart; I learn the pattern of your righteous ways.
- 7 I will praise you with an upright heart as I learn your righteous laws.
- 8 I'm going to do what you tell me to do; don't ever walk off and leave me.
- 8 I will obey your decrees; do not utterly forsake me.
- 9 How can a young person live a clean life? By carefully reading the map of your Word.
- 9 Beth How can a young man keep his way pure? By living according to your word.
- 10 I'm single-minded in pursuit of you; don't let me miss the road signs you've posted.
- 10 I seek you with all my heart; do not let me stray from your commands.
- 11 I've banked your promises in the vault of my heart so I won't sin myself bankrupt.
- 11 I have hidden your word in my heart that I might not sin against you.
- 12 Be blessed, GOD; train me in your ways of wise living.
- 12 Praise be to you, O LORD; teach me your decrees.
- 13 I'll transfer to my lips all the counsel that comes from your mouth;
- 13 With my lips I recount all the laws that come from your mouth.

14 I delight far more in what you tell me about living than in gathering a pile of riches.

14 I rejoice in following your statutes as one rejoices in great riches.

15 I ponder every morsel of wisdom from you, I attentively watch how you've done it.

15 I meditate on your precepts and consider your ways.

16 I relish everything you've told me of life, I won't forget a word of it.

16 I delight in your decrees; I will not neglect your word.

17 Be generous with me and I'll live a full life; not for a minute will I take my eyes off your road.

17 Gimel Do good to your servant, and I will live; I will obey your word.

18 Open my eyes so I can see what you show me of your miracle-wonders.

18 Open my eyes that I may see wonderful things in your law.

19 I'm a stranger in these parts; give me clear directions.

19 I am a stranger on earth; do not hide your commands from me.

20 My soul is starved and hungry, ravenous!-- insatiable for your nourishing commands.

20 My soul is consumed with longing for your laws at all times.

21 And those who think they know so much, ignoring everything you tell them--let them have it!

21 You rebuke the arrogant, who are cursed and who stray from your commands.

22 Don't let them mock and humiliate me; I've been careful to do just what you said.

22 Remove from me scorn and contempt, for I keep your statutes.

23 While bad neighbors maliciously gossip about me, I'm absorbed in pondering your wise counsel.

23 Though rulers sit together and slander me, your servant will meditate on your decrees.

24 Yes, your sayings on life are what give me delight; I listen to them as to good neighbors!

24 Your statutes are my delight; they are my counselors.

25 I'm feeling terrible--I couldn't feel worse! Get me on my feet again. You promised, remember?

25 Daleth I am laid low in the dust; preserve my life according to your word.

26 When I told my story, you responded; train me well in your deep wisdom.

26 I recounted my ways and you answered me; teach me your decrees.

27 Help me understand these things inside and out so I can ponder your miracle-wonders.

27 Let me understand the teaching of your precepts; then I will meditate on your wonders.

28 My sad life's dilapidated, a falling-down barn; build me up again by your Word.

28 My soul is weary with sorrow; strengthen me according to your word.

29 Barricade the road that goes Nowhere; grace me with your clear revelation.

29 Keep me from deceitful ways; be gracious to me through your law.

30 I choose the true road to Somewhere, I post your road signs at every curve and corner.

30 I have chosen the way of truth; I have set my heart on your laws.

31 I grasp and cling to whatever you tell me; GOD, don't let me down!

31 I hold fast to your statutes, O LORD; do not let me be put to shame.

32 I'll run the course you lay out for me if you'll just show me how.

32 I run in the path of your commands, for you have set my heart free.

33 GOD, teach me lessons for living so I can stay the course.

33 He Teach me, O LORD, to follow your decrees; then I will keep them to the end.

34 Give me insight so I can do what you tell me-- my whole life one long, obedient response.

34 Give me understanding, and I will keep your law and obey it with all my heart.

35 Guide me down the road of your commandments; I love traveling this freeway!

35 Direct me in the path of your commands, for there I find delight.

36 Give me a bent for your words of wisdom, and not for piling up loot.

36 Turn my heart toward your statutes and not toward selfish gain.

37 Divert my eyes from toys and trinkets, invigorate me on the pilgrim way.

37 Turn my eyes away from worthless things; preserve my life according to your word.

38 Affirm your promises to me-- promises made to all who fear you.
38 Fulfill your promise to your servant, so that you may be feared.
39 Deflect the harsh words of my critics-- but what you say is always so good.
39 Take away the disgrace I dread, for your laws are good.
40 See how hungry I am for your counsel; preserve my life through your righteous ways!
40 How I long for your precepts! Preserve my life in your righteousness.
41 Let your love, GOD, shape my life with salvation, exactly as you promised;
41 Waw May your unfailing love come to me, O LORD, your salvation according to your promise;
42 Then I'll be able to stand up to mockery because I trusted your Word.
42 then I will answer the one who taunts me, for I trust in your word.
43 Don't ever deprive me of truth, not ever-- your commandments are what I depend on.
43 Do not snatch the word of truth from my mouth, for I have put my hope in your laws.
44 Oh, I'll guard with my life what you've revealed to me, guard it now, guard it ever;
44 I will always obey your law, for ever and ever.
45 And I'll stride freely through wide open spaces as I look for your truth and your wisdom;
45 I will walk about in freedom, for I have sought out your precepts.
46 Then I'll tell the world what I find, speak out boldly in public, unembarrassed.
46 I will speak of your statutes before kings and will not be put to shame,
47 I cherish your commandments--oh, how I love them!--
47 for I delight in your commands because I love them.
48 relishing every fragment of your counsel.
48 I lift up my hands to your commands, which I love, and I meditate on your decrees.
49 Remember what you said to me, your servant-- I hang on to these words for dear life!
49 Zayin Remember your word to your servant, for you have given me hope.

50 These words hold me up in bad times; yes, your promises rejuvenate me.

50 My comfort in my suffering is this: Your promise preserves my life.

51 The insolent ridicule me without mercy, but I don't budge from your revelation.

51 The arrogant mock me without restraint, but I do not turn from your law.

52 I watch for your ancient landmark words, and know I'm on the right track.

52 I remember your ancient laws, O LORD, and I find comfort in them.

53 But when I see the wicked ignore your directions, I'm beside myself with anger.

53 Indignation grips me because of the wicked, who have forsaken your law.

54 I set your instructions to music and sing them as I walk this pilgrim way.

54 Your decrees are the theme of my song wherever I lodge.

55 I meditate on your name all night, GOD, treasuring your revelation, O GOD.

55 In the night I remember your name, O LORD, and I will keep your law.

56 Still, I walk through a rain of derision because I live by your Word and counsel.

56 This has been my practice: I obey your precepts.

57 Because you have satisfied me, GOD, I promise to do everything you say.

57 Heth You are my portion, O LORD; I have promised to obey your words.

58 I beg you from the bottom of my heart: smile, be gracious to me just as you promised.

58 I have sought your face with all my heart; be gracious to me according to your promise.

59 When I took a long, careful look at your ways, I got my feet back on the trail you blazed.

59 I have considered my ways and have turned my steps to your statutes.

60 I was up at once, didn't drag my feet, was quick to follow your orders.

60 I will hasten and not delay to obey your commands.

61 The wicked hemmed me in--there was no way out-- but not for a minute did I forget your plan for me.

61 Though the wicked bind me with ropes, I will not forget your law.

62 I get up in the middle of the night to thank you; your decisions are so right, so true--I can't wait till morning!

62 At midnight I rise to give you thanks for your righteous laws.

63 I'm a friend and companion of all who fear you, of those committed to living by your rules.

63 I am a friend to all who fear you, to all who follow your precepts.

64 Your love, GOD, fills the earth! Train me to live by your counsel.

64 The earth is filled with your love, O LORD; teach me your decrees.

65 Be good to your servant, GOD; be as good as your Word.

65 Teth Do good to your servant according to your word, O LORD.

66 Train me in good common sense; I'm thoroughly committed to living your way.

66 Teach me knowledge and good judgment, for I believe in your commands.

67 Before I learned to answer you, I wandered all over the place, but now I'm in step with your Word.

67 Before I was afflicted I went astray, but now I obey your word.

68 You are good, and the source of good; train me in your goodness.

68 You are good, and what you do is good; teach me your decrees.

69 The godless spread lies about me, but I focus my attention on what you are saying;

69 Though the arrogant have smeared me with lies, I keep your precepts with all my heart.

70 They're bland as a bucket of lard, while I dance to the tune of your revelation.

70 Their hearts are callous and unfeeling, but I delight in your law.

71 My troubles turned out all for the best-- they forced me to learn from your textbook.

71 It was good for me to be afflicted so that I might learn your decrees.

72 Truth from your mouth means more to me than striking it rich in a gold mine.

72 The law from your mouth is more precious to me than thousands of pieces of silver and gold.

73 With your very own hands you formed me; now breathe your wisdom over me so I can understand you.

73 Yodh Your hands made me and formed me; give me understanding to learn your commands.

74 When they see me waiting, expecting your Word, those who fear you will take heart and be glad.

74 May those who fear you rejoice when they see me, for I have put my hope in your word.

75 I can see now, GOD, that your decisions are right; your testing has taught me what's true and right.

75 I know, O LORD, that your laws are righteous, and in faithfulness you have afflicted me.

76 Oh, love me--and right now!--hold me tight! just the way you promised.

76 May your unfailing love be my comfort, according to your promise to your servant.

77 Now comfort me so I can live, really live; your revelation is the tune I dance to.

77 Let your compassion come to me that I may live, for your law is my delight.

78 Let the fast-talking tricksters be exposed as frauds; they tried to sell me a bill of goods, but I kept my mind fixed on your counsel.

78 May the arrogant be put to shame for wronging me without cause; but I will meditate on your precepts.

79 Let those who fear you turn to me for evidence of your wise guidance.

79 May those who fear you turn to me, those who understand your statutes.

80 And let me live whole and holy, soul and body, so I can always walk with my head held high.

80 May my heart be blameless toward your decrees, that I may not be put to shame.

81 I'm homesick--longing for your salvation; I'm waiting for your word of hope.

81 Kaph My soul faints with longing for your salvation, but I have put my hope in your word.

82 My eyes grow heavy watching for some sign of your promise; how long must I wait for your comfort?

82 My eyes fail, looking for your promise; I say, "When will you comfort me?"

83 There's smoke in my eyes--they burn and water, but I keep a steady gaze on the instructions you post.

83 Though I am like a wineskin in the smoke, I do not forget your decrees.

84 How long do I have to put up with all this? How long till you haul my tormentors into court?

84 How long must your servant wait? When will you punish my persecutors?

85 The arrogant godless try to throw me off track, ignorant as they are of God and his ways.

85 The arrogant dig pitfalls for me, contrary to your law.

86 Everything you command is a sure thing, but they harass me with lies. Help!

86 All your commands are trustworthy; help me, for men persecute me without cause.

87 They've pushed and pushed--they never let up-- but I haven't relaxed my grip on your counsel.

87 They almost wiped me from the earth, but I have not forsaken your precepts.

88 In your great love revive me so I can alertly obey your every word.

88 Preserve my life according to your love, and I will obey the statutes of your mouth.

89 What you say goes, GOD, and stays, as permanent as the heavens.

89 Lamedh Your word, O LORD, is eternal; it stands firm in the heavens.

90 Your truth never goes out of fashion; it's as up-to-date as the earth when the sun comes up.

90 Your faithfulness continues through all generations; you established the earth, and it endures.

91 Your Word and truth are dependable as ever; that's what you ordered--you set the earth going.

91 Your laws endure to this day, for all things serve you.

92 If your revelation hadn't delighted me so, I would have given up when the hard times came.

92 If your law had not been my delight, I would have perished in my affliction.

93 But I'll never forget the advice you gave me; you saved my life with those wise words.

93 I will never forget your precepts, for by them you have preserved my life.

94 Save me! I'm all yours. I look high and low for your words of wisdom.

94 Save me, for I am yours; I have sought out your precepts.

95 The wicked lie in ambush to destroy me, but I'm only concerned with your plans for me.

95 The wicked are waiting to destroy me, but I will ponder your statutes.

96 I see the limits to everything human, but the horizons can't contain your commands!

96 To all perfection I see a limit; but your commands are boundless.

97 Oh, how I love all you've revealed; I reverently ponder it all the day long.

97 Mem Oh, how I love your law! I meditate on it all day long.

98 Your commands give me an edge on my enemies; they never become obsolete.

98 Your commands make me wiser than my enemies, for they are ever with me.

99 I've even become smarter than my teachers since I've pondered and absorbed your counsel.

99 I have more insight than all my teachers, for I meditate on your statutes.

100 I've become wiser than the wise old sages simply by doing what you tell me.

100 I have more understanding than the elders, for I obey your precepts.

101 I watch my step, avoiding the ditches and ruts of evil so I can spend all my time keeping your Word.

101 I have kept my feet from every evil path so that I might obey your word.

102 I never make detours from the route you laid out; you gave me such good directions.

102 I have not departed from your laws, for you yourself have taught me.

103 Your words are so choice, so tasty; I prefer them to the best home cooking.

103 How sweet are your words to my taste, sweeter than honey to my mouth!

104 With your instruction, I understand life; that's why I hate false propaganda.

104 I gain understanding from your precepts; therefore I hate every wrong path.

105 By your words I can see where I'm going; they throw a beam of light on my dark path.

105 Nun Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light for my path.

106 I've committed myself and I'll never turn back from living by your righteous order.

106 I have taken an oath and confirmed it, that I will follow your righteous laws.

107 Everything's falling apart on me, GOD; put me together again with your Word.

107 I have suffered much; preserve my life, O LORD, according to your word.

108 Festoon me with your finest sayings, GOD; teach me your holy rules.

108 Accept, O LORD, the willing praise of my mouth, and teach me your laws.

109 My life is as close as my own hands, but I don't forget what you have revealed.

109 Though I constantly take my life in my hands, I will not forget your law.

110 The wicked do their best to throw me off track, but I don't swerve an inch from your course.

110 The wicked have set a snare for me, but I have not strayed from your precepts.

111 I inherited your book on living; it's mine forever-- what a gift! And how happy it makes me!

111 Your statutes are my heritage forever; they are the joy of my heart.

112 I concentrate on doing exactly what you say-- I always have and always will.

112 My heart is set on keeping your decrees to the very end.

113 I hate the two-faced, but I love your clear-cut revelation.

113 Samekh I hate double-minded men, but I love your law.

114 You're my place of quiet retreat; I wait for your Word to renew me.

114 You are my refuge and my shield; I have put my hope in your word.

115 Get out of my life, evildoers, so I can keep my God's commands.
115 Away from me, you evildoers, that I may keep the commands of my God!
116 Take my side as you promised; I'll live then for sure. Don't disappoint all my grand hopes.
116 Sustain me according to your promise, and I will live; do not let my hopes be dashed.
117 Stick with me and I'll be all right; I'll give total allegiance to your definitions of life.
117 Uphold me, and I will be delivered; I will always have regard for your decrees.
118 Expose all who drift away from your sayings; their casual idolatry is lethal.
118 You reject all who stray from your decrees, for their deceitfulness is in vain.
119 You reject earth's wicked as so much rubbish; therefore I lovingly embrace everything you say.
119 All the wicked of the earth you discard like dross; therefore I love your statutes.
120 I shiver in awe before you; your decisions leave me speechless with reverence.
120 My flesh trembles in fear of you; I stand in awe of your laws.
121 I stood up for justice and the right; don't leave me to the mercy of my oppressors.
121 Ayin I have done what is righteous and just; do not leave me to my oppressors.
122 Take the side of your servant, good God; don't let the godless take advantage of me.
122 Ensure your servant's well-being; let not the arrogant oppress me.
123 I can't keep my eyes open any longer, waiting for you to keep your promise to set everything right.
123 My eyes fail, looking for your salvation, looking for your righteous promise.
124 Let your love dictate how you deal with me; teach me from your textbook on life.

124 Deal with your servant according to your love and teach me your decrees.

125 I'm your servant--help me understand what that means, the inner meaning of your instructions.

125 I am your servant; give me discernment that I may understand your statutes.

126 It's time to act, GOD; they've made a shambles of your revelation!

126 It is time for you to act, O LORD; your law is being broken.

127 Yea-Saying God, I love what you command, I love it better than gold and gemstones;

127 Because I love your commands more than gold, more than pure gold,

128 Yea-Saying God, I honor everything you tell me, I despise every deceitful detour. W

128 and because I consider all your precepts right, I hate every wrong path.

129 Every word you give me is a miracle word-- how could I help but obey?

129 Pe Your statutes are wonderful; therefore I obey them.

130 Break open your words, let the light shine out, let ordinary people see the meaning.

130 The unfolding of your words gives light; it gives understanding to the simple.

131 Mouth open and panting, I wanted your commands more than anything.

131 I open my mouth and pant, longing for your commands.

132 Turn my way, look kindly on me, as you always do to those who personally love you.

132 Turn to me and have mercy on me, as you always do to those who love your name.

133 Steady my steps with your Word of promise so nothing malign gets the better of me.

133 Direct my footsteps according to your word; let no sin rule over me.

134 Rescue me from the grip of bad men and women so I can live life your way.

134 Redeem me from the oppression of men, that I may obey your precepts.

135 Smile on me, your servant; teach me the right way to live.

135 Make your face shine upon your servant and teach me your decrees.
136 I cry rivers of tears because nobody's living by your book!
136 Streams of tears flow from my eyes, for your law is not obeyed.
137 You are right and you do right, GOD; your decisions are right on target.
137 Tsadhe Righteous are you, O LORD, and your laws are right.
138 You rightly instruct us in how to live ever faithful to you.
138 The statutes you have laid down are righteous; they are fully trustworthy.
139 My rivals nearly did me in, they persistently ignored your commandments.
139 My zeal wears me out, for my enemies ignore your words.
140 Your promise has been tested through and through, and I, your servant, love it dearly.
140 Your promises have been thoroughly tested, and your servant loves them.
141 I'm too young to be important, but I don't forget what you tell me.
141 Though I am lowly and despised, I do not forget your precepts.
142 Your righteousness is eternally right, your revelation is the only truth.
142 Your righteousness is everlasting and your law is true.
143 Even though troubles came down on me hard, your commands always gave me delight.
143 Trouble and distress have come upon me, but your commands are my delight.
144 The way you tell me to live is always right; help me understand it so I can live to the fullest.
144 Your statutes are forever right; give me understanding that I may live.
145 I call out at the top of my lungs, "GOD! Answer! I'll do whatever you say."
145 Qoph I call with all my heart; answer me, O LORD, and I will obey your decrees.
146 I called to you, "Save me so I can carry out all your instructions."
146 I call out to you; save me and I will keep your statutes.
147 I was up before sunrise, crying for help, hoping for a word from you.
147 I rise before dawn and cry for help; I have put my hope in your word.
148 I stayed awake all night, prayerfully pondering your promise.

148 My eyes stay open through the watches of the night, that I may meditate on your promises.

149 In your love, listen to me; in your justice, GOD, keep me alive.

149 Hear my voice in accordance with your love; preserve my life, O LORD, according to your laws.

150 As those out to get me come closer and closer, they go farther and farther from the truth you reveal;

150 Those who devise wicked schemes are near, but they are far from your law.

151 But you're the closest of all to me, GOD, and all your judgments true.

151 Yet you are near, O LORD, and all your commands are true.

152 I've known all along from the evidence of your words that you meant them to last forever.

152 Long ago I learned from your statutes that you established them to last forever.

153 Take a good look at my trouble, and help me-- I haven't forgotten your revelation.

153 Resh Look upon my suffering and deliver me, for I have not forgotten your law.

154 Take my side and get me out of this; give me back my life, just as you promised.

154 Defend my cause and redeem me; preserve my life according to your promise.

155 "Salvation" is only gibberish to the wicked because they've never looked it up in your dictionary.

155 Salvation is far from the wicked, for they do not seek out your decrees.

156 Your mercies, GOD, run into the billions; following your guidelines, revive me.

156 Your compassion is great, O LORD; preserve my life according to your laws.

157 My antagonists are too many to count, but I don't swerve from the directions you gave.

157 Many are the foes who persecute me, but I have not turned from your statutes.

158 I took one look at the quitters and was filled with loathing; they walked away from your promises so casually!

158 I look on the faithless with loathing, for they do not obey your word.
159 Take note of how I love what you tell me; out of your life of love,
prolong my life.
159 See how I love your precepts; preserve my life, O LORD, according to
your love.
160 Your words all add up to the sum total: Truth. Your righteous decisions
are eternal.
160 All your words are true; all your righteous laws are eternal.
161 I've been slandered unmercifully by the politicians, but my awe at your
words keeps me stable.
161 Sin and Shin Rulers persecute me without cause, but my heart trembles
at your word.
162 I'm ecstatic over what you say, like one who strikes it rich.
162 I rejoice in your promise like one who finds great spoil.
163 I hate lies--can't stand them!-- but I love what you have revealed.
163 I hate and abhor falsehood but I love your law.
164 Seven times each day I stop and shout praises for the way you keep
everything running right.
164 Seven times a day I praise you for your righteous laws.
165 For those who love what you reveal, everything fits-- no stumbling
around in the dark for them.
165 Great peace have they who love your law, and nothing can make them
stumble.
166 I wait expectantly for your salvation; GOD, I do what you tell me.
166 I wait for your salvation, O LORD, and I follow your commands.
167 My soul guards and keeps all your instructions-- oh, how much I love
them!
167 I obey your statutes, for I love them greatly.
168 I follow your directions, abide by your counsel; my life's an open book
before you.
168 I obey your precepts and your statutes, for all my ways are known to
you.
169 Let my cry come right into your presence, GOD; provide me with the
insight that comes only from your Word.
169 Taw May my cry come before you, O LORD; give me understanding
according to your word.

170 Give my request your personal attention, rescue me on the terms of your promise.
170 May my supplication come before you; deliver me according to your promise.
171 Let praise cascade off my lips; after all, you've taught me the truth about life!
171 May my lips overflow with praise, for you teach me your decrees.
172 And let your promises ring from my tongue; every order you've given is right.
172 May my tongue sing of your word, for all your commands are righteous.
173 Put your hand out and steady me since I've chosen to live by your counsel.
173 May your hand be ready to help me, for I have chosen your precepts.
174 I'm homesick, GOD, for your salvation; I love it when you show yourself!
174 I long for your salvation, O LORD, and your law is my delight.
175 Invigorate my soul so I can praise you well, use your decrees to put iron in my soul.
175 Let me live that I may praise you, and may your laws sustain me.
176 And should I wander off like a lost sheep--seek me! I'll recognize the sound of your voice.
176 I have strayed like a lost sheep. Seek your servant, for I have not forgotten your commands.

Psalms 120

MSG

NIV

1 A pilgrim song. I'm in trouble. I cry to GOD, desperate for an answer:
1 A song of ascents. I call on the LORD in my distress, and he answers me.
2 "Deliver me from the liars, GOD! They smile so sweetly but lie through their teeth."
2 Save me, O LORD, from lying lips and from deceitful tongues.
3 Do you know what's next, can you see what's coming, all you barefaced liars?

- 3 What will he do to you, and what more besides, O deceitful tongue?
- 4 Pointed arrows and burning coals will be your reward.
- 4 He will punish you with a warrior's sharp arrows, with burning coals of the broom tree.
- 5 I'm doomed to live in Meshech, cursed with a home in Kedar,
- 5 Woe to me that I dwell in Meshech, that I live among the tents of Kedar!
- 6 My whole life lived camping among quarreling neighbors.
- 6 Too long have I lived among those who hate peace.
- 7 I'm all for peace, but the minute I tell them so, they go to war!
- 7 I am a man of peace; but when I speak, they are for war.

Psalms 121

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. I look up to the mountains; does my strength come from mountains?
- 1 A song of ascents. I lift up my eyes to the hills-- where does my help come from?
- 2 No, my strength comes from GOD, who made heaven, and earth, and mountains.
- 2 My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth.
- 3 He won't let you stumble, your Guardian God won't fall asleep.
- 3 He will not let your foot slip-- he who watches over you will not slumber;
- 4 Not on your life! Israel's Guardian will never doze or sleep.
- 4 indeed, he who watches over Israel will neither slumber nor sleep.
- 5 GOD's your Guardian, right at your side to protect you--
- 5 The LORD watches over you-- the LORD is your shade at your right hand;
- 6 Shielding you from sunstroke, sheltering you from moonstroke.
- 6 the sun will not harm you by day, nor the moon by night.
- 7 GOD guards you from every evil, he guards your very life.
- 7 The LORD will keep you from all harm-- he will watch over your life;
- 8 He guards you when you leave and when you return, he guards you now, he guards you always.

8 the LORD will watch over your coming and going both now and forevermore.

Psalms 122

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song of David. When they said, "Let's go to the house of GOD," my heart leaped for joy.
- 1 A song of ascents. Of David. I rejoiced with those who said to me, "Let us go to the house of the LORD."
- 2 And now we're here, O Jerusalem, inside Jerusalem's walls!
- 2 Our feet are standing in your gates, O Jerusalem.
- 3 Jerusalem, well-built city, built as a place for worship!
- 3 Jerusalem is built like a city that is closely compacted together.
- 4 The city to which the tribes ascend, all GOD's tribes go up to worship, To give thanks to the name of GOD-- this is what it means to be Israel.
- 4 That is where the tribes go up, the tribes of the LORD, to praise the name of the LORD according to the statute given to Israel.
- 5 Thrones for righteous judgment are set there, famous David-thrones.
- 5 There the thrones for judgment stand, the thrones of the house of David.
- 6 Pray for Jerusalem's peace! Prosperity to all you Jerusalem-lovers!
- 6 Pray for the peace of Jerusalem: "May those who love you be secure.
- 7 Friendly insiders, get along! Hostile outsiders, keep your distance!
- 7 May there be peace within your walls and security within your citadels."
- 8 For the sake of my family and friends, I say it again: live in peace!
- 8 For the sake of my brothers and friends, I will say, "Peace be within you."
- 9 For the sake of the house of our God, GOD, I'll do my very best for you.
- 9 For the sake of the house of the LORD our God, I will seek your prosperity.

Psalms 123

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. I look to you, heaven-dwelling God, look up to you for help.
- 1 A song of ascents. I lift up my eyes to you, to you whose throne is in heaven.
- 2 Like servants, alert to their master's commands, like a maiden attending her lady, We're watching and waiting, holding our breath, awaiting your word of mercy.
- 2 As the eyes of slaves look to the hand of their master, as the eyes of a maid look to the hand of her mistress, so our eyes look to the LORD our God, till he shows us his mercy.
- 3 Mercy, GOD, mercy! We've been kicked around long enough,
- 3 Have mercy on us, O LORD, have mercy on us, for we have endured much contempt.
- 4 Kicked in the teeth by complacent rich men, kicked when we're down by arrogant brutes.
- 4 We have endured much ridicule from the proud, much contempt from the arrogant.

Psalms 124

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song of David. If GOD hadn't been for us --all together now, Israel, sing out!--
- 1 A song of ascents. Of David. If the LORD had not been on our side-- let Israel say--
- 2 If GOD hadn't been for us when everyone went against us,
- 2 if the LORD had not been on our side when men attacked us,
- 3 We would have been swallowed alive by their violent anger,
- 3 when their anger flared against us, they would have swallowed us alive;
- 4 Swept away by the flood of rage, drowned in the torrent;
- 4 the flood would have engulfed us, the torrent would have swept over us,
- 5 We would have lost our lives in the wild, raging water.
- 5 the raging waters would have swept us away.
- 6 Oh, blessed be GOD! He didn't go off and leave us. He didn't abandon us defenseless, helpless as a rabbit in a pack of snarling dogs.

- 6 Praise be to the LORD, who has not let us be torn by their teeth.
7 We've flown free from their fangs, free of their traps, free as a bird. Their grip is broken; we're free as a bird in flight.
7 We have escaped like a bird out of the fowler's snare; the snare has been broken, and we have escaped.
8 GOD's strong name is our help, the same GOD who made heaven and earth.
8 Our help is in the name of the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth.

Psalms 125

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. Those who trust in GOD are like Zion Mountain: Nothing can move it, a rock-solid mountain you can always depend on.
1 A song of ascents. Those who trust in the LORD are like Mount Zion, which cannot be shaken but endures forever.
2 Mountains encircle Jerusalem, and GOD encircles his people-- always has and always will.
2 As the mountains surround Jerusalem, so the LORD surrounds his people both now and forevermore.
3 The fist of the wicked will never violate What is due the righteous, provoking wrongful violence.
3 The scepter of the wicked will not remain over the land allotted to the righteous, for then the righteous might use their hands to do evil.
4 Be good to your good people, GOD, to those whose hearts are right!
4 Do good, O LORD, to those who are good, to those who are upright in heart.
5 GOD will round up the backsliders, corral them with the incorrigibles. Peace over Israel!
5 But those who turn to crooked ways the LORD will banish with the evildoers. Peace be upon Israel.

Psalms 126

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. It seemed like a dream, too good to be true, when GOD returned Zion's exiles.
- 1 A song of ascents. When the LORD brought back the captives to Zion, we were like men who dreamed.
- 2 We laughed, we sang, we couldn't believe our good fortune. We were the talk of the nations-- "GOD was wonderful to them!"
- 2 Our mouths were filled with laughter, our tongues with songs of joy. Then it was said among the nations, "The LORD has done great things for them."
- 3 GOD was wonderful to us; we are one happy people.
- 3 The LORD has done great things for us, and we are filled with joy.
- 4 And now, GOD, do it again-- bring rains to our drought-stricken lives
- 4 Restore our fortunes, O LORD, like streams in the Negev.
- 5 So those who planted their crops in despair will shout hurrahs at the harvest,
- 5 Those who sow in tears will reap with songs of joy.
- 6 So those who went off with heavy hearts will come home laughing, with armloads of blessing.
- 6 He who goes out weeping, carrying seed to sow, will return with songs of joy, carrying sheaves with him.

Psalms 127

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song of Solomon. If GOD doesn't build the house, the builders only build shacks. If GOD doesn't guard the city, the night watchman might as well nap.
- 1 A song of ascents. Of Solomon. Unless the LORD builds the house, its builders labor in vain. Unless the LORD watches over the city, the watchmen stand guard in vain.
- 2 It's useless to rise early and go to bed late, and work your worried fingers to the bone. Don't you know he enjoys giving rest to those he loves?
- 2 In vain you rise early and stay up late, toiling for food to eat-- for he grants sleep to those he loves.

- 3 Don't you see that children are GOD's best gift? the fruit of the womb his generous legacy?
- 3 Sons are a heritage from the LORD, children a reward from him.
- 4 Like a warrior's fistful of arrows are the children of a vigorous youth.
- 4 Like arrows in the hands of a warrior are sons born in one's youth.
- 5 Oh, how blessed are you parents, with your quivers full of children! Your enemies don't stand a chance against you; you'll sweep them right off your doorstep.
- 5 Blessed is the man whose quiver is full of them. They will not be put to shame when they contend with their enemies in the gate.

Psalms 128

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. All you who fear GOD, how blessed you are! how happily you walk on his smooth straight road!
- 1 A song of ascents. Blessed are all who fear the LORD, who walk in his ways.
- 2 You worked hard and deserve all you've got coming. Enjoy the blessing! Revel in the goodness!
- 2 You will eat the fruit of your labor; blessings and prosperity will be yours.
- 3 Your wife will bear children as a vine bears grapes, your household lush as a vineyard, The children around your table as fresh and promising as young olive shoots.
- 3 Your wife will be like a fruitful vine within your house; your sons will be like olive shoots around your table.
- 4 Stand in awe of God's Yes. Oh, how he blesses the one who fears GOD!
- 4 Thus is the man blessed who fears the LORD.
- 5 Enjoy the good life in Jerusalem every day of your life.
- 5 May the LORD bless you from Zion all the days of your life; may you see the prosperity of Jerusalem,
- 6 And enjoy your grandchildren. Peace to Israel!
- 6 and may you live to see your children's children. Peace be upon Israel.

Psalms 129

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. "They've kicked me around ever since I was young" -- this is how Israel tells it--
- 1 A song of ascents. They have greatly oppressed me from my youth-- let Israel say--
- 2 "They've kicked me around ever since I was young, but they never could keep me down.
- 2 they have greatly oppressed me from my youth, but they have not gained the victory over me.
- 3 Their plowmen plowed long furrows up and down my back;
- 3 Plowmen have plowed my back and made their furrows long.
- 4 Then GOD ripped the harnesses of the evil plowmen to shreds."
- 4 But the LORD is righteous; he has cut me free from the cords of the wicked.
- 5 Oh, let all those who hate Zion grovel in humiliation;
- 5 May all who hate Zion be turned back in shame.
- 6 Let them be like grass in shallow ground that withers before the harvest,
- 6 May they be like grass on the roof, which withers before it can grow;
- 7 Before the farmhands can gather it in, the harvesters get in the crop,
- 7 with it the reaper cannot fill his hands, nor the one who gathers fill his arms.
- 8 Before the neighbors have a chance to call out, "Congratulations on your wonderful crop! We bless you in GOD's name!"
- 8 May those who pass by not say, "The blessing of the LORD be upon you; we bless you in the name of the LORD."

Psalms 130

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. Help, GOD--the bottom has fallen out of my life! Master, hear my cry for help!
- 1 A song of ascents. Out of the depths I cry to you, O LORD;

- 2 Listen hard! Open your ears! Listen to my cries for mercy.
2 O Lord, hear my voice. Let your ears be attentive to my cry for mercy.
3 If you, GOD, kept records on wrongdoings, who would stand a chance?
3 If you, O LORD, kept a record of sins, O Lord, who could stand?
4 As it turns out, forgiveness is your habit, and that's why you're worshiped.
4 But with you there is forgiveness; therefore you are feared.
5 I pray to GOD--my life a prayer-- and wait for what he'll say and do.
5 I wait for the LORD, my soul waits, and in his word I put my hope.
6 My life's on the line before God, my Lord, waiting and watching till morning, waiting and watching till morning.
6 My soul waits for the Lord more than watchmen wait for the morning, more than watchmen wait for the morning.
7 O Israel, wait and watch for GOD-- with GOD's arrival comes love, with GOD's arrival comes generous redemption.
7 O Israel, put your hope in the LORD, for with the LORD is unfailing love and with him is full redemption.
8 No doubt about it--he'll redeem Israel, buy back Israel from captivity to sin.
8 He himself will redeem Israel from all their sins.

Psalms 131

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. GOD, I'm not trying to rule the roost, I don't want to be king of the mountain. I haven't meddled where I have no business or fantasized grandiose plans.
1 A song of ascents. Of David. My heart is not proud, O LORD, my eyes are not haughty; I do not concern myself with great matters or things too wonderful for me.
2 I've kept my feet on the ground, I've cultivated a quiet heart. Like a baby content in its mother's arms, my soul is a baby content.
2 But I have stilled and quieted my soul; like a weaned child with its mother, like a weaned child is my soul within me.
3 Wait, Israel, for GOD. Wait with hope. Hope now; hope always!

3 O Israel, put your hope in the LORD both now and forevermore.

Psalms 132

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. O GOD, remember David, remember all his troubles!
- 1 A song of ascents. O LORD, remember David and all the hardships he endured.
- 2 And remember how he promised GOD, made a vow to the Strong God of Jacob,
- 2 He swore an oath to the LORD and made a vow to the Mighty One of Jacob:
- 3 "I'm not going home, and I'm not going to bed,
- 3 I will not enter my house or go to my bed--
- 4 I'm not going to sleep, not even take time to rest,
- 4 I will allow no sleep to my eyes, no slumber to my eyelids,
- 5 Until I find a home for GOD, a house for the Strong God of Jacob."
- 5 till I find a place for the LORD, a dwelling for the Mighty One of Jacob."
- 6 Remember how we got the news in Ephrathah, learned all about it at Jaar Meadows?
- 6 We heard it in Ephrathah, we came upon it in the fields of Jaar:
- 7 We shouted, "Let's go to the shrine dedication! Let's worship at God's own footstool!"
- 7 Let us go to his dwelling place; let us worship at his footstool--
- 8 Up, GOD, enjoy your new place of quiet repose, you and your mighty covenant ark;
- 8 arise, O LORD, and come to your resting place, you and the ark of your might.
- 9 Get your priests all dressed up in justice; prompt your worshipers to sing this prayer:
- 9 May your priests be clothed with righteousness; may your saints sing for joy."
- 10 "Honor your servant David; don't disdain your anointed one."
- 10 For the sake of David your servant, do not reject your anointed one.

- 11 GOD gave David his word, he won't back out on this promise: "One of your sons I will set on your throne;
- 11 The LORD swore an oath to David, a sure oath that he will not revoke: "One of your own descendants I will place on your throne--
- 12 If your sons stay true to my Covenant and learn to live the way I teach them, Their sons will continue the line-- always a son to sit on your throne.
- 12 if your sons keep my covenant and the statutes I teach them, then their sons will sit on your throne for ever and ever."
- 13 Yes--I, GOD, chose Zion, the place I wanted for my shrine;
- 13 For the LORD has chosen Zion, he has desired it for his dwelling:
- 14 This will always be my home; this is what I want, and I'm here for good.
- 14 This is my resting place for ever and ever; here I will sit enthroned, for I have desired it--
- 15 I'll shower blessings on the pilgrims who come here, and give supper to those who arrive hungry;
- 15 I will bless her with abundant provisions; her poor will I satisfy with food.
- 16 I'll dress my priests in salvation clothes; the holy people will sing their hearts out!
- 16 I will clothe her priests with salvation, and her saints will ever sing for joy.
- 17 Oh, I'll make the place radiant for David! I'll fill it with light for my anointed!
- 17 Here I will make a horn grow for David and set up a lamp for my anointed one.
- 18 I'll dress his enemies in dirty rags, but I'll make his crown sparkle with splendor."
- 18 I will clothe his enemies with shame, but the crown on his head will be resplendent."

Psalms 133

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song of David. How wonderful, how beautiful, when brothers and sisters get along!
- 1 A song of ascents. Of David. How good and pleasant it is when brothers live together in unity!
- 2 It's like costly anointing oil flowing down head and beard, Flowing down Aaron's beard, flowing down the collar of his priestly robes.
- 2 It is like precious oil poured on the head, running down on the beard, running down on Aaron's beard, down upon the collar of his robes.
- 3 It's like the dew on Mount Hermon flowing down the slopes of Zion. Yes, that's where GOD commands the blessing, ordains eternal life.
- 3 It is as if the dew of Hermon were falling on Mount Zion. For there the LORD bestows his blessing, even life forevermore.

Psalms 134

MSG

NIV

- 1 A pilgrim song. Come, bless GOD, all you servants of GOD! You priests of GOD, posted to the nightwatch in GOD's shrine,
- 1 A song of ascents. Praise the LORD, all you servants of the LORD who minister by night in the house of the LORD.
- 2 Lift your praising hands to the Holy Place, and bless GOD.
- 2 Lift up your hands in the sanctuary and praise the LORD.
- 3 In turn, may GOD of Zion bless you-- GOD who made heaven and earth!
- 3 May the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth, bless you from Zion.

Psalms 135

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! Praise the name of GOD, praise the works of GOD.
- 1 Praise the LORD. Praise the name of the LORD; praise him, you servants of the LORD,
- 2 All you priests on duty in GOD's temple, serving in the sacred halls of our God,

- 2 you who minister in the house of the LORD, in the courts of the house of our God.
- 3 Shout "Hallelujah!" because GOD's so good, sing anthems to his beautiful name.
- 3 Praise the LORD, for the LORD is good; sing praise to his name, for that is pleasant.
- 4 And why? Because GOD chose Jacob, embraced Israel as a prize possession.
- 4 For the LORD has chosen Jacob to be his own, Israel to be his treasured possession.
- 5 I too give witness to the greatness of GOD, our Lord, high above all other gods.
- 5 I know that the LORD is great, that our Lord is greater than all gods.
- 6 He does just as he pleases-- however, wherever, whenever.
- 6 The LORD does whatever pleases him, in the heavens and on the earth, in the seas and all their depths.
- 7 He makes the weather--clouds and thunder, lightning and rain, wind pouring out of the north.
- 7 He makes clouds rise from the ends of the earth; he sends lightning with the rain and brings out the wind from his storehouses.
- 8 He struck down the Egyptian firstborn, both human and animal firstborn.
- 8 He struck down the firstborn of Egypt, the firstborn of men and animals.
- 9 He made Egypt sit up and take notice, confronted Pharaoh and his servants with miracles.
- 9 He sent his signs and wonders into your midst, O Egypt, against Pharaoh and all his servants.
- 10 Yes, he struck down great nations, he slew mighty kings--
- 10 He struck down many nations and killed mighty kings--
- 11 Sihon king of the Amorites, also Og of Bashan-- every last one of the Canaanite kings!
- 11 Sihon king of the Amorites, Og king of Bashan and all the kings of Canaan--
- 12 Then he turned their land over to Israel, a gift of good land to his people.
- 12 and he gave their land as an inheritance, an inheritance to his people Israel.

13 GOD, your name is eternal, GOD, you'll never be out-of-date.
13 Your name, O LORD, endures forever, your renown, O LORD, through all generations.
14 GOD stands up for his people, GOD holds the hands of his people.
14 For the LORD will vindicate his people and have compassion on his servants.
15 The gods of the godless nations are mere trinkets, made for quick sale in the markets:
15 The idols of the nations are silver and gold, made by the hands of men.
16 Chiseled mouths that can't talk, painted eyes that can't see,
16 They have mouths, but cannot speak, eyes, but they cannot see;
17 Carved ears that can't hear-- dead wood! cold metal!
17 they have ears, but cannot hear, nor is there breath in their mouths.
18 Those who make and trust them become like them.
18 Those who make them will be like them, and so will all who trust in them.
19 Family of Israel, bless GOD! Family of Aaron, bless GOD!
19 O house of Israel, praise the LORD; O house of Aaron, praise the LORD;
20 Family of Levi, bless GOD! You who fear GOD, bless GOD!
20 O house of Levi, praise the LORD; you who fear him, praise the LORD.
21 Oh, blessed be GOD of Zion, First Citizen of Jerusalem! Hallelujah!
21 Praise be to the LORD from Zion, to him who dwells in Jerusalem.
Praise the LORD.

Psalms 136

MSG

NIV

1 Thank GOD! He deserves your thanks. His love never quits.
1 Give thanks to the LORD, for he is good. His love endures forever.
2 Thank the God of all gods, His love never quits.
2 Give thanks to the God of gods. His love endures forever.
3 Thank the Lord of all lords. His love never quits.
3 Give thanks to the Lord of lords: His love endures forever.
4 Thank the miracle-working God, His love never quits.

4 to him who alone does great wonders, His love endures forever.
5 The God whose skill formed the cosmos, His love never quits.
5 who by his understanding made the heavens, His love endures forever.
6 The God who laid out earth on ocean foundations, His love never quits.
6 who spread out the earth upon the waters, His love endures forever.
7 The God who filled the skies with light, His love never quits.
7 who made the great lights-- His love endures forever.
8 The sun to watch over the day, His love never quits.
8 the sun to govern the day, His love endures forever.
9 Moon and stars as guardians of the night, His love never quits.
9 the moon and stars to govern the night; His love endures forever.
10 The God who struck down the Egyptian firstborn, His love never quits.
10 to him who struck down the firstborn of Egypt His love endures forever.
11 And rescued Israel from Egypt's oppression, His love never quits.
11 and brought Israel out from among them His love endures forever.
12 Took Israel in hand with his powerful hand, His love never quits.
12 with a mighty hand and outstretched arm; His love endures forever.
13 Split the Red Sea right in half, His love never quits.
13 to him who divided the Red Sea asunder His love endures forever.
14 Led Israel right through the middle, His love never quits.
14 and brought Israel through the midst of it, His love endures forever.
15 Dumped Pharaoh and his army in the sea, His love never quits.
15 but swept Pharaoh and his army into the Red Sea; His love endures forever.
16 The God who marched his people through the desert, His love never quits.
16 to him who led his people through the desert, His love endures forever.
17 Smashed huge kingdoms right and left, His love never quits.
17 who struck down great kings, His love endures forever.
18 Struck down the famous kings, His love never quits.
18 and killed mighty kings-- His love endures forever.
19 Struck Sihon the Amorite king, His love never quits.
19 Sihon king of the Amorites His love endures forever.
20 Struck Og the Bashanite king, His love never quits.
20 and Og king of Bashan-- His love endures forever.
21 Then distributed their land as booty, His love never quits.

21 and gave their land as an inheritance, His love endures forever.
22 Handed the land over to Israel. His love never quits.
22 an inheritance to his servant Israel; His love endures forever.
23 God remembered us when we were down, His love never quits.
23 to the One who remembered us in our low estate His love endures forever.
24 Rescued us from the trampling boot, His love never quits.
24 and freed us from our enemies, His love endures forever.
25 Takes care of everyone in time of need. His love never quits.
25 and who gives food to every creature. His love endures forever.
26 Thank God, who did it all! His love never quits!
26 Give thanks to the God of heaven. His love endures forever.

Psalms 137

MSG

NIV

1 Alongside Babylon's rivers we sat on the banks; we cried and cried, remembering the good old days in Zion.
1 By the rivers of Babylon we sat and wept when we remembered Zion.
2 Alongside the quaking aspens we stacked our unplayed harps;
2 There on the poplars we hung our harps,
3 That's where our captors demanded songs, sarcastic and mocking: "Sing us a happy Zion song!"
3 for there our captors asked us for songs, our tormentors demanded songs of joy; they said, "Sing us one of the songs of Zion!"
4 Oh, how could we ever sing GOD's song in this wasteland?
4 How can we sing the songs of the LORD while in a foreign land?
5 If I ever forget you, Jerusalem, let my fingers wither and fall off like leaves.
5 If I forget you, O Jerusalem, may my right hand forget its skill.
6 Let my tongue swell and turn black if I fail to remember you, If I fail, O dear Jerusalem, to honor you as my greatest.
6 May my tongue cling to the roof of my mouth if I do not remember you, if I do not consider Jerusalem my highest joy.

- 7 GOD, remember those Edomites, and remember the ruin of Jerusalem,
That day they yelled out, "Wreck it, smash it to bits!"
- 7 Remember, O LORD, what the Edomites did on the day Jerusalem fell.
"Tear it down," they cried, "tear it down to its foundations!"
- 8 And you, Babylonians--ravagers! A reward to whoever gets back at you
for all you've done to us;
- 8 O Daughter of Babylon, doomed to destruction, happy is he who repays
you for what you have done to us--
- 9 Yes, a reward to the one who grabs your babies and smashes their heads
on the rocks!
- 9 he who seizes your infants and dashes them against the rocks.

Psalms 138

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Thank you! Everything in me says "Thank you!" Angels
listen as I sing my thanks.
- 1 Of David. I will praise you, O LORD, with all my heart; before the
"gods" I will sing your praise.
- 2 I kneel in worship facing your holy temple and say it again: "Thank
you!" Thank you for your love, thank you for your faithfulness; Most
holy is your name, most holy is your Word.
- 2 I will bow down toward your holy temple and will praise your name for
your love and your faithfulness, for you have exalted above all things
your name and your word.
- 3 The moment I called out, you stepped in; you made my life large with
strength.
- 3 When I called, you answered me; you made me bold and stouthearted.
- 4 When they hear what you have to say, GOD, all earth's kings will say
"Thank you."
- 4 May all the kings of the earth praise you, O LORD, when they hear the
words of your mouth.
- 5 They'll sing of what you've done: "How great the glory of GOD!"
- 5 May they sing of the ways of the LORD, for the glory of the LORD is
great.

- 6 And here's why: GOD, high above, sees far below; no matter the distance, he knows everything about us.
- 6 Though the LORD is on high, he looks upon the lowly, but the proud he knows from afar.
- 7 When I walk into the thick of trouble, keep me alive in the angry turmoil. With one hand strike my foes, With your other hand save me.
- 7 Though I walk in the midst of trouble, you preserve my life; you stretch out your hand against the anger of my foes, with your right hand you save me.
- 8 Finish what you started in me, GOD. Your love is eternal--don't quit on me now.
- 8 The LORD will fulfill his purpose for me; your love, O LORD, endures forever-- do not abandon the works of your hands.

Psalms 139

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. GOD, investigate my life; get all the facts firsthand.
- 1 For the director of music. Of David. A psalm. O LORD, you have searched me and you know me.
- 2 I'm an open book to you; even from a distance, you know what I'm thinking.
- 2 You know when I sit and when I rise; you perceive my thoughts from afar.
- 3 You know when I leave and when I get back; I'm never out of your sight.
- 3 You discern my going out and my lying down; you are familiar with all my ways.
- 4 You know everything I'm going to say before I start the first sentence.
- 4 Before a word is on my tongue you know it completely, O LORD.
- 5 I look behind me and you're there, then up ahead and you're there, too-- your reassuring presence, coming and going.
- 5 You hem me in--behind and before; you have laid your hand upon me.
- 6 This is too much, too wonderful-- I can't take it all in!
- 6 Such knowledge is too wonderful for me, too lofty for me to attain.
- 7 Is there anyplace I can go to avoid your Spirit? to be out of your sight?

7 Where can I go from your Spirit? Where can I flee from your presence?
8 If I climb to the sky, you're there! If I go underground, you're there!
8 If I go up to the heavens, you are there; if I make my bed in the depths,
you are there.
9 If I flew on morning's wings to the far western horizon,
9 If I rise on the wings of the dawn, if I settle on the far side of the sea,
10 You'd find me in a minute-- you're already there waiting!
10 even there your hand will guide me, your right hand will hold me fast.
11 Then I said to myself, "Oh, he even sees me in the dark! At night I'm
immersed in the light!"
11 If I say, "Surely the darkness will hide me and the light become night
around me,"
12 It's a fact: darkness isn't dark to you; night and day, darkness and light,
they're all the same to you.
12 even the darkness will not be dark to you; the night will shine like the
day, for darkness is as light to you.
13 Oh yes, you shaped me first inside, then out; you formed me in my
mother's womb.
13 For you created my inmost being; you knit me together in my mother's
womb.
14 I thank you, High God--you're breathtaking! Body and soul, I am
marvelously made! I worship in adoration--what a creation!
14 I praise you because I am fearfully and wonderfully made; your works
are wonderful, I know that full well.
15 You know me inside and out, you know every bone in my body; You
know exactly how I was made, bit by bit, how I was sculpted from
nothing into something.
15 My frame was not hidden from you when I was made in the secret
place. When I was woven together in the depths of the earth,
16 Like an open book, you watched me grow from conception to birth; all
the stages of my life were spread out before you, The days of my life all
prepared before I'd even lived one day.
16 your eyes saw my unformed body. All the days ordained for me were
written in your book before one of them came to be.
17 Your thoughts--how rare, how beautiful! God, I'll never comprehend
them!

- 17 How precious to me are your thoughts, O God! How vast is the sum of them!
- 18 I couldn't even begin to count them-- any more than I could count the sand of the sea. Oh, let me rise in the morning and live always with you!
- 18 Were I to count them, they would outnumber the grains of sand. When I awake, I am still with you.
- 19 And please, God, do away with wickedness for good! And you murderers--out of here!--
- 19 If only you would slay the wicked, O God! Away from me, you bloodthirsty men!
- 20 all the men and women who belittle you, God, infatuated with cheap god-imitations.
- 20 They speak of you with evil intent; your adversaries misuse your name.
- 21 See how I hate those who hate you, GOD, see how I loathe all this godless arrogance;
- 21 Do I not hate those who hate you, O LORD, and abhor those who rise up against you?
- 22 I hate it with pure, unadulterated hatred. Your enemies are my enemies!
- 22 I have nothing but hatred for them; I count them my enemies.
- 23 Investigate my life, O God, find out everything about me; Cross-examine and test me, get a clear picture of what I'm about;
- 23 Search me, O God, and know my heart; test me and know my anxious thoughts.
- 24 See for yourself whether I've done anything wrong-- then guide me on the road to eternal life.
- 24 See if there is any offensive way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting.

Psalms 140

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. GOD, get me out of here, away from this evil; protect me from these vicious people.
- 1 For the director of music. A psalm of David. Rescue me, O LORD, from evil men; protect me from men of violence,

- 2 All they do is think up new ways to be bad; they spend their days plotting war games.
- 2 who devise evil plans in their hearts and stir up war every day.
- 3 They practice the sharp rhetoric of hate and hurt, speak venomous words that maim and kill.
- 3 They make their tongues as sharp as a serpent's; the poison of vipers is on their lips. Selah
- 4 GOD, keep me out of the clutch of these wicked ones, protect me from these vicious people;
- 4 Keep me, O LORD, from the hands of the wicked; protect me from men of violence who plan to trip my feet.
- 5 Stuffed with self-importance, they plot ways to trip me up, determined to bring me down. These crooks invent traps to catch me and do their best to incriminate me.
- 5 Proud men have hidden a snare for me; they have spread out the cords of their net and have set traps for me along my path. Selah
- 6 I prayed, "GOD, you're my God! Listen, GOD! Mercy!
- 6 O LORD, I say to you, "You are my God." Hear, O LORD, my cry for mercy.
- 7 GOD, my Lord, Strong Savior, protect me when the fighting breaks out!
- 7 O Sovereign LORD, my strong deliverer, who shields my head in the day of battle--
- 8 Don't let the wicked have their way, GOD, don't give them an inch!"
- 8 do not grant the wicked their desires, O LORD; do not let their plans succeed, or they will become proud. Selah
- 9 These troublemakers all around me-- let them drown in their own verbal poison.
- 9 Let the heads of those who surround me be covered with the trouble their lips have caused.
- 10 Let God pile hellfire on them, let him bury them alive in crevasses!
- 10 Let burning coals fall upon them; may they be thrown into the fire, into miry pits, never to rise.
- 11 These loudmouths-- don't let them be taken seriously; These savages-- let the Devil hunt them down!
- 11 Let slanderers not be established in the land; may disaster hunt down men of violence.

- 12 I know that you, GOD, are on the side of victims, that you care for the rights of the poor.
- 12 I know that the LORD secures justice for the poor and upholds the cause of the needy.
- 13 And I know that the righteous personally thank you, that good people are secure in your presence.
- 13 Surely the righteous will praise your name and the upright will live before you.

Psalms 141

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. GOD, come close. Come quickly! Open your ears--it's my voice you're hearing!
- 1 A psalm of David. O LORD, I call to you; come quickly to me. Hear my voice when I call to you.
- 2 Treat my prayer as sweet incense rising; my raised hands are my evening prayers.
- 2 May my prayer be set before you like incense; may the lifting up of my hands be like the evening sacrifice.
- 3 Post a guard at my mouth, GOD, set a watch at the door of my lips.
- 3 Set a guard over my mouth, O LORD; keep watch over the door of my lips.
- 4 Don't let me so much as dream of evil or thoughtlessly fall into bad company. And these people who only do wrong-- don't let them lure me with their sweet talk!
- 4 Let not my heart be drawn to what is evil, to take part in wicked deeds with men who are evildoers; let me not eat of their delicacies.
- 5 May the Just One set me straight, may the Kind One correct me, Don't let sin anoint my head. I'm praying hard against their evil ways!
- 5 Let a righteous man strike me--it is a kindness; let him rebuke me--it is oil on my head. My head will not refuse it. Yet my prayer is ever against the deeds of evildoers;
- 6 Oh, let their leaders be pushed off a high rock cliff; make them face the music.

- 6 their rulers will be thrown down from the cliffs, and the wicked will learn that my words were well spoken.
- 7 Like a rock pulverized by a maul, let their bones be scattered at the gates of hell.
- 7 They will say, "As one plows and breaks up the earth, so our bones have been scattered at the mouth of the grave. "
- 8 But GOD, dear Lord, I only have eyes for you. Since I've run for dear life to you, take good care of me.
- 8 But my eyes are fixed on you, O Sovereign LORD; in you I take refuge-- do not give me over to death.
- 9 Protect me from their evil scheming, from all their demonic subterfuge.
- 9 Keep me from the snares they have laid for me, from the traps set by evildoers.
- 10 Let the wicked fall flat on their faces, while I walk off without a scratch. A David prayer--when he was in the cave.
- 10 Let the wicked fall into their own nets, while I pass by in safety.

Psalms 142

MSG

NIV

- 1 I cry out loudly to GOD, loudly I plead with GOD for mercy.
- 1 A maskil of David. When he was in the cave. A prayer. I cry aloud to the LORD; I lift up my voice to the LORD for mercy.
- 2 I spill out all my complaints before him, and spell out my troubles in detail:
- 2 I pour out my complaint before him; before him I tell my trouble.
- 3 "As I sink in despair, my spirit ebbing away, you know how I'm feeling, Know the danger I'm in, the traps hidden in my path.
- 3 When my spirit grows faint within me, it is you who know my way. In the path where I walk men have hidden a snare for me.
- 4 Look right, look left-- there's not a soul who cares what happens! I'm up against it, with no exit-- bereft, left alone.
- 4 Look to my right and see; no one is concerned for me. I have no refuge; no one cares for my life.
- 5 I cry out, GOD, call out: 'You're my last chance, my only hope for life!'

- 5 I cry to you, O LORD; I say, "You are my refuge, my portion in the land of the living."
- 6 Oh listen, please listen; I've never been this low. Rescue me from those who are hunting me down; I'm no match for them.
- 6 Listen to my cry, for I am in desperate need; rescue me from those who pursue me, for they are too strong for me.
- 7 Get me out of this dungeon so I can thank you in public. Your people will form a circle around me and you'll bring me showers of blessing!"
- 7 Set me free from my prison, that I may praise your name. Then the righteous will gather about me because of your goodness to me.

Psalms 143

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Listen to this prayer of mine, GOD; pay attention to what I'm asking. Answer me--you're famous for your answers! Do what's right for me.
- 1 A psalm of David. O LORD, hear my prayer, listen to my cry for mercy; in your faithfulness and righteousness come to my relief.
- 2 But don't, please don't, haul me into court; not a person alive would be acquitted there.
- 2 Do not bring your servant into judgment, for no one living is righteous before you.
- 3 The enemy hunted me down; he kicked me and stomped me within an inch of my life. He put me in a black hole, buried me like a corpse in that dungeon.
- 3 The enemy pursues me, he crushes me to the ground; he makes me dwell in darkness like those long dead.
- 4 I sat there in despair, my spirit draining away, my heart heavy, like lead.
- 4 So my spirit grows faint within me; my heart within me is dismayed.
- 5 I remembered the old days, went over all you've done, pondered the ways you've worked,
- 5 I remember the days of long ago; I meditate on all your works and consider what your hands have done.

- 6 Stretched out my hands to you, as thirsty for you as a desert thirsty for rain.
- 6 I spread out my hands to you; my soul thirsts for you like a parched land.
Selah
- 7 Hurry with your answer, GOD! I'm nearly at the end of my rope. Don't turn away; don't ignore me! That would be certain death.
- 7 Answer me quickly, O LORD; my spirit fails. Do not hide your face from me or I will be like those who go down to the pit.
- 8 If you wake me each morning with the sound of your loving voice, I'll go to sleep each night trusting in you. Point out the road I must travel; I'm all ears, all eyes before you.
- 8 Let the morning bring me word of your unfailing love, for I have put my trust in you. Show me the way I should go, for to you I lift up my soul.
- 9 Save me from my enemies, GOD-- you're my only hope!
- 9 Rescue me from my enemies, O LORD, for I hide myself in you.
- 10 Teach me how to live to please you, because you're my God. Lead me by your blessed Spirit into cleared and level pastureland.
- 10 Teach me to do your will, for you are my God; may your good Spirit lead me on level ground.
- 11 Keep up your reputation, God--give me life! In your justice, get me out of this trouble!
- 11 For your name's sake, O LORD, preserve my life; in your righteousness, bring me out of trouble.
- 12 In your great love, vanquish my enemies; make a clean sweep of those who harass me. And why? Because I'm your servant.
- 12 In your unfailing love, silence my enemies; destroy all my foes, for I am your servant.

Psalms 144

MSG

NIV

- 1 A David psalm. Blessed be GOD, my mountain, who trains me to fight fair and well.
- 1 Of David. Praise be to the LORD my Rock, who trains my hands for war, my fingers for battle.

- 2 He's the bedrock on which I stand, the castle in which I live, my rescuing knight, The high crag where I run for dear life, while he lays my enemies low.
- 2 He is my loving God and my fortress, my stronghold and my deliverer, my shield, in whom I take refuge, who subdues peoples under me.
- 3 I wonder why you care, GOD-- why do you bother with us at all?
- 3 O LORD, what is man that you care for him, the son of man that you think of him?
- 4 All we are is a puff of air; we're like shadows in a campfire.
- 4 Man is like a breath; his days are like a fleeting shadow.
- 5 Step down out of heaven, GOD; ignite volcanoes in the hearts of the mountains.
- 5 Part your heavens, O LORD, and come down; touch the mountains, so that they smoke.
- 6 Hurl your lightnings in every direction; shoot your arrows this way and that.
- 6 Send forth lightning and scatter the enemies; shoot your arrows and rout them.
- 7 Reach all the way from sky to sea: pull me out of the ocean of hate, out of the grip of those barbarians
- 7 Reach down your hand from on high; deliver me and rescue me from the mighty waters, from the hands of foreigners
- 8 Who lie through their teeth, who shake your hand then knife you in the back.
- 8 whose mouths are full of lies, whose right hands are deceitful.
- 9 O God, let me sing a new song to you, let me play it on a twelve-string guitar--
- 9 I will sing a new song to you, O God; on the ten-stringed lyre I will make music to you,
- 10 A song to the God who saved the king, the God who rescued David, his servant.
- 10 to the One who gives victory to kings, who delivers his servant David from the deadly sword.
- 11 Rescue me from the enemy sword, release me from the grip of those barbarians Who lie through their teeth, who shake your hand then knife you in the back.

- 11 Deliver me and rescue me from the hands of foreigners whose mouths are full of lies, whose right hands are deceitful.
- 12 Make our sons in their prime like sturdy oak trees, Our daughters as shapely and bright as fields of wildflowers.
- 12 Then our sons in their youth will be like well-nurtured plants, and our daughters will be like pillars carved to adorn a palace.
- 13 Fill our barns with great harvest, fill our fields with huge flocks;
- 13 Our barns will be filled with every kind of provision. Our sheep will increase by thousands, by tens of thousands in our fields;
- 14 Protect us from invasion and exile-- eliminate the crime in our streets.
- 14 our oxen will draw heavy loads. There will be no breaching of walls, no going into captivity, no cry of distress in our streets.
- 15 How blessed the people who have all this! How blessed the people who have GOD for God!
- 15 Blessed are the people of whom this is true; blessed are the people whose God is the LORD.

Psalms 145

MSG

NIV

- 1 David's praise. I lift you high in praise, my God, O my King! and I'll bless your name into eternity.
- 1 A psalm of praise. Of David. I will exalt you, my God the King; I will praise your name for ever and ever.
- 2 I'll bless you every day, and keep it up from now to eternity.
- 2 Every day I will praise you and extol your name for ever and ever.
- 3 GOD is magnificent; he can never be praised enough. There are no boundaries to his greatness.
- 3 Great is the LORD and most worthy of praise; his greatness no one can fathom.
- 4 Generation after generation stands in awe of your work; each one tells stories of your mighty acts.
- 4 One generation will commend your works to another; they will tell of your mighty acts.

- 5 Your beauty and splendor have everyone talking; I compose songs on your wonders.
- 5 They will speak of the glorious splendor of your majesty, and I will meditate on your wonderful works.
- 6 Your marvelous doings are headline news; I could write a book full of the details of your greatness.
- 6 They will tell of the power of your awesome works, and I will proclaim your great deeds.
- 7 The fame of your goodness spreads across the country; your righteousness is on everyone's lips.
- 7 They will celebrate your abundant goodness and joyfully sing of your righteousness.
- 8 GOD is all mercy and grace-- not quick to anger, is rich in love.
- 8 The LORD is gracious and compassionate, slow to anger and rich in love.
- 9 GOD is good to one and all; everything he does is suffused with grace.
- 9 The LORD is good to all; he has compassion on all he has made.
- 10 Creation and creatures applaud you, GOD;
- 10 All you have made will praise you, O LORD; your saints will extol you.
- 11 your holy people bless you. They talk about the glories of your rule, they exclaim over your splendor,
- 11 They will tell of the glory of your kingdom and speak of your might,
- 12 Letting the world know of your power for good, the lavish splendor of your kingdom.
- 12 so that all men may know of your mighty acts and the glorious splendor of your kingdom.
- 13 Your kingdom is a kingdom eternal; you never get voted out of office. GOD always does what he says, and is gracious in everything he does.
- 13 Your kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and your dominion endures through all generations. The LORD is faithful to all his promises and loving toward all he has made.
- 14 GOD gives a hand to those down on their luck, gives a fresh start to those ready to quit.
- 14 The LORD upholds all those who fall and lifts up all who are bowed down.
- 15 All eyes are on you, expectant; you give them their meals on time.

- 15 The eyes of all look to you, and you give them their food at the proper time.
- 16 Generous to a fault, you lavish your favor on all creatures.
- 16 You open your hand and satisfy the desires of every living thing.
- 17 Everything GOD does is right-- the trademark on all his works is love.
- 17 The LORD is righteous in all his ways and loving toward all he has made.
- 18 GOD's there, listening for all who pray, for all who pray and mean it.
- 18 The LORD is near to all who call on him, to all who call on him in truth.
- 19 He does what's best for those who fear him-- hears them call out, and saves them.
- 19 He fulfills the desires of those who fear him; he hears their cry and saves them.
- 20 GOD sticks by all who love him, but it's all over for those who don't.
- 20 The LORD watches over all who love him, but all the wicked he will destroy.
- 21 My mouth is filled with GOD's praise. Let everything living bless him, bless his holy name from now to eternity!
- 21 My mouth will speak in praise of the LORD. Let every creature praise his holy name for ever and ever.

Psalms 146

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! O my soul, praise GOD!
- 1 Praise the LORD. Praise the LORD, O my soul.
- 2 All my life long I'll praise GOD, singing songs to my God as long as I live.
- 2 I will praise the LORD all my life; I will sing praise to my God as long as I live.
- 3 Don't put your life in the hands of experts who know nothing of life, of salvation life.
- 3 Do not put your trust in princes, in mortal men, who cannot save.

- 4 Mere humans don't have what it takes; when they die, their projects die with them.
- 4 When their spirit departs, they return to the ground; on that very day their plans come to nothing.
- 5 Instead, get help from the God of Jacob, put your hope in GOD and know real blessing!
- 5 Blessed is he whose help is the God of Jacob, whose hope is in the LORD his God,
- 6 GOD made sky and soil, sea and all the fish in it. He always does what he says--
- 6 the Maker of heaven and earth, the sea, and everything in them-- the LORD, who remains faithful forever.
- 7 he defends the wronged, he feeds the hungry. GOD frees prisoners--
- 7 He upholds the cause of the oppressed and gives food to the hungry. The LORD sets prisoners free,
- 8 he gives sight to the blind, he lifts up the fallen. GOD loves good people,
- 8 the LORD gives sight to the blind, the LORD lifts up those who are bowed down, the LORD loves the righteous.
- 9 protects strangers, takes the side of orphans and widows, but makes short work of the wicked.
- 9 The LORD watches over the alien and sustains the fatherless and the widow, but he frustrates the ways of the wicked.
- 10 GOD's in charge--always. Zion's God is God for good! Hallelujah!
- 10 The LORD reigns forever, your God, O Zion, for all generations. Praise the LORD.

Psalms 147

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! It's a good thing to sing praise to our God; praise is beautiful, praise is fitting.
- 1 Praise the LORD. How good it is to sing praises to our God, how pleasant and fitting to praise him!
- 2 GOD's the one who rebuilds Jerusalem, who regathers Israel's scattered exiles.

- 2 The LORD builds up Jerusalem; he gathers the exiles of Israel.
3 He heals the heartbroken and bandages their wounds.
3 He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.
4 He counts the stars and assigns each a name.
4 He determines the number of the stars and calls them each by name.
5 Our Lord is great, with limitless strength; we'll never comprehend what he knows and does
5 Great is our Lord and mighty in power; his understanding has no limit.
6 GOD puts the fallen on their feet again and pushes the wicked into the ditch.
6 The LORD sustains the humble but casts the wicked to the ground.
7 Sing to GOD a thanksgiving hymn, play music on your instruments to God,
7 Sing to the LORD with thanksgiving; make music to our God on the harp.
8 Who fills the sky with clouds, preparing rain for the earth, Then turning the mountains green with grass,
8 He covers the sky with clouds; he supplies the earth with rain and makes grass grow on the hills.
9 feeding both cattle and crows.
9 He provides food for the cattle and for the young ravens when they call.
10 He's not impressed with horsepower; the size of our muscles means little to him.
10 His pleasure is not in the strength of the horse, nor his delight in the legs of a man;
11 Those who fear GOD get GOD's attention; they can depend on his strength.
11 the LORD delights in those who fear him, who put their hope in his unfailing love.
12 Jerusalem, worship GOD! Zion, praise your God!
12 Extol the LORD, O Jerusalem; praise your God, O Zion,
13 He made your city secure, he blessed your children among you.
13 for he strengthens the bars of your gates and blesses your people within you.
14 He keeps the peace at your borders, he puts the best bread on your tables.

- 14 He grants peace to your borders and satisfies you with the finest of wheat.
- 15 He launches his promises earthward-- how swift and sure they come!
- 15 He sends his command to the earth; his word runs swiftly.
- 16 He spreads snow like a white fleece, he scatters frost like ashes,
- 16 He spreads the snow like wool and scatters the frost like ashes.
- 17 He broadcasts hail like birdseed-- who can survive his winter?
- 17 He hurls down his hail like pebbles. Who can withstand his icy blast?
- 18 Then he gives the command and it all melts; he breathes on winter-- suddenly it's spring!
- 18 He sends his word and melts them; he stirs up his breezes, and the waters flow.
- 19 He speaks the same way to Jacob, speaks words that work to Israel.
- 19 He has revealed his word to Jacob, his laws and decrees to Israel.
- 20 He never did this to the other nations; they never heard such commands. Hallelujah!
- 20 He has done this for no other nation; they do not know his laws. Praise the LORD.

Psalms 148

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! Praise GOD from heaven, praise him from the mountaintops;
- 1 Praise the LORD. Praise the LORD from the heavens, praise him in the heights above.
- 2 Praise him, all you his angels, praise him, all you his warriors,
- 2 Praise him, all his angels, praise him, all his heavenly hosts.
- 3 Praise him, sun and moon, praise him, you morning stars;
- 3 Praise him, sun and moon, praise him, all you shining stars.
- 4 Praise him, high heaven, praise him, heavenly rain clouds;
- 4 Praise him, you highest heavens and you waters above the skies.
- 5 Praise, oh let them praise the name of GOD-- he spoke the word, and there they were!
- 5 Let them praise the name of the LORD, for he commanded and they were created.

- 6 He set them in place from all time to eternity; He gave his orders, and that's it!
- 6 He set them in place for ever and ever; he gave a decree that will never pass away.
- 7 Praise GOD from earth, you sea dragons, you fathomless ocean deeps;
- 7 Praise the LORD from the earth, you great sea creatures and all ocean depths,
- 8 Fire and hail, snow and ice, hurricanes obeying his orders;
- 8 lightning and hail, snow and clouds, stormy winds that do his bidding,
- 9 Mountains and all hills, apple orchards and cedar forests;
- 9 you mountains and all hills, fruit trees and all cedars,
- 10 Wild beasts and herds of cattle, snakes, and birds in flight;
- 10 wild animals and all cattle, small creatures and flying birds,
- 11 Earth's kings and all races, leaders and important people,
- 11 kings of the earth and all nations, you princes and all rulers on earth,
- 12 Robust men and women in their prime, and yes, graybeards and little children.
- 12 young men and maidens, old men and children.
- 13 Let them praise the name of GOD-- it's the only Name worth praising.
His radiance exceeds anything in earth and sky;
- 13 Let them praise the name of the LORD, for his name alone is exalted;
his splendor is above the earth and the heavens.
- 14 he's built a monument--his very own people! Praise from all who love GOD! Israel's children, intimate friends of GOD. Hallelujah!
- 14 He has raised up for his people a horn, the praise of all his saints, of Israel, the people close to his heart. Praise the LORD.

Psalms 149

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! Sing to GOD a brand-new song, praise him in the company of all who love him.
- 1 Praise the LORD. Sing to the LORD a new song, his praise in the assembly of the saints.

- 2 Let all Israel celebrate their Sovereign Creator, Zion's children exult in their King.
- 2 Let Israel rejoice in their Maker; let the people of Zion be glad in their King.
- 3 Let them praise his name in dance; strike up the band and make great music!
- 3 Let them praise his name with dancing and make music to him with tambourine and harp.
- 4 And why? Because GOD delights in his people, festoons plain folk with salvation garlands!
- 4 For the LORD takes delight in his people; he crowns the humble with salvation.
- 5 Let true lovers break out in praise, sing out from wherever they're sitting,
- 5 Let the saints rejoice in this honor and sing for joy on their beds.
- 6 Shout the high praises of God, brandish their swords in the wild sword-dance--
- 6 May the praise of God be in their mouths and a double-edged sword in their hands,
- 7 A portent of vengeance on the God-defying nations, a signal that punishment's coming,
- 7 to inflict vengeance on the nations and punishment on the peoples,
- 8 Their kings chained and hauled off to jail, their leaders behind bars for good,
- 8 to bind their kings with fetters, their nobles with shackles of iron,
- 9 The judgment on them carried out to the letter --and all who love God in the seat of honor! Hallelujah!
- 9 to carry out the sentence written against them. This is the glory of all his saints. Praise the LORD.

Psalms 150

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hallelujah! Praise God in his holy house of worship, praise him under the open skies;

- 1 Praise the LORD. Praise God in his sanctuary; praise him in his mighty heavens.
- 2 Praise him for his acts of power, praise him for his magnificent greatness;
- 2 Praise him for his acts of power; praise him for his surpassing greatness.
- 3 Praise with a blast on the trumpet, praise by strumming soft strings;
- 3 Praise him with the sounding of the trumpet, praise him with the harp and lyre,
- 4 Praise him with castanets and dance, praise him with banjo and flute;
- 4 praise him with tambourine and dancing, praise him with the strings and flute,
- 5 Praise him with cymbals and a big bass drum, praise him with fiddles and mandolin.
- 5 praise him with the clash of cymbals, praise him with resounding cymbals.
- 6 Let every living, breathing creature praise GOD! Hallelujah!
- 6 Let everything that has breath praise the LORD. Praise the LORD.